

Partisanship in Belgian Parliamentary Speech: Evidence from the Chamber of Representatives, 1831–2025*

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Abstract

How have divisions between Belgian parties changed over time? How did they respond to wider voting rights, proportional representation and the split of national parties along linguistic lines? We measure partisanship in speeches in the Belgian Chamber of Representatives from its first sitting in 1831 to 2025. We use the measure developed for the US Congress by [Gentzkow et al. \(2019\)](#): the expected posterior probability that a neutral observer assigns to a speaker's actual party after hearing a single phrase. Partisanship between Catholics and other parties is low under census suffrage, rises when the Socialists enter the Chamber in 1894 and peaks in the 1950s, during the Royal Question and the second school war. At that peak, an observer hearing one minute of speech would identify a member's party correctly with probability 0.69. Partisanship falls sharply after the School Pact of 1958. Partisanship between the left and other parties peaks in 1894, the early 1930s, the 1950s and the mid-1970s, and is lowest in the federal era. Both series peak when these divisions align with the divide between government and opposition. This is the most persistent division in speech. Parties differ in how they govern and oppose, as well as in how they discuss schools, social policy and the monarchy. Catholics and Liberals differed most during the second school war. Catholics and Socialists were the most distant pair, while Liberals and Socialists converged whenever they governed together. Before the national parties split, Flemish and Walloon members differed mainly in their regional agendas, with no widening gap in their speech. Belgian partisanship peaked earlier than in other parliaments studied with this method and has remained below its historical levels.

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1 Introduction

Political polarization can weaken government efficiency and stability. High polarization may block decision-making (Jones, 2001; Binder, 2003) or even threaten democracy (Arbatli and Rosenberg, 2021). Polarization usually refers to disagreement or differences in attitudes between groups (DiMaggio et al., 1996). Political scientists typically measure it by estimating legislators' positions from roll-call votes and combining the distances between them (Poole and Rosenthal, 1985; McCarty et al., 2006). Under strong party discipline, however, votes reveal little about differences that parties choose not to bring to a vote. Speech is less constrained by party discipline than voting (Proksch and Slapin, 2015; Schwarz et al., 2017). This matters in Belgium, where parties control their members' parliamentary careers and discipline in the Chamber has traditionally been high (Depauw, 2003; Deschouwer, 2012). We document differences in speech between parties in the Belgian Chamber of Representatives from 1831 to 2025. Following Gentzkow et al. (2019), we call these differences partisanship of speech, or simply partisanship.

We use the Belgian Chamber Debates dataset (Graziani, 2026). It covers every plenary sitting from the Chamber's first sitting in 1831 to the end of 2025. Each speech is linked to its speaker and, through the speaker, to a party, electoral district and biography. We convert the 1,567,306 speeches by Chamber members into stemmed two-word phrases and count them by member and by period of about two years. The measure introduced for the US Congress by Gentzkow et al. (2019) is the expected posterior probability that a neutral observer assigns to a speaker's actual party after hearing a single phrase. We also use their penalized estimator, random-label benchmark, magnitude measures and measure of individual phrase partisanship. The measure has since been applied to Norway's (Fiva et al., 2021) and Finland's (Simola et al., 2025) multiparty parliaments. As in Belgium, these applications compare two groups at a time. Related supervised measures predict a speaker's party from the text and have been applied to the House of Commons (Peterson and Spirling, 2018; Goet, 2019) and Sweden's Riksdag (Wising et al., 2026).

Belgium extends the existing evidence in three ways. First, our series begins under census suffrage, when only a small fraction of adult men elected the Chamber. It covers the full transition from an elite electorate to mass democracy: plural voting in 1893, the first use of list proportional representation for a national parliament in 1899, equal male suffrage in 1919 and women's suffrage in 1948. Second, three cleavages shaped the Belgian party system (Lorwin, 1966; Lipset and Rokkan, 1967; Lijphart, 1981): religion divided Catholics and anticlericals, socioeconomic interests divided labour and capital, and language divided Dutch- and French-speakers. We measure each through a separate grouping of parties. Third, debates take place in two languages. Between 1968 and 1978, the national parties split along linguistic lines, leaving each party to represent one language community. Combining both languages in one measure would then capture differences in language as well as partisanship. We therefore build separate French and Dutch vocabularies, compare parties within each language, and weight the two estimates by their shares of speech.

Religious partisanship measures differences between the Catholic family and all other parties. Under census suffrage, it averages 0.0006 above the random-label benchmark between 1846, when the Liberals organized as a party, and 1893. Its highest values in this era, in 1880–1886,

appear only after controlling for the parties' regional composition. It more than doubles under plural voting, when the Socialists join the Liberals in the non-Catholic group, and falls close to zero in the 1920s. It peaks at about 0.006 in 1950–1958, four times its average under plural voting. These years cover the Royal Question, the Christian-democratic governments of 1950–1954 and the second school war. Within one period after the School Pact of 1958, partisanship returns to zero. It remains low after the Christian democrats split. At the peak, an observer hearing one minute of speech would identify a member's party correctly with probability 0.69, compared with 0.55 in the last period. The US Congress reached 0.73 in 2007 ([Gentzkow et al., 2019](#)), while Finland's Eduskunta peaked slightly below 0.70 in the 1970s ([Simola et al., 2023](#)).

Partisanship between the left and other parties is highest when the Belgian Workers' Party enters the Chamber in 1894, during the crisis and special powers of 1932–1934, in the 1950s and in 1974–1977. It is lowest in the federal era. Unlike in Finland ([Simola et al., 2025](#)), the radical left does not drive the highest peaks, in 1894 and the 1950s. Excluding it does, however, halve the 1974–1977 peak and reduce the 1932–1934 peak by a third.

The peaks also reflect a division that cuts across these cleavages: government versus opposition. Religious partisanship is high when Catholics govern alone or oppose a government formed by other families. It is low under governments of national union. Left–right partisanship is high when Socialists and Catholics are on opposite sides of the government–opposition divide. Partisanship between governing and opposition parties peaks in the same periods. It exceeds its random benchmark in two thirds of periods and is the largest of the three divisions in the federal era.

The most partisan phrases help explain this pattern. They include vocabulary about schools (*écoles communales, instruction publique, enseignement libre*), social issues (*classe ouvrière, suffrage universel*) and the Royal Question (*consultation populaire*). They also include the formulas ministers and rapporteurs use to submit bills and reports, and the phrases opposition members use to address ministers. We do not control for whether the speaker's party is in government. [Simola et al. \(2025\)](#) include this control, while [Gentzkow et al. \(2019\)](#) control for majority-party status in Congress. For long periods, a single party family formed the government, so including this control prevents us from separately identifying religious partisanship.

Belgium's multiparty system also allows comparisons between pairs of party families. Catholics and Liberals spoke similarly for most of the period and differed most during the second school war. Catholics and Socialists were the most distant pair, especially in the 1950s. Liberals and Socialists differed sharply before 1914 and under the centre-right governments of the 1980s. Their speech was similar when they governed together after 1999.

Our multiparty index measures expected partisanship between two members of different families. It follows the Catholic–Socialist gap until the 1960s and rises again in the 2020s. The recent rise comes mainly from Dutch-language comparisons involving the radical right and Flemish nationalists. Before the national parties split, Flemish and Walloon members differed in their French speech mainly because of their regional agendas: canals, coal and the Walloon industrial basins on one side, and linen, sugar and ports on the other. Language policy appears among their distinctive phrases mainly between the wars. The gap in their speech did not widen in the decades before the split.

Changes in voting rights left limited traces in these series. Partisanship rose with plural voting in 1894, when the Socialists entered the Chamber. This is consistent with the Chamber–Senate comparison in [Graziani and Vanschoonbeek \(2026\)](#). It fell slightly after proportional representation was introduced in 1900. Changes around equal male suffrage and women’s suffrage are better explained by the national-union governments of 1918–1921 and the Royal Question of 1950 than by changes in the electorate.

Belgian partisanship peaked earlier than in other parliaments and has remained below its historical levels (Section 5.9). The one-minute identification probabilities of the 1950s are comparable to the US Congress in 2007 and the Finnish peak of the 1970s. In the federal era, the left–right probability is close to that of the Norwegian Storting in the same years. As in the other parliamentary systems studied so far, the government–opposition divide helps explain the results throughout the period.

Two companion modules of the dataset, still in progress, extend the analysis. Topic labels for every speech will distinguish differences in what parties discuss from differences in how they discuss the same subject (Section 6). The dictionaries already suggest that the Royal Question and social issues divided parties’ agendas, while the first school war divided their vocabulary on a shared subject.

Stage directions in the record provide a measure of disorder in the Chamber (Section 7). Disorder peaks in the 1950s and moves with partisanship across decades. Opposition speakers received more disorder than government speakers in every decade from the 1840s to the 2010s. References to members by name were directed towards other party families more often than a random benchmark would predict. From 1900, they also favoured members of the speaker’s own language community.

Two limitations matter for interpreting these findings. First, the measure captures differences in speech rather than the intensity of conflict. During the first school war, both sides spoke about schools in proportion to their numbers. Religious partisanship therefore rose much less than historical accounts of the conflict might suggest ([Lamberts and Lory, 1986](#); [Witte et al., 2009](#)). Second, levels are not directly comparable across eras. Members used three to four times as many phrases around 1900 as after 1990, and the Dutch vocabulary is a fifth the size of the French vocabulary. Some speech blocks also mix languages or include procedural text. In the 1950s, text in the other language accounts for about a quarter of religious partisanship in the leave-out estimates. Much of this text consists of translated formulas used by the governing side to submit bills and reports. We document these problems and identify the results they affect.

This paper contributes to research on partisan parliamentary speech outside the US two-party system. [Peterson and Spirling \(2018\)](#) measure polarization in Westminster through the accuracy of machine-learning classifiers. [Goet \(2019\)](#) studies polarization in the House of Commons from 1811. [Lauderdale and Herzog \(2016\)](#) estimate positions from speeches in the Irish Dáil and find that the government–opposition divide is the main dimension. [Fiva et al. \(2021\)](#) apply the measure of [Gentzkow et al. \(2019\)](#) to the Norwegian Storting from 1981. [Simola et al. \(2025\)](#) trace a century of Finnish speech. [Wising et al. \(2026\)](#) study the blocs of Sweden’s Riksdag, and [Hirst et al. \(2014\)](#) show that Canadian debate classifiers learn government and opposition roles rather than ideology. More broadly, debate rules and party control shape who speaks and how

freely members can speak (Proksch and Slapin, 2015; Bäck et al., 2021). For the United States, Jensen et al. (2012) and Gentzkow et al. (2019) document long-run changes in partisan language in Congress.

Belgium adds a series covering census suffrage, wider voting rights, proportional representation and federalization. Its bilingual parliament also allows us to study three distinct cleavages. For 1880–1912, Graziani and Vanschoonbeek (2026) use the same data and the leave-out estimator of Gentzkow et al. (2019) to compare the Chamber and Senate around the reforms of 1894 and 1900. Here, we study the Chamber’s full history and use the penalized estimator as our main measure.

Section 2 describes Belgium and the Chamber. Section 3 presents the data and their limitations, and Section 4 explains the speech model and estimation. Section 5 reports the results and compares Belgium with other parliaments. Section 6 discusses topics, Section 7 examines reactions and references in the Chamber, and Section 8 concludes.

2 Background

2.1 Belgium, 1830–2025

Belgium became independent after the revolution of 1830 and adopted its Constitution on 7 February 1831. It was the first country in continental Europe to industrialize. Industry developed around coal and iron in the Walloon basins and textiles in Ghent, while most of Flanders remained agricultural (Witte et al., 2009). Figure 6 shows GDP per capita and its growth from 1846, the first year of the annual series (Bolt and van Zanden, 2024, 2025). It records sustained nineteenth-century growth, sharp falls during both German occupations, rapid post-war expansion and a slowdown after the crises of the 1970s. After the Second World War, economic activity shifted from Wallonia towards Flanders. This shift contributed to conflict between the language communities (Deschouwer, 2012).

Three cleavages shaped Belgian politics (Lorwin, 1966; Lijphart, 1981). The religious cleavage divided Catholics and anticlerical Liberals over the Church’s role in the state, especially in education. The Liberal school law of 1879 began the first school war. It ended with the Catholic victory of 1884 and a law allowing communes to adopt Catholic schools in place of their own (Lamberts and Lory, 1986; Witte et al., 2009). The second school war concerned the laws of the Socialist–Liberal government of 1954–1958 and ended with the School Pact of 1958. The socioeconomic cleavage developed with the foundation of the Belgian Workers’ Party in 1885 and the industrial unrest of 1886. The party entered the Chamber in 1894. The linguistic cleavage divided the Flemish movement and the French-speaking state. It led to the Equality Law of 1898, the language laws of the 1930s, the split of the national parties in 1968–1978 and the state reforms of 1970–1993 that made Belgium a federation (Deschouwer, 2012). These cleavages structured pillars of parties, unions, mutual societies, schools and newspapers (Lijphart, 1981).

Other conflicts crossed these divisions. The Royal Question concerned King Leopold III’s return after the Second World War. It divided Catholics from Socialists and Liberals, as well as Flanders from Wallonia. It was settled after the popular consultation of 1950 and the King’s abdication in 1951 (Witte et al., 2009; Conway, 2012).

2.2 The Chamber of Representatives, 1831–2025

The Constitution of 1831 created a bicameral parliament. The Chamber of Representatives was elected under census suffrage in multi-member districts (arrondissements), with half its seats renewed every two years (Graziani, 2026). The voting qualification was lowered in 1848, but only a small fraction of adult men could vote until 1893. After a general strike, the constitutional revision of 1893 introduced universal male suffrage with plural voting and made voting compulsory. In 1899, Belgium became the first country to adopt list proportional representation for its national parliament; the system was first used in 1900. Equal male suffrage replaced plural voting in 1919, when elections also began to renew the entire Chamber. Women first voted in national elections in 1949 (Ahmed, 2013; Witte et al., 2009; Graziani, 2026).

Until the state reform of 1993, the Chamber and Senate shared legislative power on equal terms. We do not study the Senate’s proceedings. The Chamber grew with the population, reaching 212 members in 1949, and has had 150 members since 1995. It did not sit during most of the German occupations, from August 1914 to November 1918 and from May 1940 to September 1944.

For long periods, governments came from a single party family. After the early unionist cabinets, Liberal and Catholic governments alternated from 1847. Catholics then governed alone from 1884 to the First World War. Coalitions became the norm after 1918. Governments of national union included all three traditional families in 1918–1921, 1926–1927 and most of 1935–1939. The Christian democrats again governed alone in 1950–1954. Under a right established in the Constitution of 1831, ministers may address the Chamber whether or not they are members (Graziani, 2026).

The Chamber has kept a verbatim record of its sittings throughout the period. The record appeared in the official gazette, the *Moniteur belge*, until 1844 and then in the *Annales parlementaires*. For more than a century and a half, it was prepared from shorthand notes. Audio recordings replaced shorthand in 2000. Since 1999, each intervention has been numbered and accompanied by a summary in the other national language (Model, 2021; Graziani, 2026).

Sittings have been public since 1831. For most of the period, voters encountered the debates through newspapers belonging to the same pillars as the parties. French dominated nineteenth-century debates. Dutch speeches were almost absent before the mid-1890s, accounted for about a quarter of speeches by the late 1930s, and have been the majority since the 1980s (Graziani, 2026).

3 Data

The Belgian Chamber Debates dataset (Graziani, 2026) covers every plenary sitting from 1831 to 2025. The version used here contains 3,057,358 debate blocks, including 2,126,618 speeches. These blocks are segmented from OCR text of the *Moniteur belge* and *Annales parlementaires* and, from 2019, the Chamber’s own reports. Against hand-annotated excerpts, the segmentation rules achieve an F1 score of 89.1 per cent for block boundaries. Overall, 95.6 per cent of speeches are linked to a member or minister. Each speech records its language and the speaker’s party, district, gender and ministerial office on the sitting date. Online Appendix B details the sample,

preprocessing, and definitions of parties, regions and government status.

Sample. We select French or Dutch speech blocks from plenary sittings whose speakers were Chamber members on the sitting date. Following [Simola et al. \(2023\)](#), who exclude the Speaker and Deputy Speakers, we exclude turns by the chair. We also exclude collective interjections, clerks' text, documents read into the record, summaries in the other language and committee proceedings. Finally, we exclude speeches by ministers who were not Chamber members: senators and extra-parliamentary ministers have no Chamber district. Of the 1,625,933 plenary speeches linked to a member or minister, we retain the 1,567,306 delivered by Chamber members. Of these, 13.4 per cent are in Dutch.

Periods. We divide time into periods of about two years. Until 1919, half the Chamber was renewed every two years, so each legislature in the register lasts about two years and forms one period. From 1919, elections renewed the whole Chamber and legislatures lasted up to four years, or five from 2014. We divide legislatures lasting at least three years into two halves at mid-term. These periods correspond to the two-year Congresses in [Gentzkow et al. \(2019\)](#) and parliamentary years in [Simola et al. \(2025\)](#). The wars divide the legislatures elected before them. The sample contains 91 periods, from 1831–1833 to 2024–2025.

Phrases. Following [Gentzkow et al. \(2019\)](#), we remove interruptions in parentheses, replace symbols and punctuation with spaces, lowercase the text and remove stopwords. We then reduce words to stems using the Snowball stemmer for each language ([Porter, 1980, 2001](#)). We form bigrams from consecutive stems. We exclude bigrams containing a member's surname, a party acronym or name, an address to the chair or a month, along with a list of procedural phrases. As in [Gentzkow et al. \(2019\)](#), a phrase enters the vocabulary if it occurs at least 100 times overall, at least 10 times in one period, and in at least 10 distinct speaker-periods. The separate French and Dutch vocabularies contain 76,397 and 13,055 phrases, with 34,231,812 and 4,035,835 occurrences. For each language, we count each phrase by member and period. The analysis contains 14,234 speaker-periods and 2,895 members.

Parties, regions and government. We use the party labels listed for each legislature and group parties into families: Catholic and Christian democrat, Liberal, Socialist, Communist and radical left, Flemish nationalist, Francophone regionalist, Green, and other. After a family splits, each party belongs to one language community. Members who switch parties within a period are assigned to their party at the start of that period.

We reconstruct each government's composition from the register of ministers. A party is in government on a given day if one of its members holds ministerial office. We classify a member-period as governing if at least half the member's speeches were delivered while the party was in government. The province of the electoral district serves the same purpose as state in [Gentzkow et al. \(2019\)](#) and dialect region in [Simola et al. \(2023\)](#): it captures regional language differences and members' regional agendas.

Quality of the record. Four features of the source matter for the results. First, coverage is incomplete in 1832–1843, when we rely on digitized years of the *Moniteur*, and in 1992–1995, when much plenary business moved to a Central Commission whose proceedings are excluded. We shade these years in figures and exclude them from tables. Second, 74 per cent of speeches are linked to a member in the 1830s, compared with more than 92 per cent in every later decade (Online Appendix Figure D3).

Third, some speech blocks contain text in the other language. This occurs when short interventions are mislabeled, when speakers use both languages, or when the record inserts a translation within a speech block. From the interwar years, these translations include statements by rapporteurs and ministers submitting reports and bills. Phrases containing a function word from the other language account for 4 to 15 per cent of Dutch phrases in most periods from 1919. They account for less than 1.5 per cent of French phrases before 1999 and 2 to 7 per cent afterwards. Fourth, speech blocks in 1997–2007 often include roll-call formulas printed after a member’s turn (*Résultat du vote*, *Uitslag van de stemming*). These reach 700 per 100,000 French phrases in 1999–2003. Section 5.10 identifies the results affected by these problems.

4 Model and estimation

4.1 Partisanship measure

We divide parties into two groups: A , such as the Catholic family, and B , containing all other parties. Let c_{ijt} be the number of times speaker i uses phrase j in period t , and $m_{it} = \sum_j c_{ijt}$. The share of group P ’s phrases accounted for by phrase j is $q_{jt}^P = \sum_{i \in P_t} c_{ijt} / \sum_{i \in P_t} m_{it}$. Following Gentzkow et al. (2019), an observer who initially considers both groups equally likely updates the probability that the speaker belongs to A after hearing phrase j :

$$\rho_{jt} = \frac{q_{jt}^A}{q_{jt}^A + q_{jt}^B}. \quad (1)$$

We model speaker i ’s phrase counts as multinomial:

$$\mathbf{c}_{it} \sim MN\left(m_{it}, \mathbf{q}_t^{P_i}(\mathbf{x}_{it})\right), \quad (2)$$

with phrase-choice probabilities

$$q_{jt}^{P_i}(\mathbf{x}_{it}) = \frac{e^{u_{ijt}}}{\sum_k e^{u_{ikt}}}, \quad u_{ijt} = \alpha_{jt} + \mathbf{x}_{it}'\boldsymbol{\gamma}_j + \varphi_{jt}\mathbf{1}_{i \in A_t}, \quad (3)$$

Here, α_{jt} captures the phrase’s popularity in that period and φ_{jt} is the party effect. The controls in $\mathbf{x}_{it}$ are gender and the province of the electoral district, which may affect speech independently of partisanship. Their effects are constant over time, as are most covariate effects in Gentzkow et al. (2019).

Gentzkow et al. (2019) control for majority-party status, while Simola et al. (2025) control for government status. Our main specification omits a control for whether the speaker’s party is in government. In Belgium, government status closely follows party membership for long

periods. Catholics governed alone in 1884–1914 and 1950–1954, and Liberals in 1857–1870 and 1878–1884. A nearly unpenalized government coefficient that is constant over time cannot then be separately identified from the penalized party effects.

The estimates confirm this problem. Adding government status produces religious partisanship values of 0.64 to 0.74 in sixteen periods between 1868 and 1912, all under governments of a single family. These values lie far outside the range of all other specifications (Online Appendix Figure A2). In other periods, the estimates remain close to those without covariates. We instead measure the government–opposition divide directly in Section 5.3.¹

For characteristics x in period t , partisanship is the expected posterior probability assigned to the speaker’s actual group after one phrase, starting from equal prior probabilities:

$$\pi_t(x) = \frac{1}{2} q_t^A(x) \cdot \rho_t(x) + \frac{1}{2} q_t^B(x) \cdot (1 - \rho_t(x)), \quad (4)$$

We average this measure across speakers:

$$\pi_t = \frac{1}{|A_t \cup B_t|} \sum_{i \in A_t \cup B_t} \pi_t(x_{it}). \quad (5)$$

The measure is at least 0.5. It equals 0.5 when both groups use every phrase with the same probability.

4.2 Estimation

The vocabulary contains tens of thousands of phrases, most of which appear rarely in any one period. Estimating partisanship directly from observed frequencies therefore creates substantial finite-sample bias: a phrase used only once appears perfectly partisan (Gentzkow et al., 2019). Following Gentzkow et al. (2019) and Taddy (2015), we estimate phrase-choice probabilities with a multinomial logit and a lasso penalty on party effects. We use its Poisson approximation:

$$c_{ijt} \sim \text{Poisson}(\exp(\mu_{it} + u_{ijt})), \quad \mu_{it} = \log m_{it}. \quad (6)$$

This approximation allows us to estimate a separate regression for each phrase. For phrase j , we minimize

$$\frac{1}{N} \sum_t \sum_i [m_{it} e^{u_{ijt}} - c_{ijt} u_{ijt}] + \psi\left(\sum_t |\alpha_{jt}| + \|\gamma_j\|_1\right) + \lambda_j \sum_t |\varphi_{jt}|, \quad (7)$$

where N is the number of speaker-periods. The small penalty $\psi = 10^{-5}$ is the one Gentzkow et al. (2019) use to ensure convergence. As in their paper, we choose λ_j using the Bayesian Information Criterion (Schwarz, 1978). We evaluate 100 penalty values, starting at the smallest value that sets all φ_{jt} to zero.

All covariates are indicators. The likelihood therefore depends only on counts and exposures aggregated by period, group and covariate pattern, which simplifies estimation. Given γ_j , define group P ’s exposure as $e_t^P = \sum_{i \in P_t} m_{it} e^{x'_{it} \gamma_j}$ and its phrase count as c_{jt}^P . Also define $s_{jt} = c_{jt}^A + c_{jt}^B$,

¹Allowing the covariate effects to vary across six institutional periods leaves the results unchanged (Online Appendix Figure A11). Average religious partisanship above the random benchmark is 0.00104 in both specifications.

$\pi_t^0 = e_t^A / (e_t^A + e_t^B)$, $\nu = N\psi$ and $\kappa_j = N\lambda_j$. The fitted count for group A is

$$\hat{\mu}_{jt}^A = \begin{cases} c_{jt}^A - \kappa_j & \text{if } c_{jt}^A - \pi_t^0(s_{jt} + \nu) > \kappa_j, \\ c_{jt}^A + \kappa_j & \text{if } c_{jt}^A - \pi_t^0(s_{jt} + \nu) < -\kappa_j, \\ \pi_t^0(s_{jt} + \nu) & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases} \quad (8)$$

The fitted count for group B is $\hat{\mu}_{jt}^B = s_{jt} + \nu - \hat{\mu}_{jt}^A$. The corresponding coefficients are $\hat{\alpha}_{jt} = \log(\hat{\mu}_{jt}^B / e_t^B)$ and $\hat{\varphi}_{jt} = \log(\hat{\mu}_{jt}^A / e_t^A) - \hat{\alpha}_{jt}$. The lasso moves group A 's count towards its nonpartisan value by $N\lambda_j$. The penalty on α_{jt} adds $N\psi$ to the fitted total. We can therefore compute the BIC in closed form at every point on the penalty path. We estimate γ_j with proximal Newton steps, replacing $(\alpha_{jt}, \varphi_{jt})$ in the objective with their optimal values. We then choose λ_j again and repeat until the selected point on the path stops changing.

Two languages. We build separate French and Dutch vocabularies and estimate the model for each language. A speaker-period contributes its phrases in the relevant language. After the Catholic (1968), Liberal (1972) and Socialist (1978) families split, members of these families enter only the estimation for their own language community. This ensures that we compare parties speaking the same language. Before the splits, the province control accounts for differences between Flemish and Walloon members within a party. Period t 's partisanship is the weighted average of both languages:

$$\pi_t = \sum_{\ell \in \{\text{fr}, \text{nl}\}} w_{\ell t} \pi_{\ell t}, \quad (9)$$

The weights $w_{\ell t}$ are each language's share of the phrases spoken by the two groups. We include a language only if each group has at least 10 speakers in it. We include a period only if each group has at least 20 speakers overall, or 15 in pairwise comparisons. [Simola et al. \(2023\)](#) use a threshold of 30. Our lower threshold reflects the Chamber's size: it had 102 to 152 members before 1912, the Socialists entered with 28 members in 1894, and each party belongs to only one language group after the national parties split.

Levels are not comparable across languages. The Dutch vocabulary is a fifth the size of the French vocabulary. With fewer phrases, each phrase conveys more information about the speaker. We therefore compare the timing of the two series rather than their levels.

4.3 Inference

We construct confidence intervals by subsampling ([Politis et al., 1999](#); [Gentzkow et al., 2019](#)). For each period, we draw 100 subsamples, each containing 20 per cent of speakers selected without replacement. We estimate the series in each subsample k . The intervals are

$$\left[0.5 + \exp\left(\log(\hat{\pi}_t - 0.5) - Q_t^{(90)} / \sqrt{N_t}\right), 0.5 + \exp\left(\log(\hat{\pi}_t - 0.5) - Q_t^{(10)} / \sqrt{N_t}\right) \right], \quad (10)$$

where $Q_t^{(p)}$ is the p -th percentile of $Q_{kt} = \sqrt{N_{kt}} [\log(\hat{\pi}_{t,k} - 0.5) - \log(\bar{\pi}_t - 0.5)]$. Here, $\bar{\pi}_t$ is the subsample average of $\hat{\pi}_{t,k}$ and N_t is the number of speakers. The intervals have 80 per cent nominal coverage.

We also estimate each series after randomly reassigning group labels within each period, keeping group shares fixed (Gentzkow et al., 2019). This benchmark measures the partisanship the estimator detects when labels have no systematic relationship with speech. In our data, it is not flat at 0.5. With groups of a few dozen speakers, it usually lies between 0.500 and 0.503 and rises when one group is small. Because each random series uses a single permutation, it also reflects noise from that draw. For example, excluding the radical right leaves the real 1950s series unchanged, but changes the 1954–1956 random estimate from 0.5022 to 0.5053. We report net partisanship as $\hat{\pi}_t - \hat{\pi}_t^{\text{random}}$. We call a period significant when the real series’ lower confidence bound exceeds the random series’ upper bound.

4.4 Phrase partisanship

The partisanship of phrase j at x measures how removing it changes the expected posterior probability assigned to group A (Gentzkow et al., 2019):

$$\zeta_{jt}(x) = 0.5 - 0.5 \sum_{k \neq j} \left(\frac{q_{kt}^A(x)}{1 - q_{jt}^A(x)} + \frac{q_{kt}^B(x)}{1 - q_{jt}^B(x)} \right) \rho_{kt}(x). \quad (11)$$

Positive values identify phrases associated with group A ; negative values identify phrases associated with group B . We average across the period’s speakers to obtain ζ_{jt} .

4.5 OCR noise

OCR errors turn some phrase occurrences into strings outside the vocabulary. Since these errors affect all parties, they tend to blur party differences in older volumes (Hill and Hengchen, 2019; van Strien et al., 2020). We assess this effect by adding simulated OCR errors to the born-digital reports of 2019–2025: common character confusions, deletions, insertions, and split or merged words. We process the altered text with the same pipeline and vocabulary, then re-estimate partisanship. The ratio $(\pi_t^{\text{noisy}} - 0.5) / (\pi_t^{\text{clean}} - 0.5)$ measures attenuation at each character error rate.

5 Results

We first study two cleavages: Catholics versus other parties (Section 5.1) and the left versus other parties (Section 5.2). Simola et al. (2023) classify parties as left when their names refer to the left, socialism or workers. We similarly group the Socialist family—the Belgian Workers’ Party and its successors—with the Communist and radical left family. All other parties form the comparison group. Section 5.3 studies government versus opposition. Section 5.4 compares pairs of families, women and men, and each current party with the rest. Section 5.5 compares Flemish and Walloon members before the national parties split. Each figure shows both the real series and a benchmark based on randomly permuted group labels.

Table 1 summarizes the main series, and Table 2 reports decade averages. Three patterns stand out. First, every series covering the 1950s reaches its highest significant value in that

Table 1: The main series

Series	Years	Periods	All periods		Highest period			Last
			Signif. (%)	Mean	Period	Net	One minute	Net
Catholic vs other parties	1843–2025	81	46	0.81	1954–1956	3.89	0.64	0.57
Left vs other parties	1894–2025	58	60	1.30	1932–1934	4.59	0.67	1.95
Government vs opposition	1845–2025	77	65	1.23	1934–1936	4.70	0.66	1.24
Catholic vs Liberal	1843–2025	81	26	0.42	1954–1956	2.99		-0.36
Catholic vs Socialist	1894–2025	58	53	1.33	1956–1958	4.97		0.74
Liberal vs Socialist	1894–2025	56	32	0.97	1912–1914	4.70		0.74
Multiparty index	1843–2025	83	57	1.09	1896–1898	4.81		4.45
Women vs men	1974–2025	18	61	2.15	1999–2001	7.37		0.65

Notes: Net partisanship: real minus random series, multiplied by 1,000. Periods: periods when the series is defined; periods with low coverage of the sittings (1832–1843, 1992–1995) are excluded. Signif.: share of the periods when the lower bound of the 80 per cent interval of the real series lies above the upper bound of the interval of the random series. Highest period: the significant period with the highest net partisanship. One minute: probability of guessing a member’s group correctly after one minute of speech (33 phrases) in that period, computed from the real series (Section 5.8). Pairs and multiparty index without covariates. The multiparty index is estimated with the language rule for every party (Section 5.4). Produced by code/python/20_main_tables.py.

decade, except the Liberal–Socialist comparison, which peaks under the centre-right governments of 1983–1985. In 1956–1958, one minute of speech allows an observer to identify a member’s religious or left–right group correctly with probability 0.69, and their government–opposition group with probability 0.73.

Second, the government–opposition and left–right series exceed their random benchmarks significantly in about two thirds of periods. The corresponding shares are 59 per cent for Catholics versus Socialists, half for the religious series and a quarter for Catholics versus Liberals. Third, the religious, left–right and pairwise series are low after 1990. Decade averages range from -1.6 to 1.3 per thousand, except for religious partisanship in the 2000s, which is inflated by roll-call formulas. Government–opposition differences (1.2–2.5) and differences between women and men (0.9–2.6) persist, while the multiparty index rises in the 2020s.

5.1 Religious partisanship

Figure 1 compares the Catholic family with other parties, controlling for gender and province. Three features stand out. First, partisanship is low under census suffrage. Before 1846, the real series is significant in only two of eight periods, and net partisanship ranges from -0.0010 to 0.0007 . This fits a period of loose groupings of notables and unionist governments. From 1846, when the Liberals organize as a party, net partisanship averages 0.0006 . The real series exceeds the random benchmark in 8 of the 23 periods to 1893. The highest values under census suffrage occur during and after the first school war: 0.0021 in 1880–1882 and 0.0018 in 1884–1886. These peaks appear only after controlling for province. Without covariates, the values are no higher than in the 1870s (Online Appendix Figure A2).

Second, partisanship rises under plural voting. It ranges from 0.0008 to 0.0022 in every period from 1894 to 1914, and all these periods are significant. This rise coincides with the Socialists’ entry into the Chamber, joining the Liberals in group *B*. It does not appear in the Catholic–Liberal comparison (Section 5.4). Third, the 1950s dominate the series. After values close to zero under national-union governments and the coalitions of the 1920s, partisanship is

Table 2: Net partisanship by decade

Decade	Religious	Left-right	Gov.-opp.	Cath.-Lib.	Cath.-Soc.	Lib.-Soc.	Multiparty	Women-men
1840s	0.6		-0.2	0.8			0.3	
1850s	0.2		0.5	0.5 [†]			0.2	
1860s	0.1		0.3	0.4			0.3	
1870s	0.9 [†]		1.2 [†]	1.2 [†]			0.9 [†]	
1880s	1.1		1.0 [†]	1.3 [†]			1.1 [†]	
1890s	1.3 [†]	2.9 [†]	1.0 [†]	1.3	4.2 [†]	3.4	2.6 [†]	
1900s	1.4 [†]	2.0 [†]	1.3 [†]	0.3 [†]	3.2 [†]	3.0 [†]	1.7 [†]	
1910s	0.9 [†]	1.4 [†]	1.4 [†]	0.6	2.4 [†]	3.3 [†]	1.7 [†]	
1920s	0.2	1.8 [†]	1.5 [†]	0.0	1.7 [†]	1.1	1.2 [†]	
1930s	1.2 [†]	2.1 [†]	3.0 [†]	0.6	1.5 [†]	1.7	2.5 [†]	
1940s	1.0 [†]	0.7 [†]	1.0 [†]	0.7	0.9 [†]	1.0	0.7 [†]	
1950s	2.9 [†]	2.3 [†]	2.8 [†]	1.7	3.1 [†]	0.3	2.0 [†]	
1960s	0.3	0.5	-0.1	-0.8	0.7 [†]	-0.9	0.0	
1970s	0.5	0.7 [†]	0.7 [†]	0.1	0.3	1.1 [†]	0.1	3.8
1980s	0.5	0.8 [†]	0.6	0.2	0.2	1.1	0.7	-0.4
1990s	0.7 [†]	0.8	1.1 [†]	0.5	0.1	1.2	0.5	2.0
2000s	1.0	0.6	2.1 [†]	-0.1	0.8	-0.9	1.3 [†]	3.4 [†]
2010s	-0.7	0.3	1.1 [†]	-1.5	-0.6	-0.2	-0.4	1.7 [†]
2020s	0.6	1.0 [†]	2.1 [†]	-0.4	-0.4	0.8	2.6 [†]	1.9 [†]

Notes: Average net partisanship (real minus random series, multiplied by 1,000) of the periods whose middle year falls in the decade; periods with low coverage of the sittings are excluded. [†]: the real series is significantly above the random one in at least half of the periods of the decade. Religious: Catholic family vs other parties; left-right: Socialist and Communist families vs other parties; government-opposition: members of the parties in government vs the others; pairs and multiparty index as in Table 1. The religious and government-opposition values of 1999–2005 are inflated by procedural text (Section 5.10).

moderate in the 1930s and 1940s (0.0005–0.0020). It then rises to 0.0058 in 1950–1952 and stays between 0.0055 and 0.0063 until 1958, about four times the average under plural voting. In 1958–1961, the School Pact period, it falls to 0.0007 and remains close to zero in the 1960s. Net partisanship reaches its highest level in 1954–1956, when the real series is 0.5058.

After the Christian democrats split in 1968, the series is low and noisy. It is significant in seven of 25 periods. Six have net values between 0.0009 and 0.0023, including 0.0023 in 1969–1971, 0.0021 in 1981–1983 and 0.0009 in 1989–1991. The last period includes the abortion law, which passed against the votes of the Christian democrats despite their being in government.

The series peaks again at 0.0063 in 2001–2003. Although comparable in size to the 1950s peak, this does not indicate a return of the religious cleavage under the governments of 1999–2007, which excluded Christian democrats. It comes from French speech, where the Christian-democratic group had only 10 or 11 speakers. Its most partisan phrases are roll-call formulas appended to Christian-democratic members’ speeches (Section 5.10). From 2007 to 2019, the real series never significantly exceeds the random benchmark. In 2019–2024, the Christian democrats have fewer than 20 speakers across both languages, so the series is undefined. Net partisanship is 0.0006 in 2024–2025. Across the full sample, the real series’ lower confidence bound exceeds the random series’ upper bound in 42.7 per cent of periods.

The timing is robust across specifications (Online Appendix A). Without covariates, the series has the same overall shape, but a lower 1950s peak and no 1880s peak. Allowing covariate effects to vary by institutional period leaves the average and the 1950s peak unchanged, although individual periods move: 1894–1896 falls to 0.0003. Changing ψ to 10^{-4} or 10^{-6} alters levels

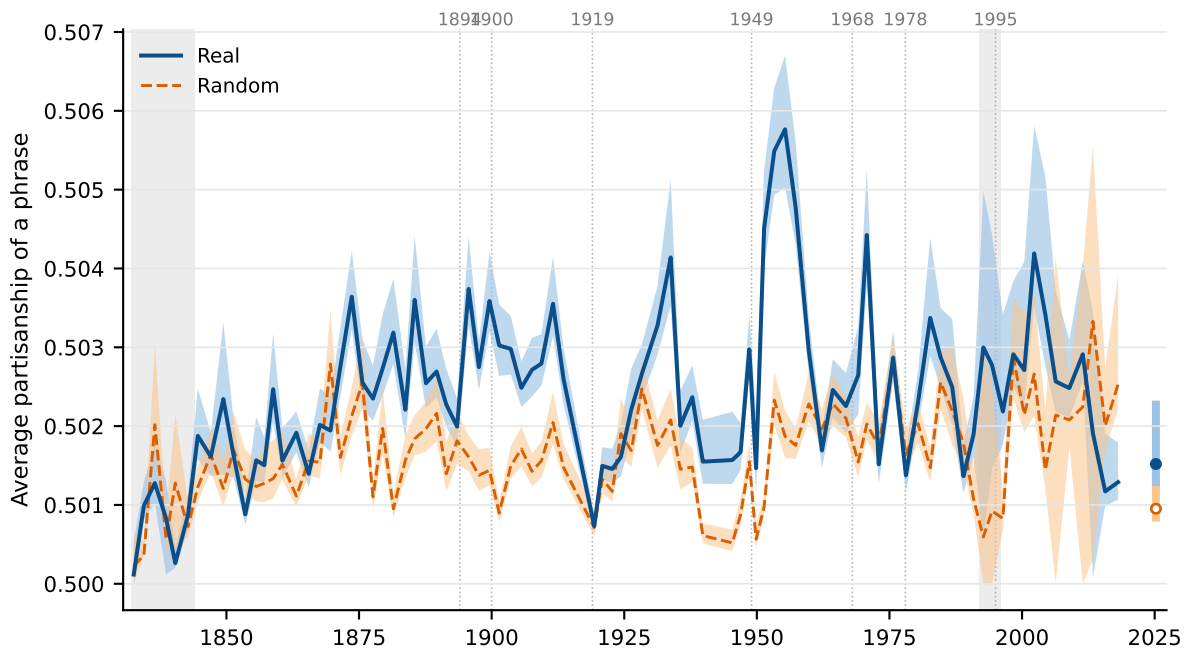


Figure 1: Religious partisanship: Catholic family vs other parties, controls for gender and province

Notes: Average partisanship of a phrase, $\hat{\pi}_t$, by period of about two years; French and Dutch averaged by their share of speech. Controls for gender and the province of the district. Real: actual party labels; random: labels assigned at random among the speakers of each period, holding group shares fixed. Shaded areas: subsampling confidence intervals with 80 per cent nominal coverage, centred at the estimate. Dotted lines: the reforms of 1894, 1900, 1919, 1949, 1968, 1978 and 1995. Grey bands: years when the source covers the sittings only in part (1832–1843, before the *Annales parlementaires*, and 1992–1995, when much of the plenary business went to a Central Commission). The series breaks when a group has fewer than 20 speakers in total; a language enters the average when each group has at least 10 speakers in it. The values of 1999–2005 are affected by procedural text in the record (Section 5.10).

but not peak timing (Figure A7). Excluding speeches delivered by members acting as ministers raises the 1950s peak to 0.0083 (Figure A10). Excluding the populist radical right changes the real series by less than 0.0001 before 1985 and at most 0.0012 afterwards (Figure A4).

The series based on empirical phrase-choice probabilities, the plug-in estimator of Gentzkow et al. (2019), moves with its random benchmark (Figure A5). This shows that finite-sample bias dominates without penalization. The leave-out estimator of Gentzkow et al. (2019) confirms the ranking of eras (Figure A9). It is positive but rarely significant in most nineteenth-century periods, higher under plural voting with all ten periods significant, and highest in 1954–1958. Both language components are significant throughout the 1950s (Figure A8): 0.0035–0.0043 in French and 0.012–0.013 in Dutch. These are each language’s highest significant values. French values in 1999–2003 are higher but not significant. The difference in levels reflects vocabulary size.

5.1.1 Schools, the Royal Question and the language of governing

Simola et al. (2025) link Finland’s high partisanship in the 1970s to the extreme left’s phrases about the Soviet Union. In Belgium, schools and the Royal Question play similar roles. Figure 12 compares the share of phrases about schools and education with religious partisanship. School phrases peak during the conflicts identified by historians: 3.3 per cent of all phrases in 1878–1880, when the Liberal school law was debated; 4.0 per cent in 1884–1886, when the Catholic majority replaced it; 2.9 per cent in 1912–1914, during the compulsory education law; and 2.5 per cent in 1954–1956, during the second school war. Yet religious partisanship reaches its highest levels only in the last episode.

Figure 13 suggests why. During the first school war, both sides discussed schools roughly in proportion to their numbers. Catholic members spoke 52 per cent of school phrases in 1878–1880, while accounting for 45 per cent of speakers and 43 per cent of seats. They spoke 49 per cent in 1880–1884, when they represented 46–49 per cent of speakers. The main difference was their choice of school phrases. The Liberal government and majority referred to *écoles communales*, the communal schools covered by the 1879 law. The Catholic opposition referred to *instruction publique* and the new *ministre de l’instruction publique*. After 1884, their roles reversed, and the Liberal opposition used *écoles communales*, *écoles adoptées* and *pères de famille* (Online Appendix C). Phrase frequencies capture this difference only partly because most debate vocabulary was shared.

The Royal Question leaves a clearer trace. Related phrases reach their highest share in 1949–1950. Catholic members used only 18 per cent of them, despite representing 46 per cent of speakers and half the seats (Online Appendix Figure A15).

Table 8 reports the five French phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group, selecting one period every ten years, as Gentzkow et al. (2019) do for selected Congresses. It also reports predicted counts per 100,000 phrases. Online Appendix C lists phrases for every period and both languages. Figure A13 tracks the most partisan phrases of each decade.

Three kinds of phrases recur. The first concerns the cleavages themselves: secondary and religious education for Catholics in 1848–1850 (*enseignement moyen*, *enseignement religieux*); *classe ouvrière* and *suffrage universel* for other parties after 1894; family allowances and old-age pensions

for Catholics in the 1930s; *consultation populaire* for their opponents in 1949–1950; *loi unique* in 1958–1961; and development cooperation for Christian democrats from 1969.

The second reflects governing and opposition roles. Formulas for submitting bills and reports (*j'ai l'honneur de déposer sur le bureau de la Chambre, section centrale; ter tafel neerleggen* in Dutch) are often among the governing side's most partisan phrases. Phrases addressing ministers (*ministre de l'intérieur, premier ministre*) often distinguish the opposition. In the 1950s, leading Dutch phrases include these submission formulas, used by the Christian-democratic majority in 1950–1954 and the Socialist–Liberal majority in 1954–1958. They also concern military service length, technical and public education, and large families.

Dutch versions of the same formulas (*legt ter tafel het verslag over het wetsontwerp*) also lead the French series in these years. The record prints them within the rapporteur's or minister's French speech (Online Appendix C). In 1950–1954, when Catholics governed alone, phrases containing a Dutch function word account for 1.6–1.7 per cent of their French phrases, compared with 0.2–0.4 per cent for Liberals and Socialists. The ranking reverses in 1954–1958. In the leave-out estimates for 1949–1958, phrases containing a function word from the other language account for 30 per cent of religious partisanship in French and 18 per cent in Dutch. Their contribution in French is almost zero in other periods before 1995. Excluding them still leaves the 1950s as the leave-out series' peak (Online Appendix B). The third kind of phrase reflects noise in the record, discussed in Section 5.10.

5.2 Left–right partisanship

Figure 2 compares the left with other parties from 1894, when the Belgian Workers' Party entered the Chamber. The series exceeds its random benchmark in two thirds of periods. Net partisanship starts at 0.0037 in 1894–1896, its highest pre-war value, and averages 0.0021 until 1914. During these years, 28 to 40 Socialist members opposed Catholic-only governments. Their distinctive phrases concerned the working class, universal suffrage, the eight-hour day and industrial councils (*classe ouvrière, suffrage universel, huit heures, conseils de prud'hommes*).

Partisanship declines under national-union governments, then rises through the 1920s to 0.0045 in 1932–1934. These were the years of strikes, special powers for Catholic–Liberal governments and the Plan of Labour. The Socialists were in opposition, with *pleins pouvoirs* and *classe ouvrière* among their most partisan phrases. Partisanship falls to about 0.001 when the Socialists join tripartite governments in 1935–1939 and the governments of the Liberation.

The highest net value occurs in 1932–1934, at the end of a decade of high values (0.0025–0.0056). That decade includes Socialist opposition to Christian-democratic governments in 1950–1954 and Socialist–Liberal governments in 1954–1958. A final peak of 0.0044 in 1974–1977 coincides with Christian-democratic and Liberal governments that excluded Socialists. This peak comes entirely from Dutch speech; the French estimate is 0.0007 and not significant. French passages within blocks labeled Dutch partly drive it (Section 5.10). After 1981, net partisanship averages 0.0009, the lowest level in the series. It is significant again in the last two periods: 0.0014 in 2022–2024 and 0.0019 in 2024–2025.

Simola et al. (2025) show that the extreme left drives Finland's 1970s peak. We perform the same check by excluding the Communist and radical left family in Figure 11. Unlike in

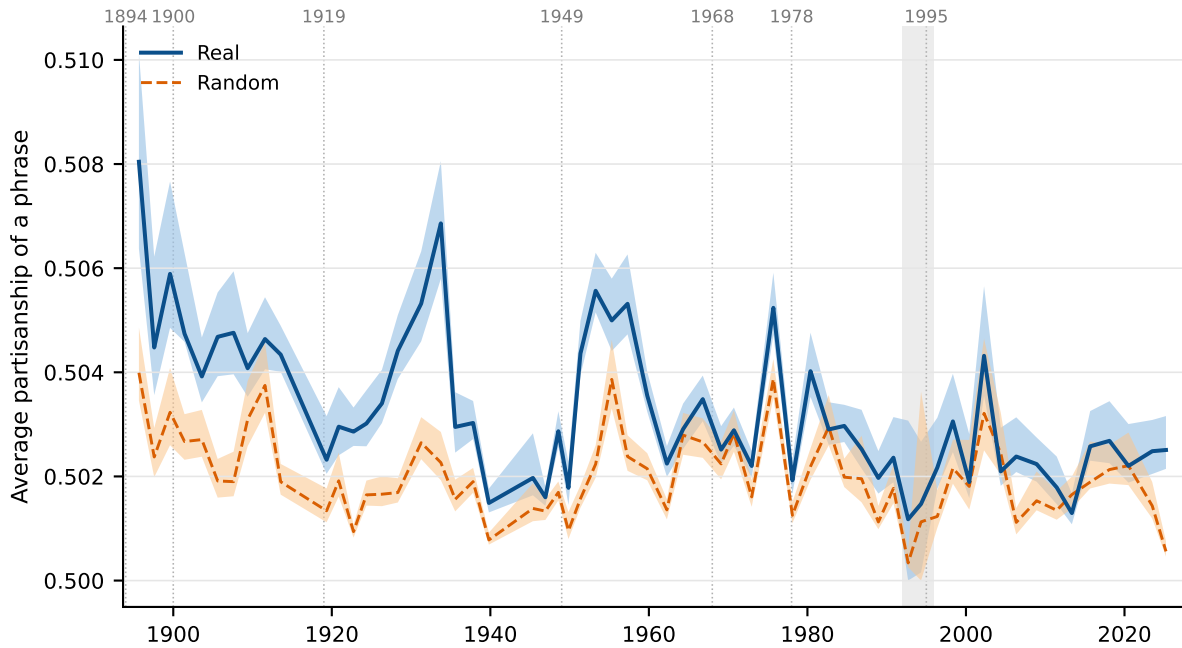


Figure 2: Left–right partisanship: Socialist and Communist families vs other parties, controls for gender and province

Notes: As Figure 1, from the first period with Socialist members (1894).

Finland, the 1894 peak and the highest 1950s values remain unchanged or rise. The highest value becomes 0.0068 in 1956–1958, although 1950–1952 falls from 0.0041 to 0.0028. The peaks in 1932–1934 and 1974–1977 fall from 0.0045 and 0.0044 to 0.0031 and 0.0022. In 2024–2025, following PVDA-PTB’s growth, the left excluding the radical left is more distinct from other parties (0.0033) than the whole left (0.0019).

Online Appendix Figure A4 excludes the populist radical right: Rex, Vlaams Blok and Vlaams Belang, Front National and Parti Populaire. This follows Simola et al. (2025)’s analysis excluding Finland’s Rural Party. Peak timing is unchanged. Controlling for government status lowers the series in most periods but raises the 1974–1977 peak (Online Appendix Figure A3).

5.3 Government and opposition

Figure 3 compares members of governing and opposition parties, controlling for gender and province. Belgium had parliamentary government from 1831, unlike Finland, where government became responsible to parliament only after 1917. Our series therefore spans the full period, except eleven periods when almost all members belonged to governing parties. These cover the unionist and mixed cabinets of 1831–1845, except 1839–1841, and 1854–1857, and the national-union governments of 1918–1921 and 1925–1927.

The series exceeds its random benchmark in two thirds of periods. Its institutional-period averages (Table 3) rise from 0.0006 under census suffrage to 0.0015 under plural voting and 0.0025 under equal male suffrage. They remain at 0.0024 in the post-war unitary state and 0.0020 in the federal era. Only during the state-reform decades do they fall, to 0.0013.

The peaks coincide with those of the religious and left–right series. Under census suffrage,

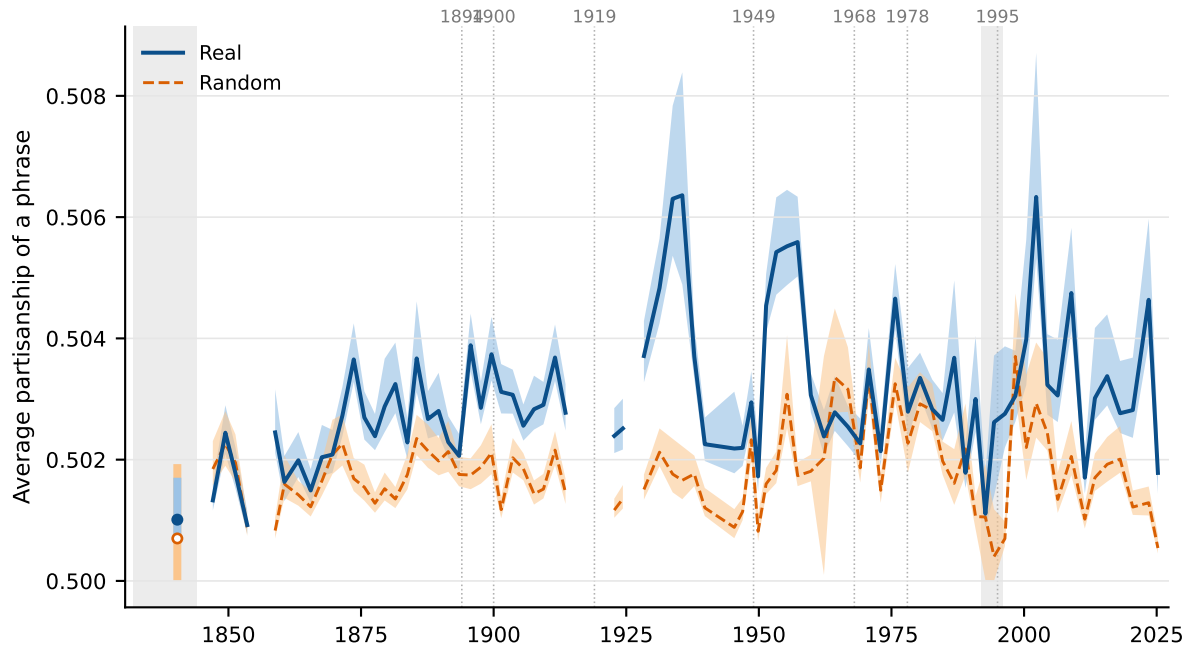


Figure 3: Government–opposition partisanship, controls for gender and province

Notes: Group A: members of the parties in government; group B: members of the parties in opposition. A member-period is in government if at least half of the member’s speeches were delivered while the party was in government. Gaps: periods when the opposition had fewer than 20 speakers (unionist and national-union governments). Otherwise as Figure 1.

the highest values occur in 1872–1874 (0.0020) and during the first school war (0.0019 in 1880–1882). Net partisanship reaches 0.0047 in 1932–1934 and 0.0051 in 1934–1936. In the 1950s, it ranges from 0.0049 to 0.0076 and peaks in 1934–1936, when the real series is 0.5064. During these decades, the cleavages aligned with government status. Socialists opposed Catholic–Liberal governments in the early 1930s and Christian-democratic governments in 1950–1954. Christian democrats then opposed the Socialist–Liberal government of 1954–1958.

After 1960, these divisions no longer align, and the series separate. Under the centre-right governments of 1981–1987, which used special powers, government–opposition partisanship is significant at 0.0014–0.0029. Religious partisanship is significant only in 1981–1983. In the federal era, government–opposition partisanship is significant in most periods and reaches 0.0041 in 2022–2024. The government then included Liberals, Socialists, Greens and Christian democrats, opposed by Flemish nationalists, the radical right and the radical left. Over the last two decades, the series averages 0.0017, compared with 0.0010 for left–right partisanship and zero for religious partisanship. As [Lauderdale and Herzog \(2016\)](#) find for the Irish Dáil, government versus opposition is the most persistent division in speech, even where other cleavages structure the party system.

The most partisan phrases reflect institutional roles. The governing side submits bills and reports (*projet de loi, honneur de déposer, section centrale*). The opposition addresses the prime minister and other ministers and invokes the Council of State (Online Appendix C). The unpenalized leave-out estimator depends differently on speech volume (Figure A9). It places government–opposition differences in the 2000s and 2020s at or above earlier peaks: net leave-out partisanship averages 0.025–0.027 after 1999, compared with 0.023 in the 1950s.

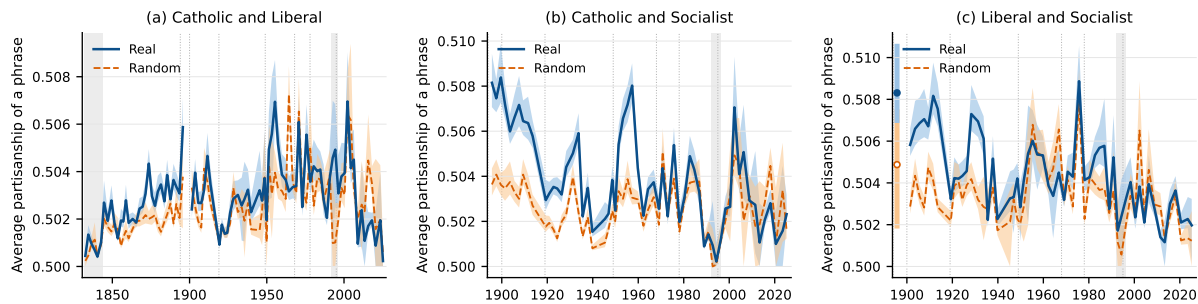


Figure 4: Partisanship, pairwise comparisons

Notes: Pairs of the Catholic, Liberal and Socialist families, without covariates; real and random series. Gaps: periods when one of the two families had fewer than 15 speakers. Otherwise as Figure 1.

5.4 Other comparisons between parties

Pairwise comparisons. Figure 4 compares the Catholic, Liberal and Socialist families in pairs, without covariates. This follows Simola et al. (2025), who compare four parties present throughout their sample. Levels and timing differ across the three pairs.

Catholics and Liberals, separated only by the religious cleavage, speak similarly for most of the period. Net partisanship averages 0.0005 and is significant in a quarter of periods. Its highest values occur during the second school war: 0.0040 and 0.0032 in 1954–1958, during the Socialist–Liberal government’s education laws. Other high values occur in 1999–2001 (0.0034), when Liberals govern without Christian democrats for the first time since 1958, and in 1974–1977 (0.0028). During the first school war, values are significant in every period from 1878 to 1886 but range only from 0.0009 to 0.0020.

Catholics and Socialists, divided by religion and class, are the most distant pair on average: 0.0016, compared with 0.0011 for Liberals and Socialists. Their net partisanship averages 0.0035 in 1894–1914, 0.0016 between the wars, and 0.0066 in 1950–1958. The interwar peak is 0.0036 in 1932–1934. The overall peak is 0.0093 in 1956–1958. After 1985, when the families usually govern together, the gap is close to zero.

Liberals and Socialists are as far apart as Catholics and Socialists before 1914, averaging 0.0034. They peak at 0.0047 in 1912–1914, after their electoral cartel’s defeat, and are close in the 1950s and 1960s. Their gap widens again under the centre-right governments of 1981–1987, when Liberals govern with Christian democrats and Socialists oppose them. It reaches the pair’s highest value, 0.0050, in 1983–1985. Their speech is similar under the governments uniting them after 1999, with net partisanship of -0.0028 in 2001–2003. Pairwise differences thus follow government status at least as closely as the underlying cleavages.

Multiparty partisanship. With more parties, the probability of identifying the right one falls mechanically. We therefore combine binary comparisons between all families present in a period: Catholics, Liberals, Socialists, Communists, Flemish nationalists, the populist radical right, Francophone regionalists and Greens. The multiparty index averages pairwise partisanship, weighting each pair by the product of the two families’ speaker counts. It measures expected partisanship between two randomly selected members of different families. Each comparison has a baseline of one half, so the index retains the other series’ scale without a mechanical

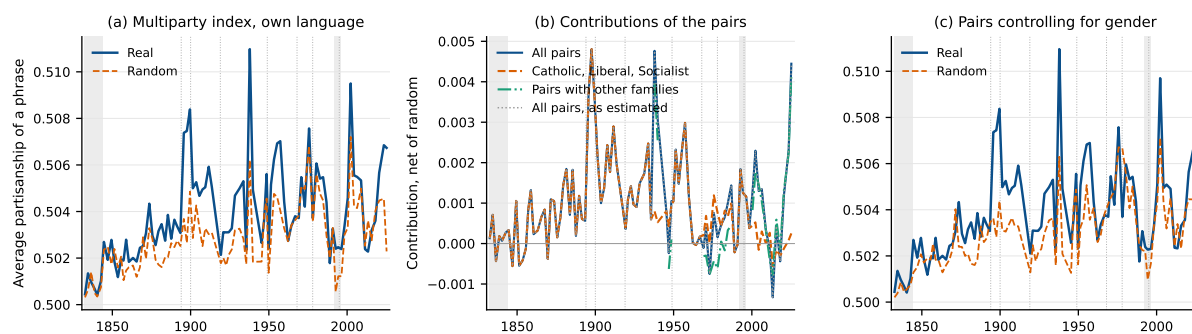


Figure 5: Multiparty partisanship

Notes: (a) Average pairwise partisanship of the party families present in each period, weighted by the product of their numbers of speakers; real and random series. From 1968, the pairs that involve the Flemish nationalists or the populist radical right are read in Dutch and those that involve the Francophone regionalists in French; the other pairs average the two languages. (b) Contribution of the pairs to the index, net of the random series: all pairs, pairs among the Catholic, Liberal and Socialist families, and pairs that involve the other families; dotted grey: the index as first estimated, with the two languages averaged for every pair. (a) and (b) without covariates; (c) the same index from pairs that control for gender. The province is not controlled for, because it is close to collinear with some of the smaller parties. Point estimates recombined from the language components of each pair (code/python/18_multiparty_ownlang.py); subsampling intervals are not shown.

dependence on party count. A family enters a period if it has at least 15 speakers.

From 1968, comparisons involving Flemish nationalists or the radical right use Dutch speech, while those involving Francophone regionalists use French. This extends the language rule applied to the national parties after their splits (Online Appendix B).

Figure 5 shows the multiparty index and the contributions of traditional-family pairs and pairs involving other families. It also reports an index based on comparisons controlling for gender. Until the 1960s, the index follows the traditional families. It rises when Socialists enter the Chamber (0.0036–0.0048 in 1894–1900) and peaks in the 1950s (0.0036–0.0061), mainly because of Catholic–Socialist differences. In 1936–1939, it reaches 0.0049, almost entirely because of pairs involving the two groups that entered in strength in 1936: the Flemish National League contributes 0.0038 and Rex 0.0004.

The index is low from the 1960s to 2019, with moderate values under the centre-right governments of 1981–1987 (0.0020–0.0025) and in 1999–2003 (0.0022–0.0025). It rises to 0.0036 in 2022–2024 and 0.0046 in 2024–2025. The rise comes mainly from Dutch-language pairs involving the radical right and Flemish nationalists: with Liberals in 2019–2024 and PVDA-PTB’s radical left in 2024–2025. In the latter period, radical-left pairs contribute 0.0021 of the total 0.0046. Pairs among the three traditional families, which have governed together in various combinations since the 1980s, contribute at most 0.0003. Controlling for gender gives almost identical results. Subsampling intervals for this version will be available after the pairs are re-estimated with the language rule (Section 5.10).

Women and men. Women entered the Chamber in 1929 but remained below a tenth of members until the 1990s. Their share has exceeded a third since the parity law of 2002 and two fifths since 2019 (Online Appendix Table D2). Figure 16 measures how well speech reveals a speaker’s gender. We control for party family, allowing family effects to vary across eras beginning in 1929, 1945, 1971, 1995 and 2007. This compares women with men of the same family. Each group

must have at least 15 speakers overall and 10 in a language, limiting the series to recent decades.

Since 1995, net partisanship between women and men averages 0.0018 and is significant in 8 of 14 periods. Without controls, it averages 0.0021 and is significant in 11. Gender differences are therefore similar in size to religious and left–right differences in the federal era. They are only slightly smaller within families than across them.

Today’s parties. Figure 17 traces each party elected in 2024 back to its foundation or its predecessors. It compares the party’s speech with that of other parties in its language group. Dutch-speaking parties are compared with Dutch-speaking parties, and French-speaking parties with French-speaking parties. PVDA-PTB, a national party, is compared across both languages. Table 5 reports legislature averages since 1995. The series have no covariates and require at least 8 speakers in the party’s language. The random benchmark is therefore especially important for smaller parties.

Before the national parties split, Dutch-speaking Christian democrats and Socialists are most distinct in 1952–1954 (0.0135 and 0.0132). Flemish nationalists are never significantly distinct before 1995. Since 1995, most parties remain within 0.003 of their random benchmark. The most distinct are PVDA-PTB in the two legislatures since it entered in strength (0.0041 and 0.0046), Vooruit in the legislature elected in 2024 (0.0042), and Vlaams Belang in 2007 and 2019 (0.0031 and 0.0024). MR in 1999 and Open VLD in 2019 also stand out. Ecolo falls below its random benchmark in most legislatures: a randomly selected group of French-speaking members of the same size speaks more distinctly than Ecolo members. Flemish nationalists, the largest party since 2010, remain close to their benchmark.

5.5 The linguistic cleavage before the split

Before the national parties split, Flemish and Walloon members of the same party shared a parliamentary group. Figure 15 compares their French speech up to 1967, before the first split, controlling for party family and gender. The grouping is Flanders versus Wallonia, based on the electoral district, rather than party. Net partisanship averages 0.0008 and is significant in 42 per cent of periods. Higher values occur in 1850–1861 (up to 0.0027), 1900–1910 (up to 0.0025) and the interwar years (up to 0.0027 in 1927–1929). Values are lower in the 1950s. There is no upward trend before the split: 1958–1965 values are no higher than those of the 1900s. The final period, 1965–1968, reaches 0.0032, but its most distinctive Flemish phrases are Dutch words inside blocks labeled French (*van het, mijnheer voorzitter*). We therefore do not interpret this value.

The phrases reveal what distinguished the regions (Online Appendix C). Most reflect regional economic interests. Flemish members discuss beet sugar, linen, the port of Ostend and West Flanders. Walloon members discuss the Société Générale, coal basins, the Charleroi canal, the canalization of the Meuse and, before 1914, industrial councils and working hours. In 1958–1961, the Congo distinguishes Flemish members and the European Coal and Steel Community distinguishes Walloon members.

Language policy appears among the most distinctive phrases mainly between the wars. Examples include the Dutch-language university of Ghent in the 1920s (*université de Gand*,

Table 3: Partisanship by institutional period

Institutional period	Catholic vs other	Left vs other	Government vs opposition
Census suffrage, 1831–1893	0.00059 (0.00015)		0.00064 (0.00018)
Plural voting, 1894–1918	0.00138 (0.00022)	0.00209 (0.00029)	0.00141 (0.00011)
Equal male suffrage, 1919–1944	0.00072 (0.00025)	0.00181 (0.00043)	0.00231 (0.00059)
Post-war unitary state, 1945–1970	0.00161 (0.00054)	0.00123 (0.00039)	0.00126 (0.00060)
State reforms, 1971–1994	0.00030 (0.00022)	0.00082 (0.00013)	0.00081 (0.00018)
Federal Chamber of 150, 1995–2025	0.00034 (0.00040)	0.00064 (0.00015)	0.00158 (0.00018)

Notes: Mean partisanship net of the random series, by institutional period; Newey–West standard errors (two lags) in parentheses. Periods with low coverage of the sittings (1832–1843, 1992–1995) are excluded.

université flamande), the language laws of 1932 (*seconde langue, loi de 1932*) and cultural councils in the late 1930s (*conseil culturel*). Within families, Flemish and Walloon Catholics speak similarly, with significant differences in only 4 of 42 periods (Online Appendix Figure A12). Socialists differ more, with significant gaps between the wars and in 1950–1952 and 1958–1961, during the Royal Question and the winter 1960–1961 general strike. Before the split, the linguistic cleavage therefore appears mainly through regional interests, particularly within the Socialist family.

5.6 Partisanship and institutional change

Table 3 reports average net partisanship by institutional period. Table 6 reports changes around each reform: plural voting, first used in 1894; proportional representation in 1900; equal male suffrage in 1919; women’s suffrage in 1949; party splits in 1968 and 1978; and the federal Chamber in 1995. Figure 18 plots the series alongside institutional-period averages.

Religious partisanship averages 0.00058 under census suffrage, 0.00143 under plural voting and 0.00081 under equal male suffrage. It reaches 0.00245 in the post-war unitary state, falls to 0.00046 during the state-reform decades and is 0.00112 in the federal era. The federal average includes the contaminated 1999–2005 values. Left–right partisanship stays between 0.0016 and 0.0021 from 1894 to 1994, then falls to 0.00096 in the federal era, with a small standard error.

The 1894 elections are followed by increases of 0.00138 in religious partisanship (standard error 0.00024) and 0.00118 in government–opposition partisanship. This agrees with [Graziani and Vanschoonbeek \(2026\)](#), who find that the partisan gap widened in the Chamber relative to the Senate after these elections. As discussed above, the rise mainly reflects Socialists joining group *B*, rather than a change between Catholics and Liberals. Proportional representation in 1900 is followed by small declines in all three series (–0.00043, –0.00082 and –0.00038), each within two standard errors. Equal male suffrage coincides with national-union governments and a decline in religious partisanship (–0.00087, standard error 0.00049).

The large increases around 1949 (0.0026–0.0033) reflect the Royal Question and the governments of 1950–1958, rather than women’s voting rights, which changed the Chamber’s composition little. Party splits are followed by small increases in religious partisanship. The

Socialist split in 1978 is followed by a decline in left-right partisanship (-0.00198 , standard error 0.00101).

Partisanship can change through member turnover or through changes in sitting members' speech. Figure 19 and Table 7 decompose changes in leave-out partisanship between consecutive periods. One component measures changes among members present in both periods; the other measures entry and exit. For religious partisanship, the components have opposite signs in five of six institutional periods. Across the full sample, changes among continuing members add to partisanship, while turnover reduces it. This is consistent with members becoming more distinctive as their careers progress and entrants speaking less distinctively than those they replace. We treat this as a career pattern rather than a response to specific reforms and do not interpret individual periods.

5.7 Partisanship and the economy

Most variation in partisanship occurs within institutional periods (Figure 18). Figure 6 compares the three series with GDP-per-capita growth averaged over each period. Across all periods, correlations are -0.11 for religious partisanship, -0.24 for left-right partisanship and -0.23 for government-opposition partisanship. Within the institutional periods in Table 3, which account for long-run changes, the correlations are stronger (panels c-e): -0.28 , -0.35 and -0.35 . The slopes per percentage point of growth are -0.00015 , -0.00017 and -0.00026 , with Newey-West standard errors of 0.00005 , 0.00005 and 0.00010 .

Partisanship is therefore higher when growth is slower than usual for that institutional period. Slow growth and high partisanship coincide during the depression in 1932–1934 and the slowdowns of 1952–1954 and 1956–1958. In 1929–1932, this pattern holds for religious and left-right partisanship, while government-opposition partisanship is at its institutional-period average. In 1936–1939, left-right and government-opposition partisanship are below their institutional-period averages. Reconstruction in 1919–1921 combines the fastest growth with low religious and left-right partisanship.

This relationship is descriptive. Growth and partisanship may share causes, and partisan conflict may itself slow growth. Reconstruction occurred under national-union governments. Religious and government-opposition partisanship remained high from the Royal Question to the School Pact (1950–1958), during both average and slow growth. Excluding the post-war unitary state gives within-period correlations of -0.28 , -0.24 and -0.26 . Evidence from elsewhere links economic hardship to political extremism in interwar Europe (de Bromhead et al., 2013), and shows increased polarization after financial crises but not ordinary recessions (Funke et al., 2016).

5.8 Magnitudes

Following Gentzkow et al. (2019), we compare parliaments using the probability of correctly identifying a member's party after one minute of speech, or about 33 phrases. Online Appendix Figure A1 shows the expected posterior probability as the number of phrases heard increases. Figure 7 shows each period's one-minute probability alongside values for other parliaments. For the US Congress, Gentzkow et al. (2019) report an increase from 57 per cent in 1989 to 73 per

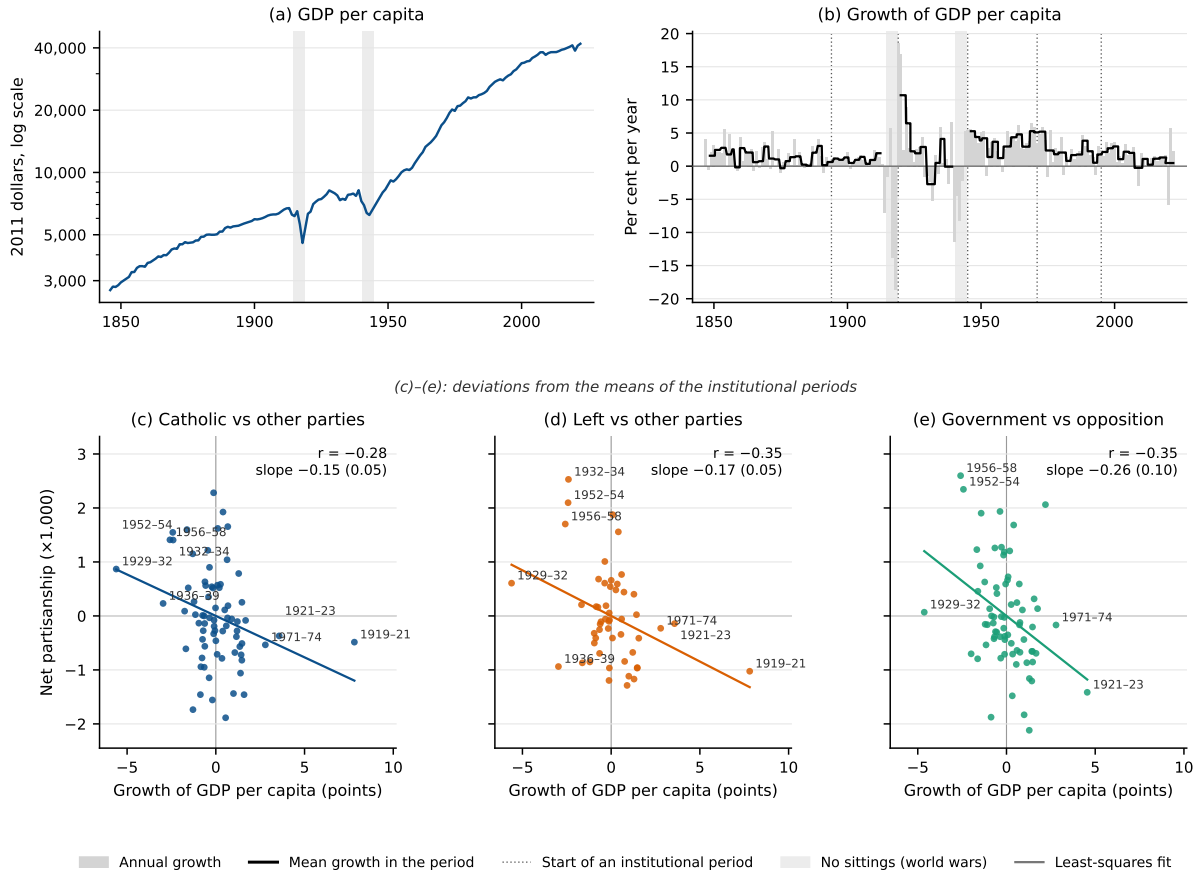


Figure 6: The Belgian economy and partisanship, 1846–2022

Notes: (a) GDP per capita in 2011 dollars, log scale. (b) Annual growth of GDP per capita, and its mean in each period of the partisanship series, with the years weighted by the days of the period that fall in them (periods that include a year of war or occupation left out); dotted lines: start of the institutional periods of Table 3 (1894, 1919, 1945, 1971, 1995). (c)–(e) Net partisanship (Figures 1, 2 and 3), multiplied by 1,000, against the mean growth of GDP per capita in the period, both as deviations from the means of the institutional period among the periods shown in the panel; line: least-squares fit; r : correlation; slope: change in partisanship ($\times 1,000$) per percentage point of growth, with fixed effects for the institutional periods, and its Newey–West standard error (two lags). Periods with low coverage of the sittings and the four periods that include a year of war or occupation (1912–1914, 1918–1919, 1939–1940, 1944–1946) are excluded; labels mark the periods whose growth is at least 2.3 points away from the mean of their institutional period. Shaded: no sittings of the Chamber (August 1914 to November 1918, May 1940 to September 1944). Source: Maddison Project Database 2023 (Bolt and van Zanden, 2024, 2025), from Gadisseur (1973) for 1846–1913, Carbonnelle (1959) for 1913–1950 and the Total Economy Database of the Conference Board for 2008–2022 (code/python/22_economy.py).

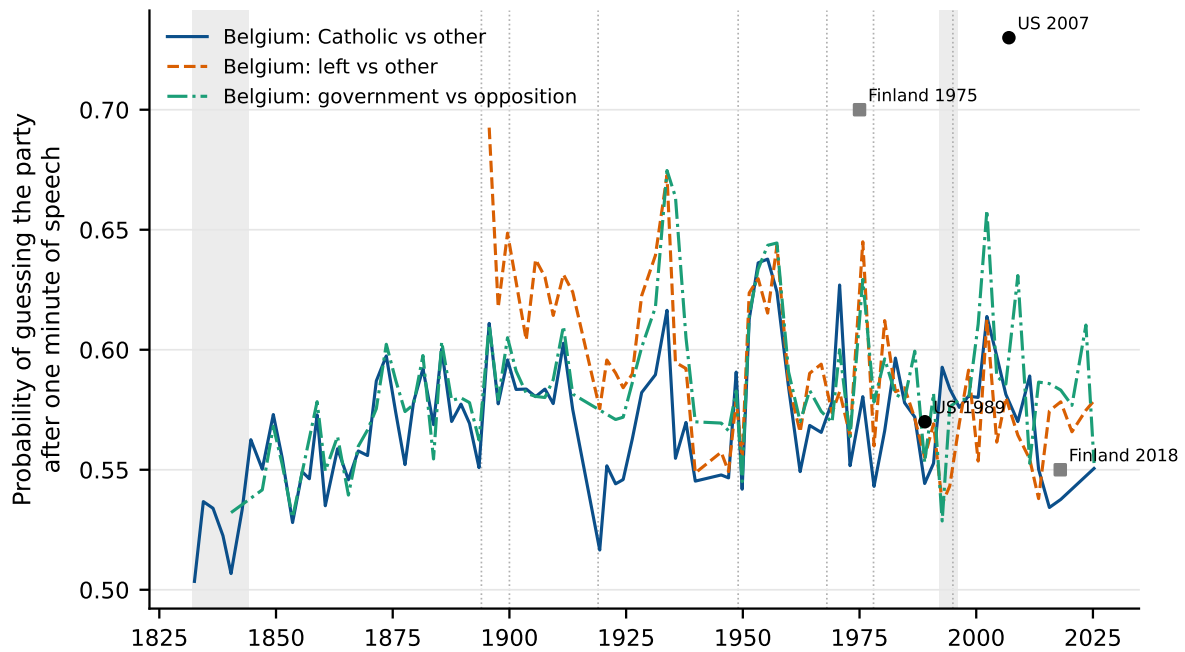


Figure 7: Probability of guessing the party after one minute of speech

Notes: Expected posterior probability assigned to the actual group after hearing 33 phrases (Gentzkow et al., 2019), by period, computed from the real series. Markers: values reported by Gentzkow et al. (2019) for the US Congress and by Simola et al. (2023) for Finland.

cent in 2007. For Finland’s Eduskunta, Simola et al. (2023) report about 55 per cent at the end of the sample and slightly below 70 per cent at the 1970s peak. For Norway’s Storting, Fiva et al. (2021) report 57 per cent in 1982–2000 and 61 per cent in 2001–2020 (Section 5.9).

In Belgium, the religious-group probability ranges from 53 to 61 per cent in 1846–1914, reaches 69.0 per cent in 1956–1958 and is 55.1 per cent in the last period. The left–right probability is 68 per cent in both 1894–1896 and 1932–1934, peaks at 69.3 per cent in 1894–1896, and is 57.9 per cent in the last period. The government–opposition probability reaches 67.5 per cent in 1932–1934, matching the US Congress in 2007.

These probabilities use the real series without subtracting finite-sample bias. A random-series value of 0.502 already implies a one-minute probability of about 0.55 in the absence of partisanship. With this qualification, Belgium’s 1950s peaks are comparable to Finland’s 1970s peak, and current Belgian levels to those of Finland and Norway in the 2010s.

Figure 14 compares religious partisanship with roll-call voting, following Gentzkow et al. (2019)’s US Congress analysis, and other Chamber features, following Simola et al. (2023)’s Finnish analysis. The Catholic–other-party gap in roll-call votes, measured with the party-unlikeness index of Rice (1925), is highest under plural voting (0.56–0.81 in 1898–1914) and in 1954–1956 (0.66). Speech and voting move together after 1945, with a correlation of 0.64 in 1945–1994. Before then, the relationship is weaker. The correlation is close to zero under census suffrage, and under plural voting the Chamber votes along party lines much more than it speaks along them. This also describes the US Congress in the late nineteenth century (Gentzkow et al., 2019). Median roll-call counts rise from about 25 per period in the nineteenth century to about 600 in the federal era. The effective number of parties rises from about two before 1894 to seven

or eight in the federal era. Online Appendix Figure A17 compares speech and voting for both main splits.

Online Appendix Figure A18 reports the OCR experiment. In the born-digital reports of 2019–2025, a character error rate of 5 per cent reduces left–right partisanship above 0.5 to 81 per cent of its clean-text value with covariates and 72 per cent without them. At 10 per cent error, these shares fall to 78 and 56 per cent. The religious series is undefined in most of these years. Historical volumes’ error rates have not yet been measured, so we cannot use these results to correct nineteenth-century levels. If historical error rates were about 5 per cent, those levels would be understated by 19 to 28 per cent. A correction of that size would not change their ranking relative to twentieth-century levels.

5.9 Comparison with other parliaments

Table 4 compares Belgium with available long-run measures of parliamentary speech partisanship. Three differences stand out.

First, the peaks occur at different times. Belgian partisanship peaks in the 1950s and remains low after the federal reforms. Elsewhere, peaks are recent or occur in the late twentieth century. US congressional partisanship is low and stable from 1873 to the early 1990s, then rises sharply (Gentzkow et al., 2019). Jensen et al. (2012) date an earlier increase in partisan language to the late 1960s. Finnish partisanship peaks in the mid-1970s and rises again from the 1990s to its 1930s level (Simola et al., 2025). In Norway’s Storting, it stays at 0.502–0.503 per word until about 2000, then rises to a peak in 2019 (Fiva et al., 2021).

In the British House of Commons, party-classifier accuracy falls to its lowest level during the Second World War, rises sharply from 1979 and peaks around 1987. It then declines, faster after Tony Blair becomes Labour leader in 1994, returning to mid-1960s levels (Peterson and Spirling, 2018). Belgium shares Britain’s low partisanship under broad coalitions and its decline in the 1990s. Unlike Finland, Norway and the United States, Belgium shows no recent return to historical peaks, except in the multiparty index of the 2020s.

Second, peak levels differ. Belgium’s peaks are among the highest measured with this method. In 1956–1958, the one-minute probability is 0.69 for religious and left–right groups, close to Finland’s 1970s peak of slightly below 0.70. The government–opposition probability of 0.73 matches the US Congress in 2007. In the federal era, Belgium’s left–right probability is 0.57 in 1982–2000 and 0.58 in 2001–2020. These are close to Norway’s bloc-identification probabilities of 0.57 and 0.61 in the same years (Fiva et al., 2021). These comparisons are approximate: Fiva et al. (2021) use single words rather than bigrams and compare two blocs, and none of these probabilities subtract finite-sample bias.

Third, different groups drive the peaks. Finland’s extreme left drives its 1970s peak (Simola et al., 2025). Belgium’s radical left contributes to the 1932–1934 and 1974–1977 peaks, but not to those of 1894 and the 1950s. Those peaks coincide with the government–opposition divide.

This divide recurs across studies of parliamentary systems. In the Irish Dáil, it is the main dimension of speech, with ministers more extreme than backbenchers (Lauderdale and Herzog, 2016). Classifiers trained on Canadian debates learn governing and opposition roles rather than ideology and fail when parties exchange roles (Hirst et al., 2014). In the House of Commons,

Table 4: Partisanship of parliamentary speech: Belgium and other parliaments

Study	Parliament	Measure	Highest values	Recent decades
This paper	Belgium, Chamber of Representatives, 1831–2025	GST, pairs of words; party families	1950s; one minute 0.69 (religious, left–right) and 0.73 (government–opposition)	Low; one minute 0.57–0.58 (left–right), 0.60 (government–opposition)
Simola et al. (2025)	Finland, Eduskunta, 1907–2018	GST, pairs of words; left vs right	Mid-1970s, driven by the extreme left; one minute somewhat below 0.70	Rising since the 1990s, to the level of the 1930s; one minute about 0.55
Gentzkow et al. (2019)	United States, Congress, 1873–2016	GST, pairs of words; Democrats vs Republicans	2000s; one minute 0.73 in 2007	Sharp rise from the early 1990s
Fiva et al. (2021)	Norway, Storting, 1981–2020	GST, single words; left vs right bloc	2019, 0.506 per word	Rising from about 2000; one minute 0.57 (1982–2000) and 0.61 (2001–2020)
Peterson and Spirling (2018)	United Kingdom, House of Commons, 1935–2013	Accuracy of party classifiers (about 0.65–0.76)	Around 1987	Falling after 1994, to the level of the mid-1960s
Wising et al. (2026)	Sweden, Riksdag, 1991–2023	Party classifiers	Similarity within the blocs highest in 2006–2014	Declining after the formal alliances

Notes: GST: the measure of [Gentzkow et al. \(2019\)](#), the expected posterior probability assigned to a speaker’s actual group after one phrase. One minute: probability of guessing a speaker’s group after one minute of speech (about 33 phrases), computed from the real series; for Belgium, Table 1 and Figure 7; for the United States, [Gentzkow et al. \(2019\)](#); for Finland, [Simola et al. \(2023\)](#); for Norway, [Fiva et al. \(2021\)](#). Levels are comparable only roughly across studies that differ in the unit of text, the groups compared, the covariates and the treatment of finite-sample bias.

the second dimension of party embeddings separates government from opposition ([Rheault and Cochrane, 2020](#)). Swedish parties within the same bloc spoke most similarly during the formal alliances of 2006–2014 ([Wising et al., 2026](#)). Government–opposition interests also explain roll-call voting better than policy positions in most parliamentary systems ([Hix and Noury, 2016](#)). Belgium extends this evidence over the long run. The government–opposition gap is measurable from the 1840s and is the most persistent division in speech. Pairwise gaps also follow whether families govern or oppose (Section 5.4).

5.10 Limits of the measure

Three limitations matter when comparing levels across eras.

The amount of speech. The penalized estimator retains a party coefficient only when the data support it. Speech volume has fallen: members use about 4,600 phrases per period in 1894–1918 and 1,300 in 1995–2025. Phrases with a non-zero religious coefficient fall from about 360 to about 100 per period (Online Appendix Figures A6 and D4). Part of the post-1960s decline may therefore reflect less speech per member rather than smaller differences in speech.

The unpenalized leave-out estimator does not decline in the same way (Figure A9). It places the last decade’s left–right gap close to or above its 1950s level, and the government–opposition gap in the 2000s and 2020s above earlier peaks. The latter result partly depends on the record. Excluding phrases containing a function word from the other language leaves only 2005–2007

clearly above earlier peaks, during the roll-call-formula years (Online Appendix B). Leave-out confidence intervals are also wide.

Role and substance. Partisanship captures differences in speech whatever their source. Governing members submit bills, while opposition members question ministers, so institutional roles generate distinctive phrases. Religious and left-right partisanship is high when these cleavages align with government status. The measure also misses conflicts conducted largely with shared vocabulary, as the first school war illustrates. Pairwise comparisons, the government–opposition series and dictionaries of school, royal, language and labour phrases help distinguish cleavages from roles. They do not remove role-related vocabulary from the series.

The record. Language labels and speech segmentation affect several results. After 2010, some blocks labeled French for Flemish nationalist and Vlaams Belang members are largely Dutch. In 2019–2024, about two thirds of their phrases contain a Dutch function word, although these members contribute at most one per cent of French phrases. The original multiparty index averaged both languages for these parties. Their French component was almost perfectly partisan, raising the index to 0.015–0.019 in 2019–2025. Restricting them to their own language reduces it to 0.002–0.005 (Figure 5).

In 1999–2007, speech blocks include appended roll-call formulas. These are concentrated among Christian-democratic members in 1999–2005, reaching 1,400 per 100,000 of their French phrases. They become the most partisan phrases of Christian democrats and the opposition in 2001–2003, inflating religious and government–opposition peaks. In Dutch-labeled blocks, French passages frequently distinguish the left in 1969–1981, especially the two or three Communist members (*monsieur le, le ministre, dans le*). These inflate Dutch left-right estimates, including the 1974–1977 leave-out estimate by 0.010.

Bilingual submission formulas also contribute to both language series in the 1950s (Section 5.1.1). Excluding them leaves the leave-out peak intact, but would likely lower the main series’ peak. Addressing these problems requires sentence-level language labels, removal of procedural formulas, and application of the language rule to every party associated with a language community. We must then re-estimate the series. Results depending on these affected periods remain provisional.

6 Topics: what the parties talk about and how

Parties may discuss different subjects or use different language to discuss the same subject. Gentzkow et al. (2019) separate these components. Between-topic partisanship treats topics as the choices and measures differences in the attention each group gives them. Within-topic partisanship is estimated separately from each topic’s phrases, then averaged using the topic’s share of speech as its weight.

The dictionaries in Section 5.1.1 suggest both types of difference. The first school war mainly reflects differences within a topic. Catholic and Liberal members discuss schools roughly in proportion to their numbers but use different school phrases. The Royal Question and social

issues instead reveal differences in topic attention. In 1949–1950, Catholics use only 18 per cent of Royal Question phrases while representing 46 per cent of speakers. In 1894–1914, Socialists represent 18–22 per cent of speakers but use 45–59 per cent of labour phrases. These account for 1.2–2.4 per cent of all phrases (Online Appendix Figure A16). Language policy is not primarily a Flemish subject within the national parties: between the wars, Flemish members use 37–51 per cent of its phrases and represent 45–48 per cent of speakers.

A full decomposition requires a topic label for each speech. A companion module assigns these in five steps, without fixing the topic list in advance. First, a language model freely labels agenda items from a sample of sittings drawn by half-legislature. It also converts keywords and EuroVoc descriptors from legislative files into labels. Second, these labels are grouped into broad categories, including a residual category for procedure. Third, the resulting codebook is applied to a sample of passages, some of which are checked by two human coders. Fourth, we train CamemBERT for French (Martin et al., 2020) and RobBERT for Dutch (Delobelle et al., 2020) on this sample. Fifth, the classifiers label every speech, allowing estimation of both components for the religious and left–right groupings (Figure 20, code/python/11_topics.py). In this version, the first step is under way.

The decomposition will answer three questions left open by the dictionaries. How much of the 1950s peak reflects different agendas, including the Royal Question and school laws, and how much reflects different language about the same bills? Does low partisanship in the federal era reflect a shared agenda or shared vocabulary? How much of the government–opposition gap is procedural? The residual category will include formulas for submitting bills and questioning ministers (Section 5.10).

7 Reactions, references and emotions

Partisanship measures differences in speech rather than how members treat each other. A second companion module examines the affective side of debates across the full period. It follows Peeters (2026), who study interactions between Dutch- and French-speaking federal parliament members since 1961. The module records three features. First, it detects stenographers’ descriptions of disorder (interruptions, noise, protests and uproar), approval and laughter, plus the chair’s calls to order and censures. Second, it detects references by name between members and whether they cross party families or language communities. Third, it will classify speakers’ emotions using the eight categories of Widmann and Wich (2023), and the tone towards referenced members as no attack, civil attack or uncivil attack (Muddiman, 2017). A language model codes a sample, and a multilingual classifier (Conneau et al., 2020) extends these labels to the corpus. The first two features require no model and cover the full period; the third is in preparation.

These preliminary results come from a test run. Online Appendix E explains the measures. Four patterns stand out. Disorder is highest in the 1950s and, before then, from the 1870s to the 1910s. Opposition speakers receive more disorder than governing speakers. Disorder moves with partisanship over the long run. Members refer to other party families more often than a random benchmark predicts but, from 1900, to the other language community less often.

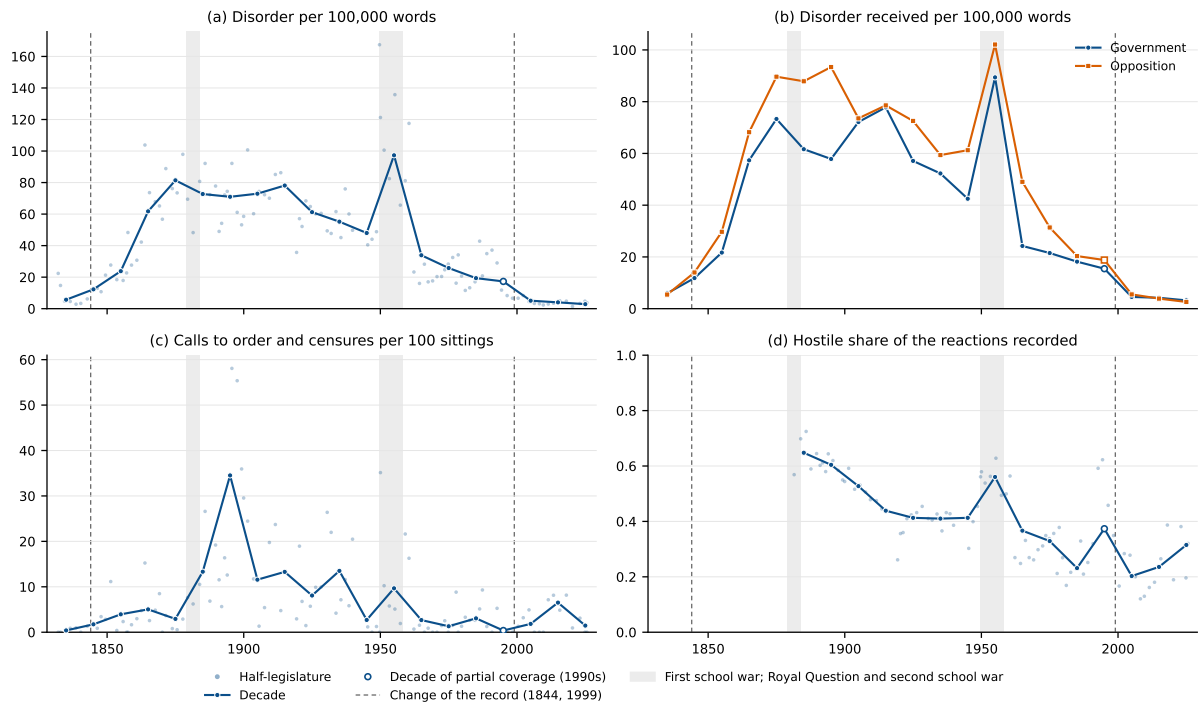


Figure 8: The temperature of the Chamber

Notes: (a) Stage directions recording disorder (interruptions, noise, protests, uproar) per 100,000 words spoken by members, the chair excluded. (b) The same, in the speeches of members of the governing parties, ministers included, and of the opposition. (c) Calls to order and censures by the chair per 100 sittings. (d) Hostile share of the reactions recorded by the stenographers, disorder / (disorder + approval), from 1880, since approval is rarely recorded between the 1840s and 1878. Points (panels a, c and d): half-legislatures; lines: decades; open markers: the 1990s, when much of the plenary business went to a Central Commission whose proceedings are not included (Section 3). Dashed lines: the record moves from the *Moniteur belge* to the *Annales parlementaires* (1844); interventions are numbered from 1999 and transcribed from audio recordings from October 2000, and the levels after 1999 are not comparable with the earlier ones. Shaded: first school war (1879–1884); Royal Question and second school war (1949–1958). Preliminary: test run of the emotions module (code/emotions); produced by code/python/21_emotions_link.py.

The temperature of the Chamber. Recorded disorder rises from 6 occurrences per 100,000 words spoken by members in the 1830s to 81 in the 1870s. It stays between 70 and 80 until the 1910s and falls to 48 in the 1940s (Figure 8a). It peaks at 97 in the 1950s. Within that decade, it reaches 121 in the second half of the short Royal Question legislature (1949–1950), and 167 in its first half, which contains only seven sittings. It reaches 136 in 1954–1956 during the second school war. After the School Pact, disorder rises again to 118 in 1959–1961, then falls to 34 in the 1960s and 17 in the 1990s. Levels after 1999 are not comparable because interventions became numbered and transcription later switched to recordings.

Calls to order and censures peak after the Socialists enter, at 55–58 per 100 sittings in 1894–1898. This is twice the earlier maximum of 27 in the 1884–1886 half-legislature. They rise again in the 2010s to 8 per 100 sittings (Figure 8c). We calculate the hostile share as disorder divided by disorder plus approval. We begin in 1880 because stenographers rarely recorded approval from the 1840s to 1878. The share falls from 0.65 in the 1880s to 0.41 in the 1920s–1940s, rises to 0.56 in the 1950s, and stays between 0.20 and 0.37 from the 1960s (Figure 8d).

Who received the disorder. Opposition speakers receive more disorder per word than governing-party speakers, including ministers, in every decade from the 1840s to the 2010s (Figure 8b).

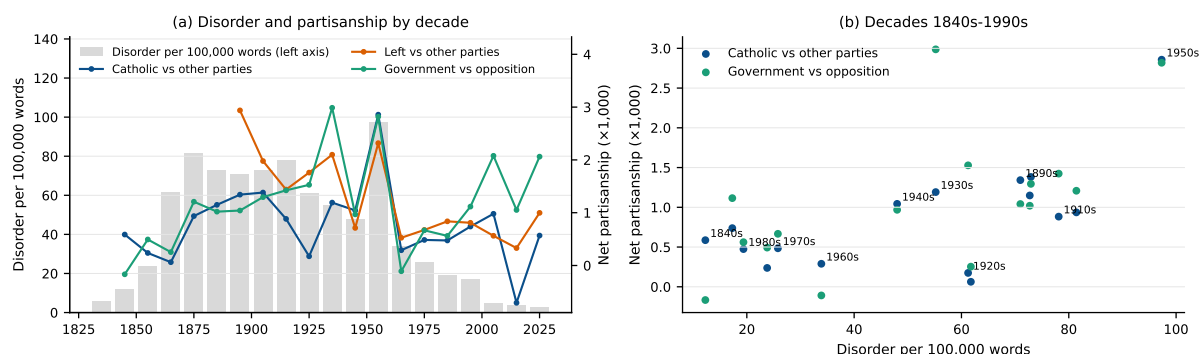


Figure 9: Disorder and partisanship

Notes: (a) Bars: stage directions recording disorder per 100,000 words spoken by members, by decade (left axis); lines: net partisanship of the religious, left-right and government–opposition series, multiplied by 1,000, averaged over the periods whose middle year falls in the decade (right axis). (b) The religious and government–opposition averages against disorder, decades 1840s–1990s. Periods with low coverage of the sittings are excluded. The comparison is made by decade because the emotions module divides the legislatures at different dates. After 1999 the levels of disorder are not comparable with the earlier ones (Figure 8). Preliminary; produced by `code/python/21_emotions_link.py`, which writes the correlations to `output/series/emotions_corr.csv`.

The ratio is 1.4–1.6 in the 1880s, 1890s, 1940s and 1970s, and about two in the 1960s: 49 versus 24 occurrences per 100,000 words. The gap is small in the 1900s, 1910s and 2010s. Studies of question time since 2010 also find that opposition members make most attacks (Poljak, 2023). Dutch speeches receive less disorder than French speeches until the 1980s, including 22 versus 43 per 100,000 words in the 1960s, and more from the 1990s.

Disorder and partisanship. Disorder and partisanship follow similar long-run patterns (Figure 9). Across decades from the 1840s to the 1990s, disorder per 100,000 words correlates with net religious partisanship (0.63) and government–opposition partisanship (0.60). From the 1890s, it also correlates with left–right partisanship (0.78) and Catholic–Socialist differences (0.88). Both disorder and religious partisanship peak in the 1950s. Excluding that decade gives correlations of 0.49, 0.48, 0.75 and 0.88.

The measures do not move together everywhere. Disorder in the 1870s–1910s is about three quarters to four fifths of its 1950s level, but religious partisanship is less than half as high. Conflicts over schools and voting rights were loud, yet both sides used largely shared vocabulary (Section 5.1.1). Disorder also rises after the School Pact until 1961, even though religious partisanship has already fallen sharply.

References. References to members by name reveal a similar structure (Figure 10). The module detects about one million references and links more than three quarters to a member or minister. In every decade, members refer to other party families more often than random speaker–target pairing within the half-legislature would predict. The gap reaches 15 percentage points: 66 versus 51 per cent in the 1870s and 77 versus 65 per cent in the 1950s. From the 1860s to the 1890s, references to the other language community—or, before party splits, the other region—also exceed the benchmark by 6–7 points. From 1900, they fall below it by 6–12 points: 41 versus 49 per cent in the 1900s and 32 versus 42 per cent in the 2000s. Before proportional representation, most districts elected members of one party, so cross-region references were largely cross-party

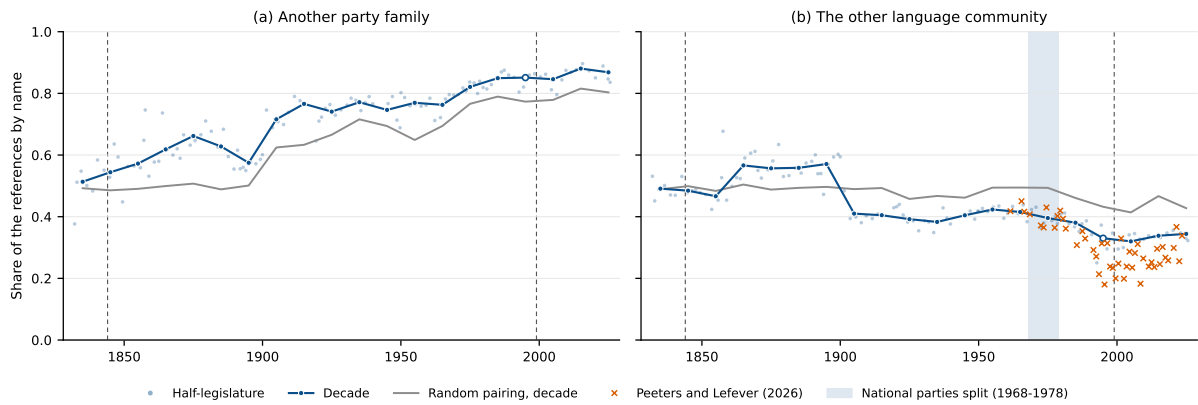


Figure 10: References between groups

Notes: Share of the references by name from one member to another, attributed to a member or minister, that point to (a) a member of another party family and (b) a member of the other language community, among the references whose speaker and target groups are known. Points: half-legislatures; lines: decades; grey lines: the share expected if, within each half-legislature, every reference paired its speaker with a target drawn at random from all the targets referred to. Crosses: the same share in the investiture, State of the Union and confidence debates of 1961–2023 studied by [Peeters and Lefever \(2026, Appendix 1\)](#), pooled by year. Language community: that of the party after the national parties split (1968–1978, shaded), otherwise the region of the constituency, so before the 1960s it separates Flemish from Walloon and Brussels constituencies rather than languages spoken. Dashed lines and open markers as in Figure 8. Preliminary: test run of the emotions module (`code/emotions`); produced by `code/python/21_emotions_link.py`.

references.

We compare the module with the investiture, State of the Union and confidence debates of 1961–2023 studied by [Peeters and Lefever \(2026\)](#). It detects similar intervention counts in most 1961–1979 debates, with a median ratio of 1.00 across 11 debates. It detects fewer from the 1980s because some sittings are missing from the dataset and, from 2000, some interventions are merged in the record. Median ratios are 0.59 in 1980–1991 and 0.49 in 1993–2023. Cross-language reference shares track theirs, with a correlation of 0.69 across 48 debates and a mean absolute difference of 0.06 (crosses in Figure 10b). They find that only 31 per cent of references cross the language border. This share declines from 1979, after the last national-party split, and rises again from 2007.

Coding emotions and reference tone will show whether parties with more distinct speech also address each other with more anger and incivility, as stage directions suggest. It will also show whether low partisanship in the federal era coexists with greater hostility.

8 Conclusions

This paper traces differences in Belgian Chamber speech from 1831 to 2025. We compare Catholics with other parties, the left with other parties, government with opposition, pairs of party families, and Flemish with Walloon members of the same national party. Partisanship is low under census suffrage, when parties are coalitions of notables and conflicts use largely shared vocabulary. It rises when Socialists enter under plural voting and peaks in the 1950s. The Royal Question and second school war then align with governments formed by one bloc and opposition by the other. At the peak, one minute of speech identifies a member’s party with probability close to 0.70, comparable to the US Congress in the 2000s and Finland in the

1970s. After the School Pact of 1958, religious differences in speech disappear within one period. Differences between traditional families remain low after the national parties split, while the government–opposition gap persists.

Studying the cleavages separately yields two findings. First, they leave the clearest traces in speech when they align with government status. Catholics and Socialists, the most distant pair, differ most when one governs and the other opposes. Liberals and Socialists speak similarly whenever they govern together. Second, before the national parties split, the linguistic cleavage appears mainly through regional interests, despite later reorganizing the party system.

Wider voting rights matter chiefly through changes in the Chamber’s composition, especially the Socialists’ entry in 1894. Belgium’s peak comes early, in the 1950s, at levels comparable to the US Congress in the 2000s and Finland’s 1970s peak. Partisanship has remained below those levels. Recorded reactions follow a similar long-run pattern, with opposition speakers receiving more disorder than governing speakers in almost every decade.

By construction, this measure captures differences between parties’ speech. It misses a hardening of rhetoric shared by all parties, and the groupings studied here cannot describe every division in a multiparty system (Simola et al., 2025). In Belgium, the measure combines cleavage-related vocabulary with language reflecting institutional roles. Its levels depend on speech volume and record quality.

Three extensions follow. Topic classification (Section 6) will separate differences in topic attention from differences within topics. Emotion and tone coding (Section 7) will test whether more distinct speech also means greater hostility, as recorded reactions suggest. Re-estimation with sentence-level language labels and procedural text removed will clarify the size of the 1950s peak and recent results. Finally, extending the analysis to the Senate, which shared legislative power with the Chamber until 1993, will reveal whether a second chamber elected under different rules spoke differently.

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Additional figures and tables

This section presents additional figures and tables referenced in the main text. Each paragraph explains the display, highlights relevant patterns and points to the section discussing it. The final two tables list the most partisan French phrases for the religious and left-right groupings, selecting one period per decade.

Figure 11 repeats Figure 2 excluding the Communist and radical left family, following [Simola et al. \(2025\)](#)'s treatment of Finland's extreme left. The real series changes little before 1925, when this family first enters the Chamber. Excluding it lowers net partisanship in 1932–1934 from 0.0046 to 0.0032, despite the family having only three speakers. The highest value is then 0.0042 in 1894–1896, followed by the 1950s. In 2024–2025, after PVDA-PTB's growth, the left excluding the radical left is more distinct (0.0033) than the whole left (0.0019). The radical left therefore contributes to the interwar peak, but does not determine the overall timing (Section 5.2).

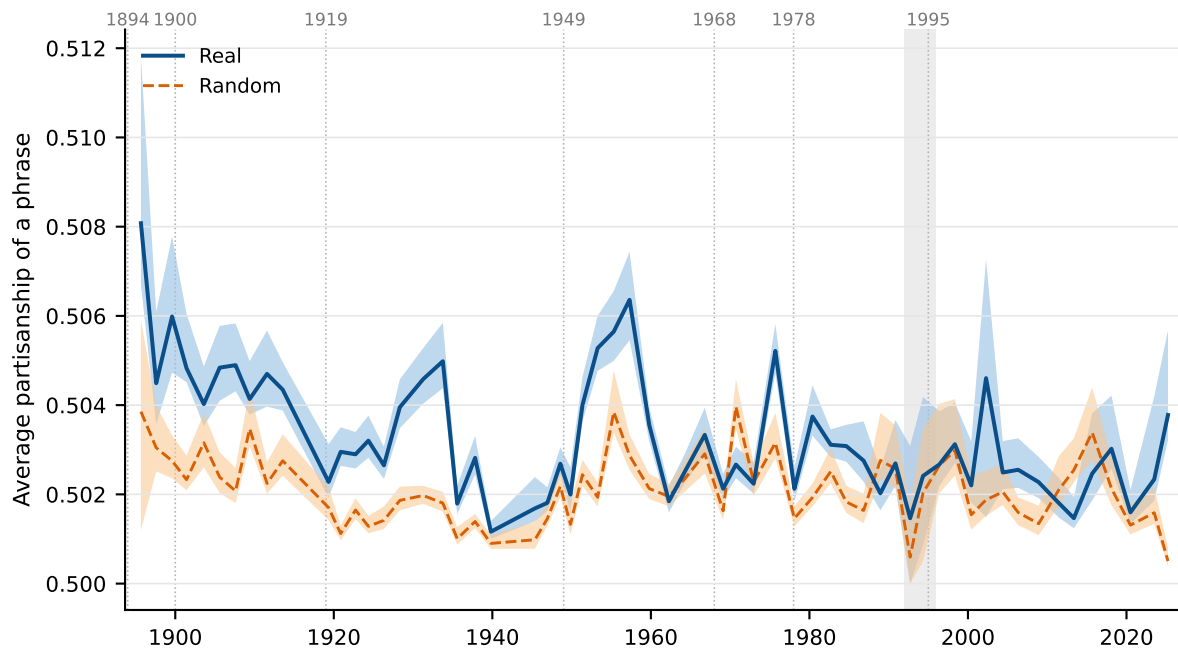


Figure 11: Left-right partisanship without the Communist and radical left family

Notes: As Figure 2, without the members of the Communist and radical left family.

Figure 12 plots school- and education-related phrases as a share of all phrases, alongside religious partisanship. The share peaks during each school conflict. It reaches its maximum of 4.0 per cent in 1884–1886, when the new Catholic majority replaces the Liberal school law, 2.9 per cent during the compulsory-education debate in 1912–1914, and 2.5 per cent during the second school war in 1954–1956. Partisanship follows only the last peak: it reaches 0.0039 in 1954–1956 but stays at or below 0.0022 during the first school war. School phrases almost disappear after education passes to the Communities in 1989. Topic attention and partisanship therefore need not move together. Both sides discuss schools extensively during the first school war (Figure 13; Section 5.1.1).

Figure 13 breaks down Figure 12's school phrases by speaker. Panel (a) counts Catholic members' school phrases; panel (b) shows their share of all school phrases. Counts peak in

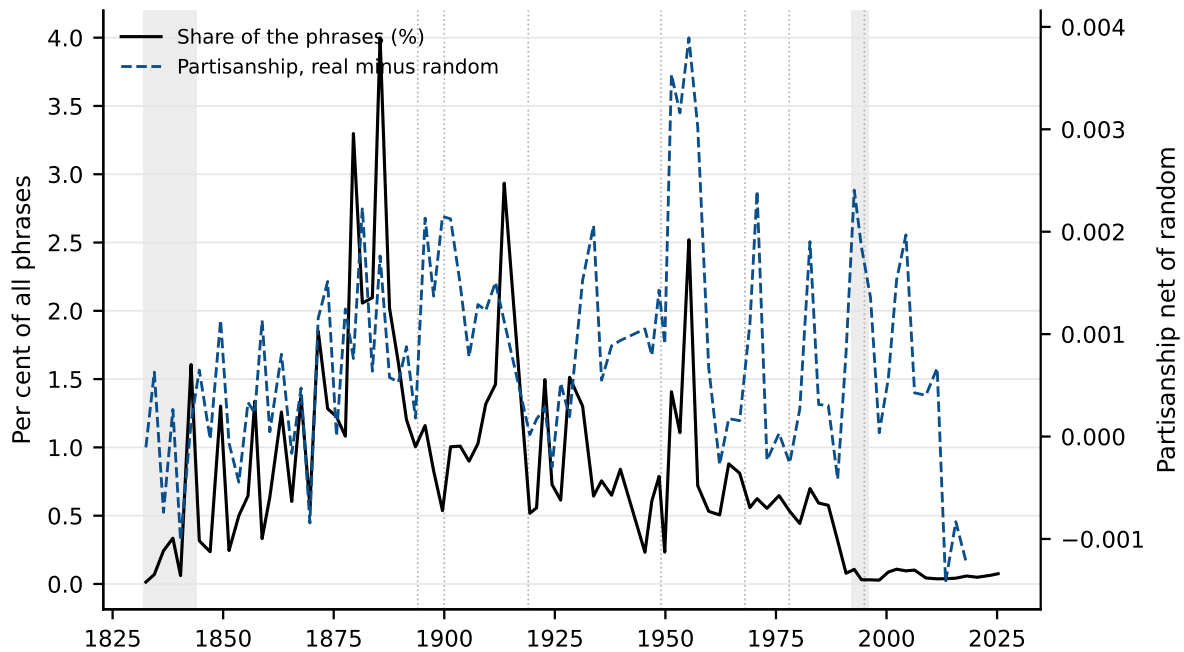


Figure 12: Phrases related to schools and education, and religious partisanship

Notes: Share of all phrases (both languages) that contain a stem related to schools and education (Online Appendix B), and religious partisanship net of the random series (Figure 1).

the first school war and are much lower in the second, when the Chamber uses about three fifths as many phrases per period. The Catholic share of school phrases generally tracks its share of speakers. In 1878–1884, Catholics use 49–52 per cent of school phrases and account for 45–49 per cent of speakers. The 1950s differ. Catholics use 35 per cent in 1950–1954, when they govern alone and represent 52–53 per cent of speakers. In opposition in 1954–1956, they use 56 per cent while representing 46 per cent of speakers. After 1989, shares rely on at most about 200 phrases per period. During the first school war, both sides discuss schools; their choice of phrases distinguishes them (Section 5.1.1).

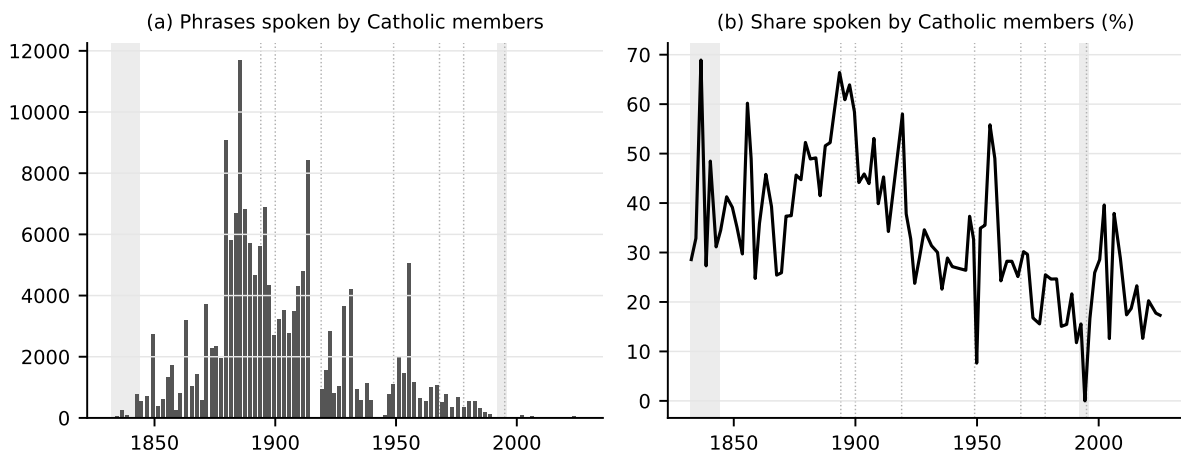


Figure 13: Catholic members and the school phrases

Notes: (a) Number of phrases related to schools and education spoken by Catholic members; (b) share of these phrases spoken by Catholic members.

Figure 14 compares religious partisanship with six Chamber features. The roll-call comparison follows Gentzkow et al. (2019)’s US Congress analysis; the other five follow Simola et al. (2023)’s Finnish analysis. Catholic–other-party differences in roll calls (panel a) move with speech partisanship only after 1945. The correlation is 0.60 in 1945–1994 and close to zero under census suffrage. Under plural voting, voting differences are at their highest but speech partisanship is moderate. Other indicators follow different trends. Roll calls rise from fewer than twenty per period before 1870 to several hundred after 1945, and more than a thousand in some federal-era periods. The effective number of parties rises from about two before 1894 to eight in the federal era, when about half the members are new in each legislature. Very long speeches are most common in the 1850s–1890s and 1960s–1980s and are unrelated to partisanship. None of these indicators peaks in the 1950s (Section 5.8).

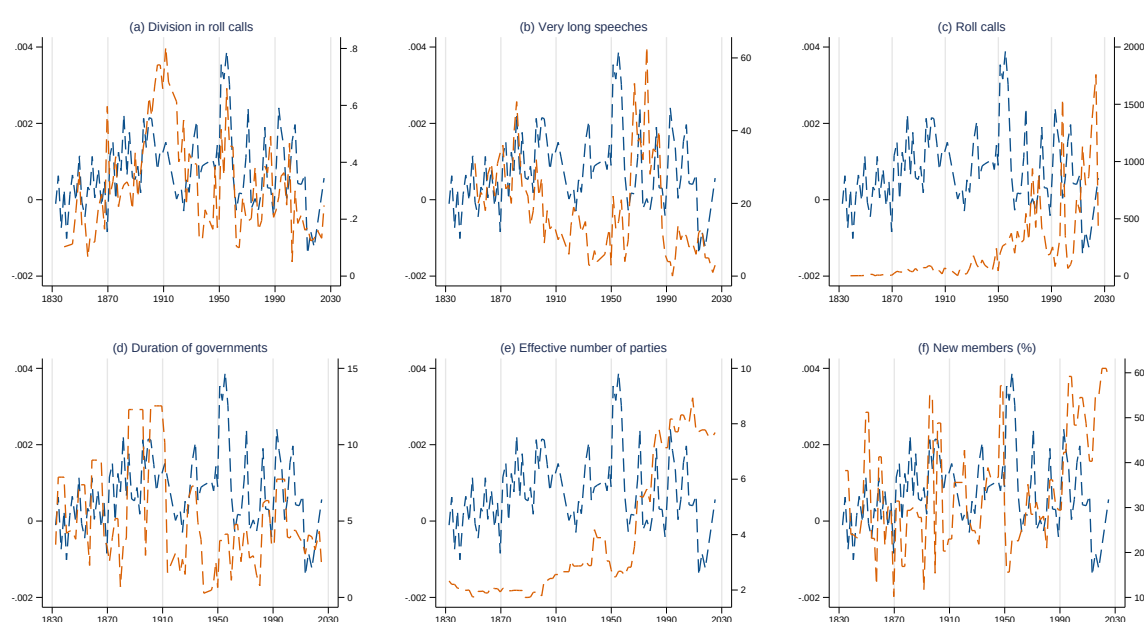


Figure 14: Religious partisanship and other features of the Chamber

Notes: Blue (left axis): religious partisanship net of the random series. Orange (right axis): (a) division between Catholics and other parties in roll calls (Rice, 1925); (b) number of very long speeches (top 0.1 per cent of the speeches since 1850); (c) number of roll calls; (d) mean duration of the governments in office; (e) effective number of parties among the members; (f) share of the members of a legislature who did not sit in the previous legislature.

Figure 15 groups members by region rather than party. It compares national-party members elected in Flemish and Walloon districts, using French speech and controlling for party family and gender. The real series remains close to the random benchmark. Net partisanship averages 0.0008 and is significant in 24 of 58 periods with adequate coverage. Values are highest in the 1850s, 1900s and 1920s, peaking at 0.0027 in 1927–1929. The 1950s and 1960s are among the lowest decades. The final period, 1965–1968, is not significant (0.0007). The regions therefore do not diverge before the party splits. As Section 5.5 argues, linguistic divisions appear mainly through regional interests (Online Appendix Table C94).

Figure 16 measures how well phrases reveal a speaker’s gender. Before 1995, the series is defined in only four periods, each with 15 to 18 women speakers. Intervals are wide and no value is significant. Since 1995, as women’s membership share rises to two fifths, the real

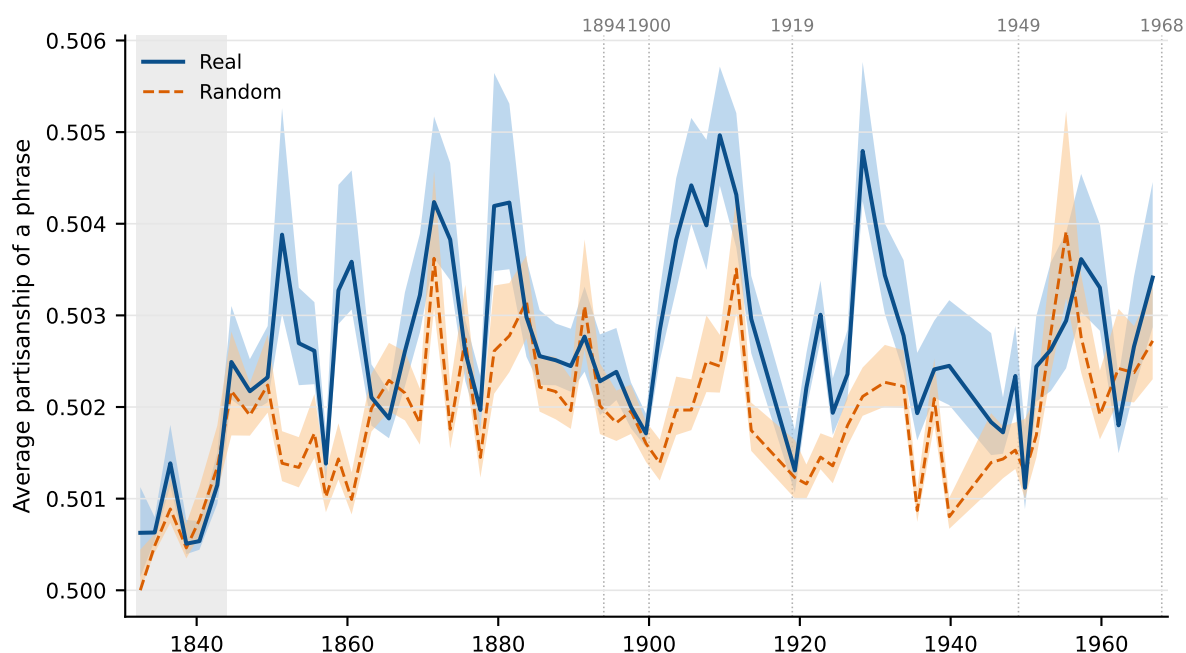


Figure 15: Flemish vs Walloon members of the national parties, before the split (French speech)

Notes: Group A: members elected in Flemish districts; group B: members elected in Walloon districts; members from Brussels are excluded. French speech, periods that begin before 1968, when the first of the national parties split. Controls for the party family and gender. Otherwise as Figure 1.

series significantly exceeds its random benchmark in 11 of 14 periods, both with and without party-family controls. Net partisanship averages 0.0025 with controls and 0.0022 without them. The leave-out estimator (panel c) exceeds its random benchmark in every period from 1995. Women and men therefore differ about as much within families as across them. In the federal era, their speech differs more than that of religious, left-right and government-opposition groups (Section 5.4).

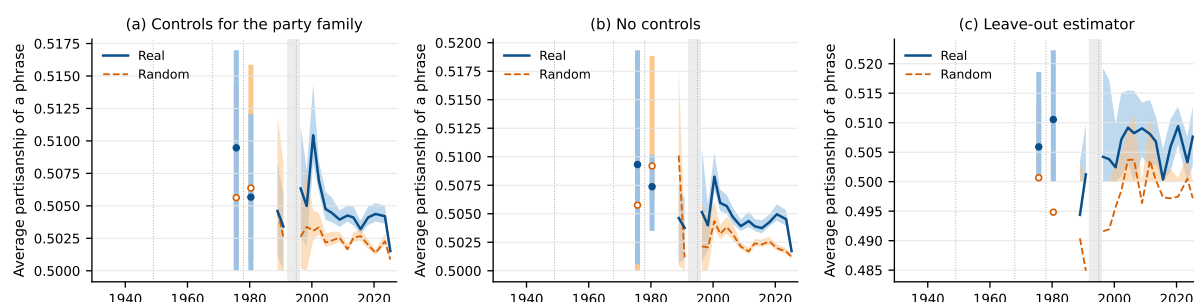


Figure 16: Women vs men

Notes: Group A: women; group B: men. (a) Controls for the party family, with effects that differ by era; (b) no controls; (c) leave-out estimator, no controls. Periods that begin in 1929 or later; a period enters the series when each group has at least 15 speakers in total and 10 in a language. Otherwise as Figure 1.

Figure 17 traces parties elected in 2024 through their predecessors. Without covariates, it compares each with other parties in its language group. Traditional-party predecessors are the most distinct. Dutch-speaking Catholics and Socialists reach 0.0071 and 0.0081 in 1952–1954, although these levels cannot be compared with French speech (Section 4). French-speaking Socialists are significantly distinct in every period from 1894 to 1914.

Smaller parties rarely differ significantly from a random group of equal size. Flemish nationalists are never significant before 1995. FDF falls below its random benchmark in all seven available periods. Greens and the radical left are never significant. Since 1995, only 11 of 116 party-periods are significant (Table 5; Section 5.4).

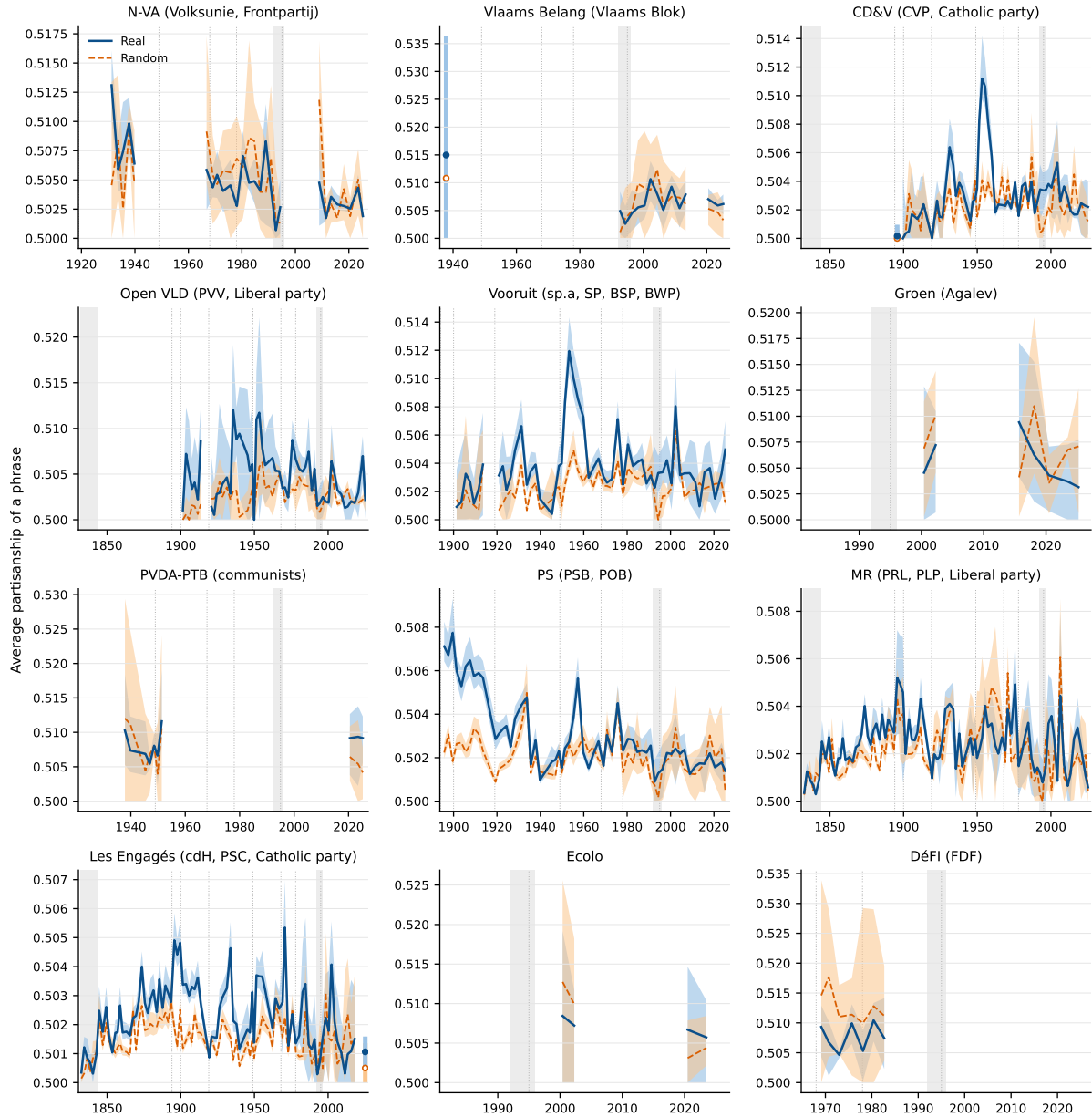


Figure 17: The parties of today's Chamber: partisanship against all the other parties

Notes: Each panel: group A is the party named in the title, followed back through its predecessors; group B, all the other parties of the same language group. Dutch series for the Dutch-speaking parties, French series for the French-speaking ones, both languages for PVDA-PTB. No covariates; a period enters the series when the party has at least 8 speakers. Otherwise as Figure 1.

Table 5 averages Figure 17's series by legislature from 1995, multiplying values by 1,000. Of 67 entries, 61 lie between -3 and 3 . Every party with entries except PVDA-PTB has both positive and negative values, so rankings change across legislatures. The largest positive values belong to PVDA-PTB in the legislatures elected in 2019 and 2024, and Vooruit in 2024. However, no PVDA-PTB period is significant. The largest negative values, for N-VA in 2007 and Groen in

2024, each come from a single period with eight speakers and a random estimate far above the real estimate. No federal-era party consistently stands apart from other parties in its language group. This agrees with low religious and left–right partisanship in these years (Section 5.4).

Table 5: Partisanship of today’s parties by legislature, 1995–2025

Party	Legislature elected in							
	1995	1999	2003	2007	2010	2014	2019	2024
N-VA				-7.09	0.32	-0.14	-0.02	0.27
Vlaams Belang	-2.30	-0.59	-2.52	1.82	-0.10		1.48	2.89
CD&V	1.86	1.05	0.71	1.99	0.25	-1.80	0.39	1.00
Open VLD	0.06	-0.22	1.68	0.91	-1.78	-0.03	2.94	-0.60
Vooruit	2.09	1.05	0.49	1.28	-0.55	1.23	-0.20	3.78
Groen		-2.62				0.30	-1.18	-3.94
PVDA-PTB							3.32	5.00
PS	0.08	-0.44	0.53	-0.01	0.33	-0.41	-0.55	0.95
MR	-0.03	1.83	-1.02	0.54	-0.13	1.08	-0.08	0.16
Les Engagés	0.10	1.44	0.55	0.16	-1.42	-0.13		0.56
Ecolo		-3.51					2.45	
DéFI								

Notes: Partisanship of each party against all the other parties of its language group, real minus random series, multiplied by 1,000; mean of the periods of each legislature. Blank: fewer than 8 speakers.

Figure 18 plots religious and left–right partisanship alongside the institutional-period means in Table 3. Religious means do not follow successive expansions of voting rights. They more than double under plural voting, halve under equal male suffrage, peak in the post-war unitary state, and fall after 1971 to about a fifth of that peak. Left–right means decline in every institutional period, from 0.0021 under plural voting to 0.0006 in the federal era. Most variation occurs within these periods. Period means explain less than a quarter of religious-series variance and less than a third of left–right variance. For example, the post-war mean combines the 1950–1958 peak with near-zero values in 1961–1968. These shifts coincide more closely with changes in Chamber and government composition than with voting rights (Section 5.6).

Figure 19 decomposes consecutive-period changes in leave-out religious partisanship. The within component measures changes among members present in both periods; renewal measures entry and exit. Both are cumulated from 1845. By 1952–1954, the within component adds 0.072 and renewal subtracts 0.038. Renewal mainly reduces partisanship because departing members spoke more distinctly than those who remained. The post-1950s fall of 0.029 comes from sitting members (within, -0.034), rather than Chamber renewal. Individual changes are noisy, and the components have opposite signs in only half of them. We therefore interpret careers and long swings rather than effects of specific reforms (Section 5.6). Online Appendix Figure A19 reports the left–right decomposition.

Figure 20 has not yet been produced. It will show religious partisanship without covariates and its two components. Between-topic partisanship measures how Catholics and other parties divide attention across subjects. Within-topic partisanship averages estimates based on each topic’s phrases, weighting by its share of all phrases. Once every speech has a topic label (Section 6), the figure will distinguish the part of the 1950s peak due to topic choice from the

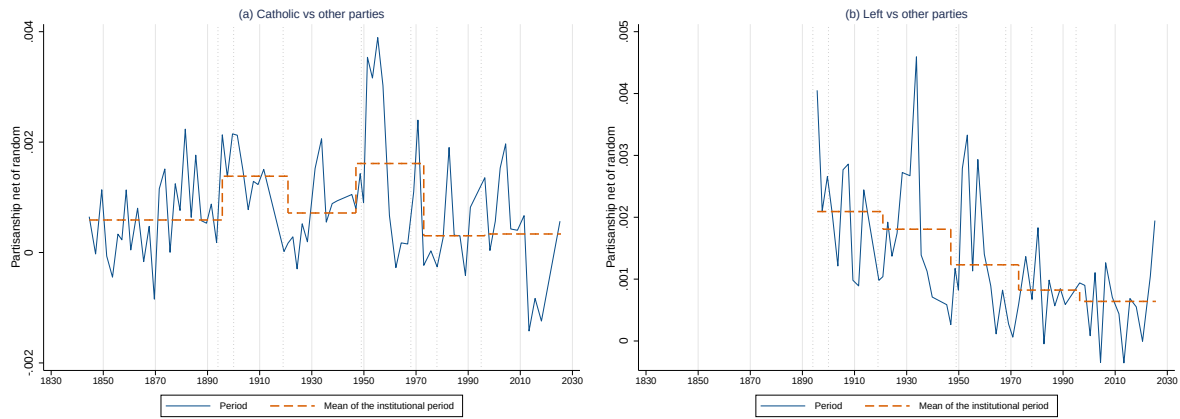


Figure 18: Partisanship and the institutional periods

Notes: Partisanship net of the random series, and its mean in each institutional period: census suffrage (to 1893), plural voting (1894–1918), equal male suffrage (1919–1944), the post-war unitary state (1945–1970), the state reforms (1971–1994) and the federal Chamber of 150 members (from 1995).

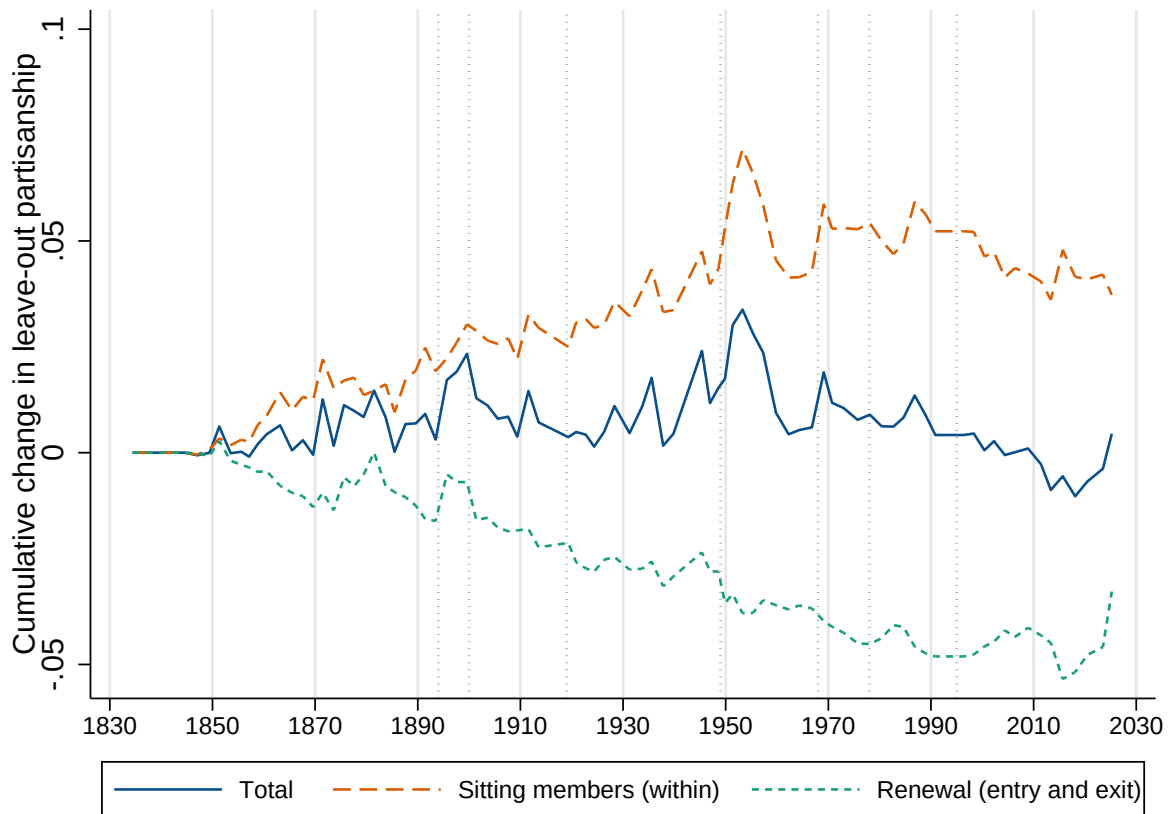


Figure 19: Renewal of the Chamber and adaptation of sitting members: Catholic vs other parties

Notes: Cumulative change in leave-out partisanship (Gentzkow et al., 2019) between consecutive periods, decomposed into the change among members who sat in both periods (within) and the contribution of entry and exit (renewal). Changes into or out of a period with low coverage of the sittings are not counted.

part due to language used within the same topics.

figures/topics_rel.pdf not yet produced

Figure 20: Partisanship between and within topics: Catholic vs other parties

Notes: Between topics: partisanship of the choice of topics; within topics: average of the partisanship estimated with the phrases of each topic, weighted by the topic's share of phrases; no covariates (code/python/11_topics.py). Not yet produced: it requires the topic of every speech (Section 6).

Table 6 compares periods beginning within five years after each reform with those beginning within six years before it. Each comparison uses four to seven periods, so standard errors are only indicative. The clearest changes occur in 1894 and 1949. Following the Socialists' entry in 1894, religious and government–opposition partisanship rise by 0.00135 and 0.00115. Around 1949, all three series rise by 0.0013–0.0018 in a window covering the Royal Question and second school war. Proportional representation and equal male suffrage are followed by small declines or no change. These lie within two standard errors, except the government–opposition estimate around 1919, which uses four periods. After both party splits, religious partisanship rises by about 0.0009 while left–right partisanship is unchanged. Too few periods around 1995 have full sitting coverage (Section 5.6).

Table 6: Partisanship around the reforms

Reform	Catholic vs other	Left vs other	Government vs opposition
1894	0.00135 (0.00024)		0.00115 (0.00030)
1900	-0.00042 (0.00038)	-0.00092 (0.00056)	-0.00035 (0.00042)
1919	-0.00083 (0.00048)	0.00001 (0.00029)	-0.00023 (0.00008)
1949	0.00178 (0.00071)	0.00134 (0.00064)	0.00148 (0.00054)
1968	0.00092 (0.00057)	-0.00016 (0.00027)	0.00098 (0.00012)
1978	0.00094 (0.00031)	-0.00010 (0.00054)	-0.00059 (0.00032)
1995			

Notes: Difference in partisanship net of the random series between the periods that begin up to five years after the reform year and those that begin up to six years before (for 1919, from 1910, because the Chamber did not sit during the war); Newey–West standard errors (one lag) in parentheses. Periods with low coverage of the sittings are excluded, which leaves too few periods around 1995.

Table 7 sums the changes in Figure 19 within each institutional period, alongside the left–right changes from Online Appendix Figure A19. For religious partisanship, the within component is positive in all four periods before 1971. The components have opposite signs in five of six periods, partly offsetting each other. The largest total, 0.020 under equal male suffrage, comes almost entirely from sitting members. In the federal era, sitting members become less distinct (–0.015), while renewal adds the same amount. For left–right partisanship, both components have the same sign under plural voting and equal male suffrage. The federal-era rise of 0.019

comes from sitting members (0.027). These totals accumulate noisy changes and describe careers rather than reform effects (Section 5.6).

Table 7: Renewal and adaptation, by institutional period

Institutional period	Catholic vs other			Left vs other		
	Total	Within	Renewal	Total	Within	Renewal
Census suffrage, 1831–1893	0.00311	0.01924	-0.01613			
Plural voting, 1894–1918	0.00056	0.00573	-0.00517	-0.02831	-0.01170	-0.01662
Equal male suffrage, 1919–1944	0.02037	0.02260	-0.00223	0.00766	0.00305	0.00461
Post-war unitary state, 1945–1970	-0.01226	0.00529	-0.01755	-0.00275	0.00319	-0.00594
State reforms, 1971–1994	-0.00760	-0.00058	-0.00702	-0.00299	-0.00960	0.00661
Federal Chamber of 150, 1995–2025	0.00029	-0.01503	0.01532	0.01864	0.02687	-0.00824

Notes: Sum over the periods of each institutional period of the change in leave-out partisanship (total), and of its components: change among sitting members (within) and entry and exit (renewal). Changes into or out of a period with low coverage of the sittings (1832–1843, 1992–1995) are not counted.

Table 8 lists the five French phrases most typical of each group in one period per decade, following Gentzkow et al. (2019, Table I)’s comparison of selected Congresses. Two types recur. Institutional-role phrases distinguish the governing side, which submits bills and reports (*section centrale, honneur de déposer, projet de loi*), from the opposition, which addresses ministers (*ministre des finances, premier ministre*). These phrases switch groups when governments change; compare 1878–1880 with 1888–1890. In the full-period lists (Online Appendix C), submission formulas follow Catholic government status in 56 of the 62 periods where they appear.

Cleavage-related phrases include religious education for Catholics in 1848–1850, *instruction publique* versus *écoles communales* during the first school war, working-class and universal-suffrage phrases for other parties after 1894, the Royal Question for other parties in 1949–1950, and development cooperation for Christian democrats from 1969–1971. Both 1999–2001 lists contain record artefacts: Dutch roll-call text and words split at accented letters (Section 5.1.1).

Table 8: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: one period every ten years

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1839–1841</i>					
société générale	232	122	sucre exotique	90	167
section centrale	515	437	tribunal commerce	46	91
affaires étrangères	153	133	chemins vicinaux	42	68
ministre affaires	100	85	redevance mines	12	37
adjudication publique	40	35	caisses prévoyance	8	18
<i>1848–1850</i>					
chemin fer	547	273	section centrale	479	658
ministre intérieur	280	167	ministre guerre	35	82
eh bien	327	247	000 fr	230	269
enseignement religieux	116	44	garde civique	43	75
enseignement moyen	140	78	société générale	21	51
<i>1859–1861</i>					
ministre finances	294	169	section centrale	310	444
vol domestique	117	22	projet loi	339	419
passee port	87	20	garde civique	7	69
pétition datée	88	30	bruxelles louvain	39	78
eh bien	350	298	000 fr	230	265
<i>1868–1870</i>					
ministre finances	223	91	sociétés coopératives	3	70
ministre justice	290	190	000 fr	67	120
aujourd'hui	554	497	section centrale	317	368
listes électorales	92	37	assemblée générale	39	87
pétition datée	95	49	sociétés anonymes	78	125
<i>1878–1880</i>					
ministre intérieur	285	133	chemin fer	313	386
instruction publique	243	105	écoles communales	72	126
ministre justice	193	84	honneur déposer	20	71
ministre instruction	136	42	projet loi	288	332
ministre finances	169	77	section centrale	306	343
<i>1888–1890</i>					
chemin fer	360	265	ministre guerre	79	179
prud hommes	220	142	ministre justice	137	221
conseils prud	155	93	ministre finances	111	191
honneur déposer	75	15	sûreté publique	19	96
déposer bureau	61	12	agents provocateurs	3	46
<i>1898–1900</i>					
section centrale	243	148	banque nationale	122	321
projet loi	380	318	classe ouvrière	33	119
juge paix	90	43	tramways bruxellois	29	106
honneur déposer	57	15	suffrage universel	46	117
bureau chambre	47	13	eh bien	146	211
<i>1908–1910</i>					
section centrale	196	104	chemin fer	299	376
comité spécial	103	25	classe ouvrière	31	95
ministre guerre	202	130	fer postes	31	84

Table 8: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: one period every ten years (continued)

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
loi 1902	74	21	ministre chemins	58	109
000 hommes	75	27	écoles normales	35	85
1918–1919					
section centrale	384	309	classe ouvrière	55	107
dommages guerre	178	134	comité national	43	85
projet loi	474	432	avant guerre	127	162
honneur déposer	90	60	chemin fer	134	162
oeuvre nationale	36	8	pendant guerre	143	167
1929–1932					
projet loi	360	275	premier ministre	91	184
honneur déposer	86	39	société nationale	101	149
déposer bureau	76	30	classe ouvrière	68	113
bureau chambre	75	31	ministre finances	104	145
chambre rapport	55	14	ministre industrie	50	91
1939–1940					
chemin fer	143	71	ministre justice	48	88
pommes terre	73	18	personnel enseignant	25	62
projet loi	277	233	nationalistes flamands	10	42
société nationale	121	82	instruction publique	96	124
commission bancaire	59	20	politique indépendance	8	34
1949–1950					
assurés libres	70	15	consultation populaire	177	353
pouvoirs représentants	47	8	premier ministre	187	297
honneur déposer	80	45	question royale	92	132
central provincial	42	7	société nationale	34	67
collège électoral	52	20	budget 1950	6	29
1958–1961					
autre part	236	165	premier ministre	208	522
politique scientifique	48	4	tout heure	177	245
allocations familiales	120	85	loi unique	63	121
ruanda urundi	100	67	aujourd'hui	392	438
force publique	57	24	classe ouvrière	25	67
1969–1971					
pays voie	283	26	projet loi	192	274
voie développement	265	25	police judiciaire	16	95
affaires étrangères	207	75	santé publique	36	103
coopération développement	130	15	affaires économiques	91	154
parlement européen	134	39	premier ministre	183	239
1979–1981					
communauté germanophone	114	23	premier ministre	527	600
conseil ministres	167	75	conseil état	72	108
parlement européen	77	13	article 107quater	18	46
affaires étrangères	114	62	organisations syndicales	26	54
coopération développement	84	33	communautés régions	29	57
1989–1991					
précompte mobilier	152	47	premier ministre	550	707
précompte professionnel	82	30	affaires étrangères	101	158
union nationale	68	20	ministre affaires	95	144
détention préventive	76	28	secrétaires communaux	21	55
spéciale impôts	51	4	ministre intérieur	77	94
1999–2001					
premier ministre	893	363	matie re	216	457
motion pure	261	76	certain nombre	192	349
zijn stem	147	72	services police	69	137
stem gecontroleerd	146	72	supplé mentaires	23	81
amendement nr	147	80	police fédérale	53	101
2007–2010					
partenaires sociaux	271	96	commission enquête	72	146
premier ministre	525	433	demandeurs asile	15	64
demandeurs emploi	99	32	certain nombre	115	152
manière dont	110	47	pays européens	25	52
cour appel	84	26	médecins généralistes	29	55
2016–2019					
projet loi	525	441	sécurité sociale	171	217
secret professionnel	74	26	saut index	10	52
arabie saoudite	103	55	pension points	8	38
spf finances	53	13	67 ans	8	36

Table 8: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: one period every ten years (continued)

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
manière dont 2024–2025	103	70	droits femmes	21	48
union européenne	324	144	premier ministre	285	654
remercie réponse	158	45	500 euros	23	113
projet loi	244	148	000 euros	117	193
coopération développement	55	17	flexi jobs	28	85
moyen orient	32	10	67 ans	17	60

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table 9 presents the same comparison for the left and other parties from 1898–1900. Before the Second World War, social issues distinguish the left. *classe ouvrière* appears among its five most partisan phrases in every displayed period before 1945, alongside universal suffrage, the eight-hour day and, in 1918–1919, women’s suffrage. The other side, usually governing, submits bills. After the war, the left’s phrases concern trade unions, social security and public services; from the 2000s, they concern tax fraud, health care and pension age (67 ans). *groupe socialiste* appears in five of fourteen periods.

As in the religious comparison, *premier ministre* identifies the opposition. It belongs to the left in 1929–1932, 1949–1950, 1958–1961 and 2024–2025, and to other parties in 1969–1971, 1979–1981, 1989–1991 and 1999–2001, when Socialists govern. Both 1999–2001 lists contain words split at accented letters (Section 5.2).

Table 9: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: one period every ten years

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1898–1900</i>					
banque nationale	355	125	section centrale	138	227
classe ouvrière	162	28	juge paix	24	102
eh bien	238	147	ministre justice	85	131
caisse épargne	140	63	députation permanente	35	80
suffrage universel	126	51	conseil guerre	39	83
<i>1908–1910</i>					
classe ouvrière	159	31	ministre guerre	106	186
prud hommes	271	152	section centrale	87	167
chemin fer	418	312	comité spécial	5	77
conseils prud	186	109	projet loi	148	188
huit heures	108	42	union minière	4	40
<i>1918–1919</i>					
classe ouvrière	231	43	dommages guerre	49	191
comité national	121	49	tribunaux dommages	11	90
suffrage universel	81	46	affaires économiques	63	109
huit heures	44	10	écoles normales	24	67
suffrage femmes	64	33	juge unique	38	71
<i>1929–1932</i>					
premier ministre	201	104	projet loi	242	363
industrie travail	159	70	honneur déposer	30	81
classe ouvrière	144	63	déposer bureau	21	71
ministre industrie	121	43	bureau chambre	23	71
ministre finances	170	99	doit être	132	178
<i>1939–1940</i>					
personnel enseignant	90	21	projet loi	209	270
instruction publique	142	91	arrêté royal	181	226
groupe socialiste	48	3	honneur déposer	32	73
union soviétique	24	2	bureau chambre	41	78
classe ouvrière	67	45	chambre rapport	17	52
<i>1949–1950</i>					
premier ministre	338	201	projet loi	221	346
membres conseil	133	62	déposer bureau	25	97
conseil ministres	159	89	bureau chambre	29	94
conseil état	174	125	honneur déposer	24	87
vrai oui	42	8	eaux usées	11	59
<i>1958–1961</i>					
premier ministre	569	217	congo belge	54	146
loi unique	129	62	autre part	148	229
classe ouvrière	82	23	ruanda urundi	61	98
services publics	94	44	marché commun	65	99
groupe socialiste	93	49	budget ordinaire	14	47
<i>1969–1971</i>					
affaires économiques	200	106	premier ministre	151	280
autre part	248	177	conseil culturel	38	102
certain nombre	165	101	police judiciaire	43	100
organisations syndicales	109	49	pères famille	21	63
santé publique	128	70	classes moyennes	24	64

Table 9: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: one period every ten years (continued)

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1979–1981</i>					
certain nombre	314	182	premier ministre	413	697
loi programme	168	65	conseil etat	45	133
bien être	98	25	communauté germanophone	7	60
organisations syndicales	92	27	déclaration gouvernementale	118	170
sécurité sociale	165	111	région bruxelles	13	57
<i>1989–1991</i>					
groupe socialiste	220	8	premier ministre	303	813
projet loi	572	469	loi financement	38	76
loi programme	98	43	secrétaires communaux	34	63
commission justice	104	50	cessez feu	33	54
personnes âgées	61	14	politique agricole	20	30
<i>1999–2001</i>					
groupe socialiste	270	3	ge rale	114	289
consé quence	229	103	premier ministre	510	562
valable celui	91	20	pre sident	1698	1705
pouvoirs membres	56	5	aujourd'hui	746	749
droits homme	147	98	projet loi	478	480
<i>2007–2010</i>					
fraude fiscale	174	76	titres services	35	69
groupe socialiste	89	7	cour comptes	65	91
soins santé	154	99	projet loi	259	284
sécurité sociale	168	117	commission justice	37	52
secret bancaire	59	10	coopération développement	45	57
<i>2019–2021</i>					
aujourd'hui	1744	1483	premier ministre	498	689
sécurité sociale	189	55	droit passerelle	38	166
soins santé	205	127	remercie réponse	93	165
milliards euros	158	89	entités fédérées	41	97
paradis fiscaux	83	16	ose espérer	14	48
<i>2024–2025</i>					
premier ministre	825	455	remercie réponse	36	92
aujourd'hui	1596	1358	allocations chômage	39	76
000 euros	293	114	projet loi	158	176
500 euros	182	39	droit auteur	14	19
67 ans	118	6	lutte contre	247	251

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Online Appendix A: Partisanship results

This appendix adds results for Section 5. It examines identification after multiple phrases and robustness to covariates, estimators, the penalty ψ , language and sample selection. It also compares regions within families, studies individual phrases and phrase groups, compares speech with roll calls, tests OCR noise and decomposes left-right changes through Chamber renewal. Each specification draws its own random benchmark (Section 4). Differences in net partisanship for a single period may therefore reflect the random draw. We mainly compare real series. Most checks follow [Gentzkow et al. \(2019\)](#): magnitude, estimates without covariates, the penalty ψ , plug-in and leave-out estimators, and roll-call comparisons. Government-status controls and checks excluding the radical left or right follow [Simola et al. \(2023\)](#)’s Finnish analysis.

Figure A1 shows the expected posterior probability assigned to a speaker’s actual group after up to 100 phrases, following [Gentzkow et al. \(2019, Figure 3\)](#). It selects eight religious-series periods from 1859–1861 to 2024–2025 and seven left-right periods from 1894–1896. The probability rises slowly. After one minute, or 33 phrases, it ranges from 0.54 to 0.60 for the religious grouping and 0.56 to 0.68 for the left-right grouping. The steepest curves occur under plural voting: 1898–1900 for religion and 1894–1896 for left-right. These curves use real estimates and include finite-sample bias. For example, the religious curve for 1974–1977 is the second steepest even though its real and random series coincide. No selected period falls within the 1950–1958 peak. Figure 7 reports every period’s one-minute probability (Section 5.8).

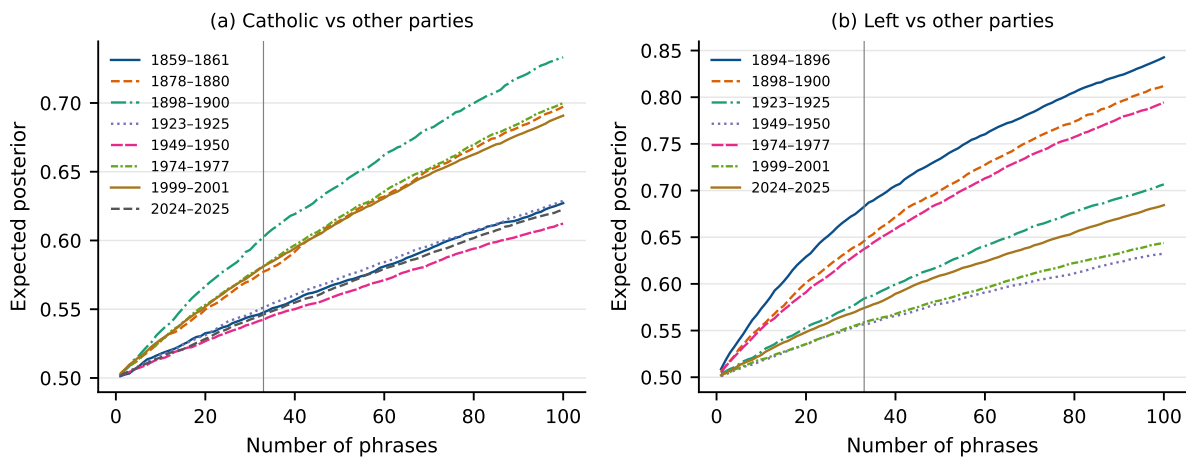


Figure A1: Magnitude of partisanship when more than one phrase is heard

Notes: Expected posterior on the true group after hearing up to 100 phrases, for selected periods; computed as in [Gentzkow et al. \(2019\)](#). Vertical line: one minute of speech (33 phrases).

Figure A2 re-estimates religious partisanship with alternative controls. Without covariates (panel a), the real series closely matches the main specification, with a correlation of 0.95. Most differences in net estimates come from the random benchmarks. Government status, whether alone or with gender and province as in [Simola et al. \(2025\)](#) (panels b and c), nearly coincides with the religious grouping in 1848–1914 and 1950–1958. Catholics then either govern alone or form almost the whole opposition. Party and government effects cannot be separately identified in these periods. The real series jumps to 0.61–0.74 in 13 to 16 periods of 1868–1912. In

other periods, including the 1950s, it stays close to its random benchmark. We therefore omit government status from the main specification (Section 4) and measure government–opposition differences directly in Section 5.3.

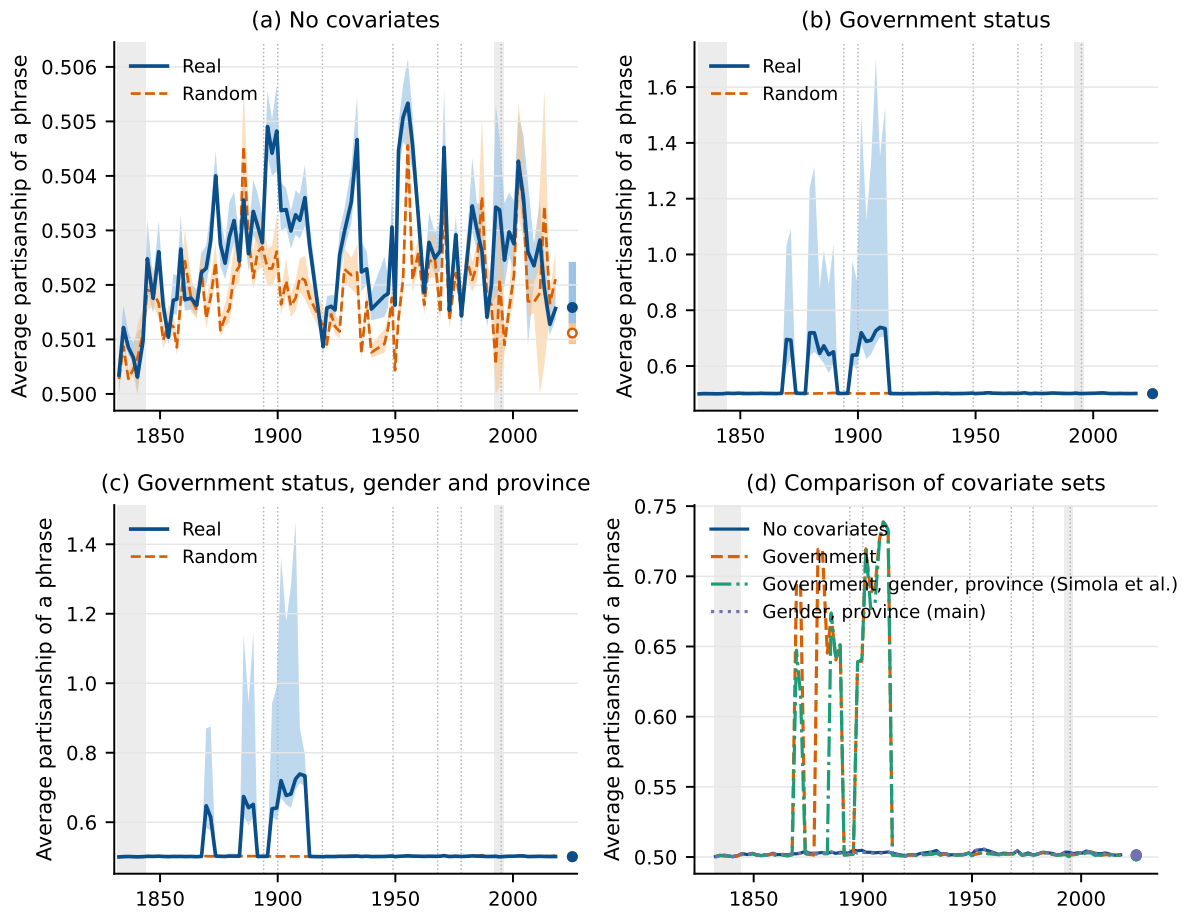


Figure A2: Religious partisanship: impact of covariates

Notes: (a)–(c) Real and random series for different sets of covariates; (d) comparison of the covariate sets: the main specification controls for gender and province; [Simola et al. \(2025\)](#) also control for government status, as [Gentzkow et al. \(2019\)](#) do for the majority status of the party. With government status, the series is not identified in the periods when a single family held office (values between 0.61 and 0.74 in 1868–1912).

Figure A3 repeats this comparison for left–right partisanship. Government controls produce no outliers but lower estimates in most periods. The largest reductions occur in eleven periods when the left almost coincides with the opposition, including 1896–1900, 1927–1934 and 1949–1954. Average net partisanship then falls from 0.0024 to below 0.0008, and the 1932–1934 peak largely disappears. Without covariates, the real series is higher in 28 of 30 pre-1960 periods but retains the main specification’s timing. After 1960, all four series are close, except in 2003–2005, when government controls give higher values. As with religion, government status absorbs much of partisanship when the cleavage aligns with government versus opposition (Section 5.3).

Figure A4 excludes the populist radical right: Rex from 1936, Vlaams Blok and Vlaams Belang from 1978, Front National from 1991 and Parti Populaire from 2010. This follows [Simola et al. \(2023\)](#)’s exclusion of Finland’s Rural Party. Real series change little. Religious estimates move by less than 0.0001 before 1985 and at most 0.0013 afterwards. Left–right estimates remain highest in 1894–1900, 1932–1934 and the 1950s. The 1894–1896 estimate falls from 0.5080 to

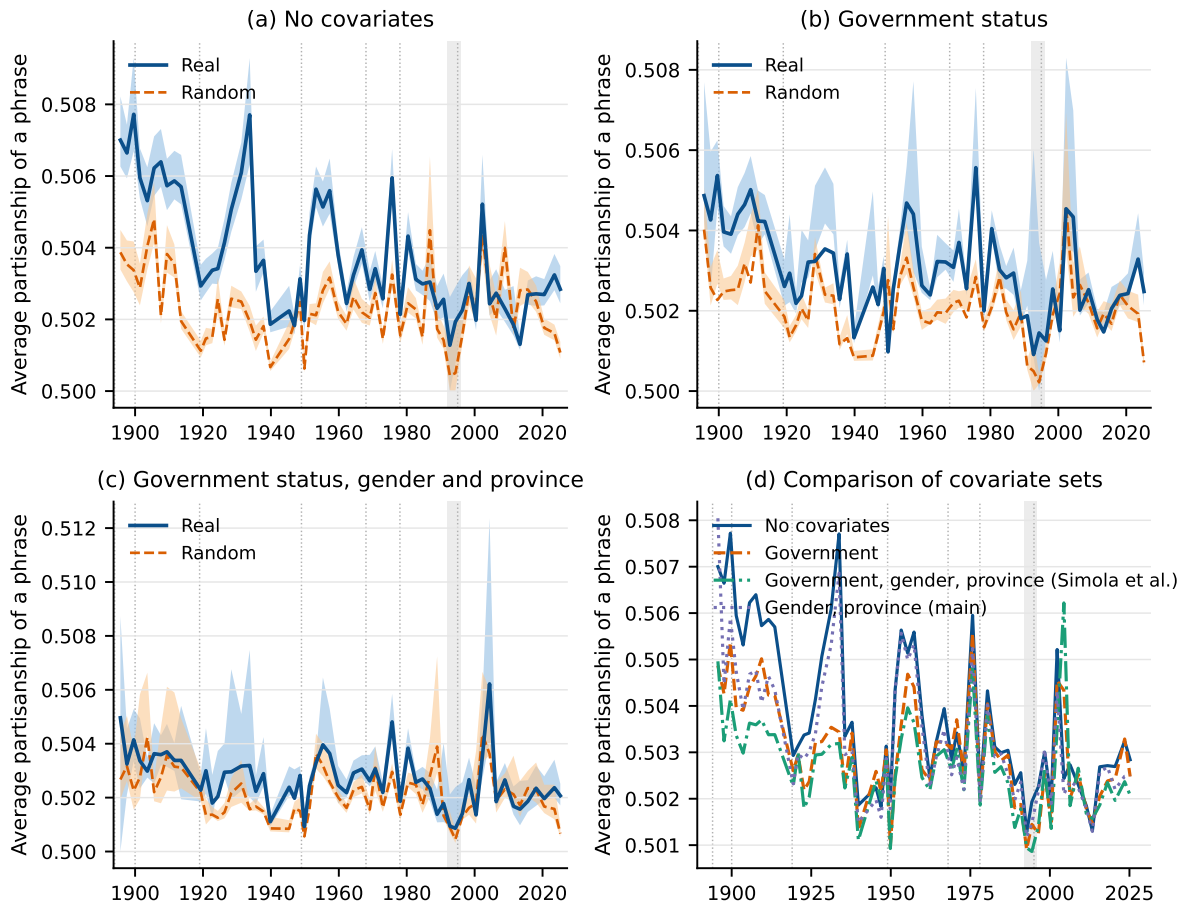


Figure A3: Left–right partisanship: impact of covariates

Notes: As Figure A2.

0.5053 even though no radical-right member was yet present. This happens because phrase penalties and covariate effects are estimated jointly across periods.

Net estimates change more because each specification draws its own random benchmark. In 1954–1956, net religious partisanship falls from 0.0039 to 0.0006 while the real estimate is unchanged. The radical right does not determine the main series' timing.

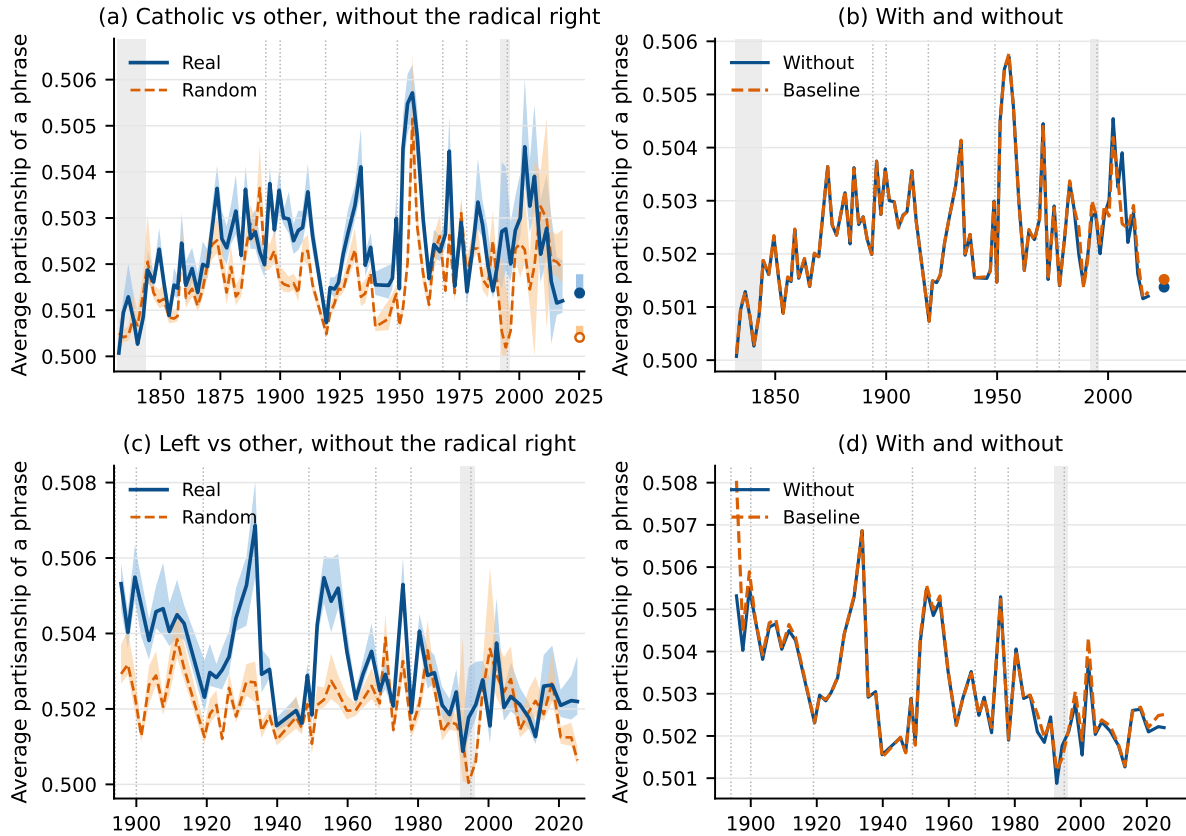


Figure A4: Partisanship without the populist radical right

Notes: Members of Rex, the Vlaams Blok and Vlaams Belang, the Front National and the Parti Populaire excluded.

Figure A5 calculates partisanship from observed phrase-choice probabilities without penalization. This is the plug-in estimator used by Gentzkow et al. (2019, Figure 1) to demonstrate finite-sample bias. Real estimates range from 0.56 to 0.82, far above penalized estimates. However, random benchmarks follow them closely and account for more than nine tenths of their distance from 0.5 on average. Levels also track speech volume. For both groupings, the correlation between real estimates and log phrases per speaker is below -0.9 . Peaks occur in short or poorly covered periods, including 1831–1833, 1949–1950 and 1991–1995. The unpenalized empirical estimator therefore mainly captures finite-sample bias, motivating our use of penalization (Section 4).

Figure A6 shows the information available for each religious-series period. Panel (a) counts French and Dutch vocabulary phrases used at least once. Panel (b) counts phrases whose party coefficient $\hat{\phi}_{jt}$ remains non-zero after penalization. The first count is broadly stable from the 1840s to the 1960s, then about two fifths lower after 1995. The second falls more, from about 360 per period under plural voting to 75 in the federal era. It follows speech volume and drops in

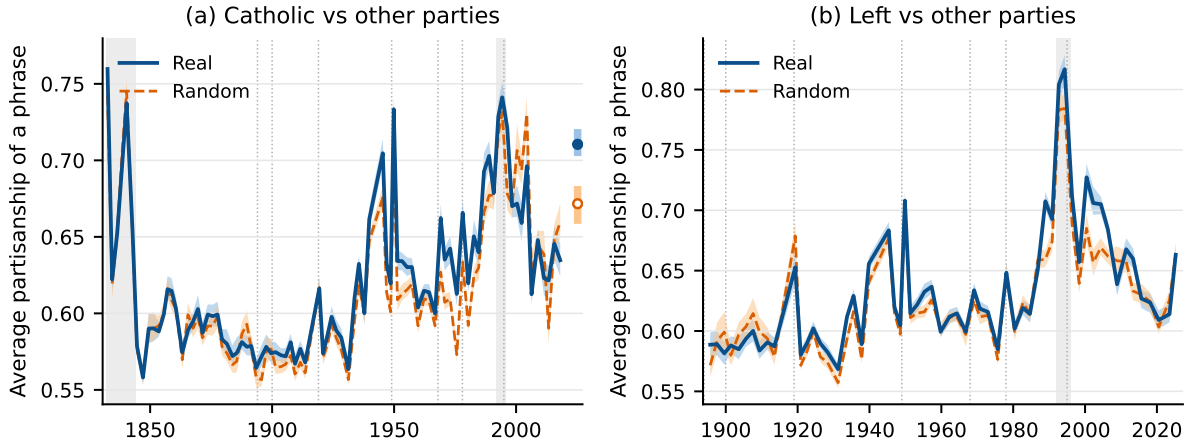


Figure A5: Partisanship computed from empirical phrase choice probabilities

Notes: Choice probabilities $\hat{q}_{jt} = c_{jt} / \sum_k c_{kt}$ by group, without penalization (the plug-in estimator of Gentzkow et al., 2019).

short or poorly covered periods such as 1944–1946, 1949–1950 and 1991–1995. Since partisanship depends on non-zero coefficients, lower recent estimates may partly reflect less speech rather than smaller differences in speech (Section 5.10).

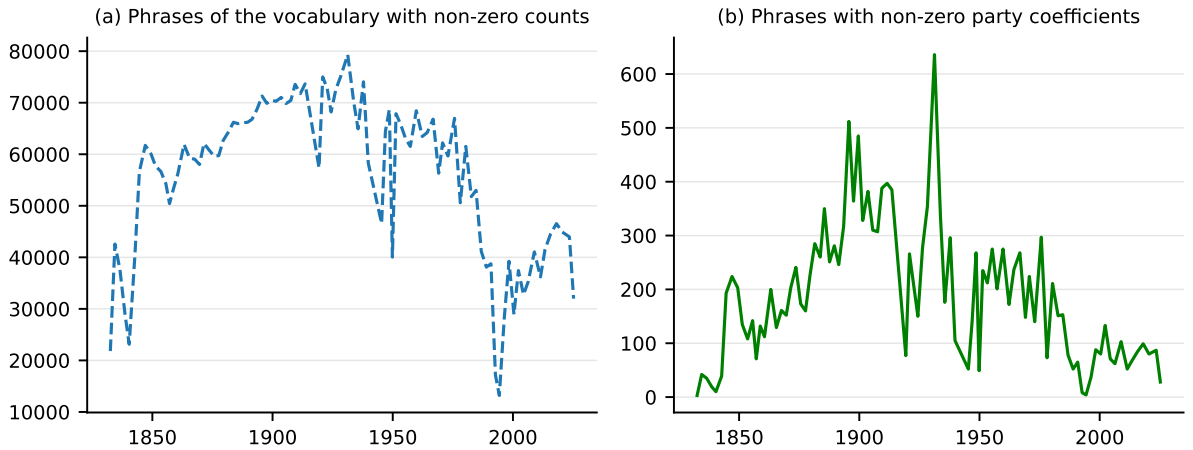


Figure A6: Phrase usage and partisanship

Notes: (a) Phrases of the vocabulary with non-zero counts; (b) phrases with non-zero party coefficients $\hat{\phi}_{jt}$, religious split, main specification.

Figure A7 re-estimates the series without covariates, increasing or decreasing the penalty ψ tenfold, as in Gentzkow et al. (2019)'s robustness checks. The reference estimates are panel (a) of Figures A2 and A3, with $\psi = 10^{-5}$. At $\psi = 10^{-4}$, every real estimate moves towards 0.5. The median reduction is about a sixth of its distance from 0.5. Random estimates fall by a similar amount, leaving average net religious partisanship unchanged and slightly reducing left–right partisanship, from 0.0015 to 0.0014. At $\psi = 10^{-6}$, real estimates are almost identical to those at $\psi = 10^{-5}$, with correlation above 0.999. Across values of ψ , religious estimates remain highest in the 1950s and under plural voting, and left–right estimates in 1894–1900 and 1932–1934. Peak timing is therefore robust.

Figure A8 separates the French and Dutch components of the main series, which are weighted

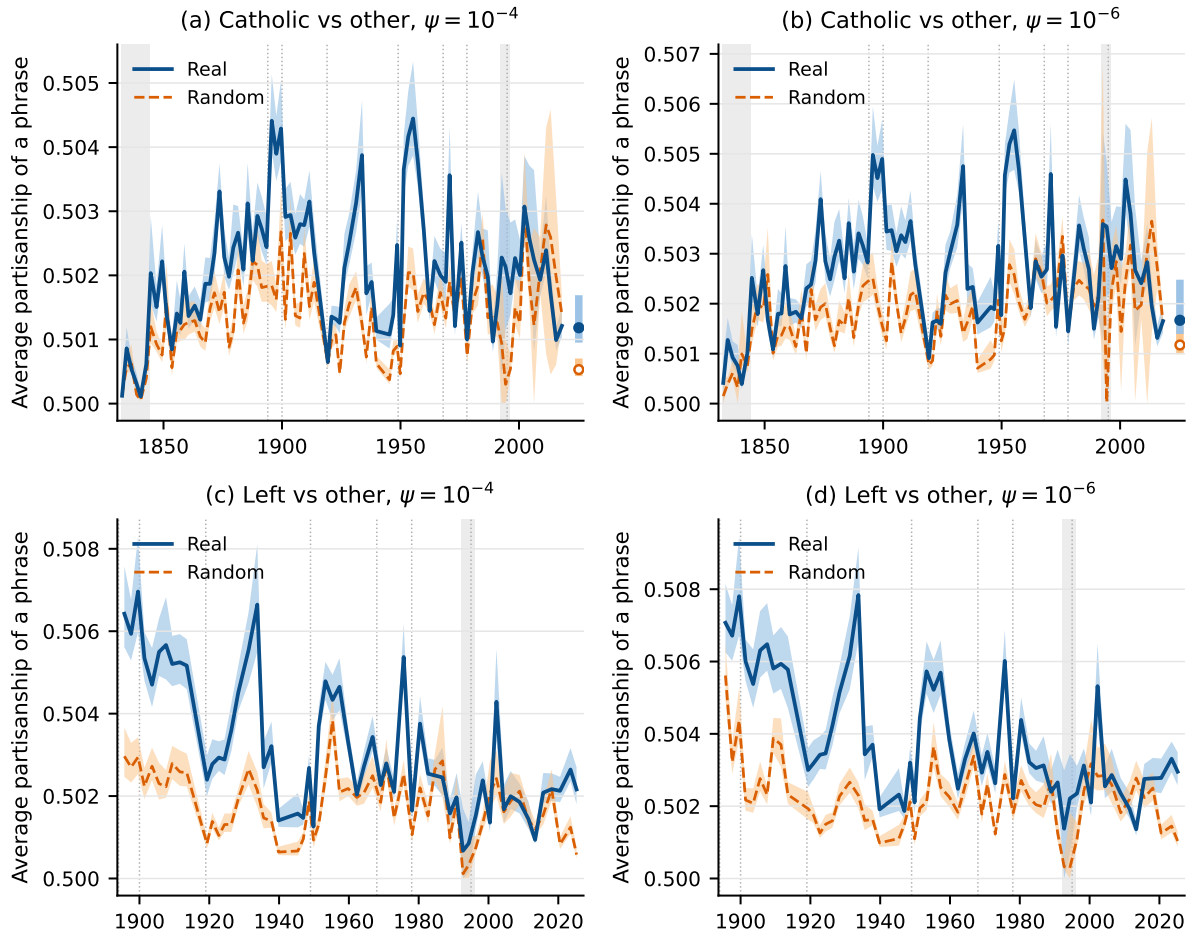


Figure A7: The impact of ψ

Notes: Series without covariates, with $\psi = 10^{-4}$ and $\psi = 10^{-6}$ (the main specifications use $\psi = 10^{-5}$).

by their phrase shares. Dutch enters in 1900 but carries little weight before 1919. It accounts for less than a sixth of interwar phrases and about a fifth in the 1950s. Both Dutch series peak in 1950–1958, with all values significant. French religious estimates in the 1950s (0.0019–0.0027) are close to the plural-voting maximum of 0.0021. They are below 1969–1971 and 2001–2003 values, when few Christian democrats spoke French. The French left–right series peaks in 1894–1896 and 1932–1934. Dutch contributes about half of net religious partisanship in 1952–1958. Levels cannot be compared across languages because the Dutch vocabulary is about a sixth the size of the French vocabulary (Section 4).

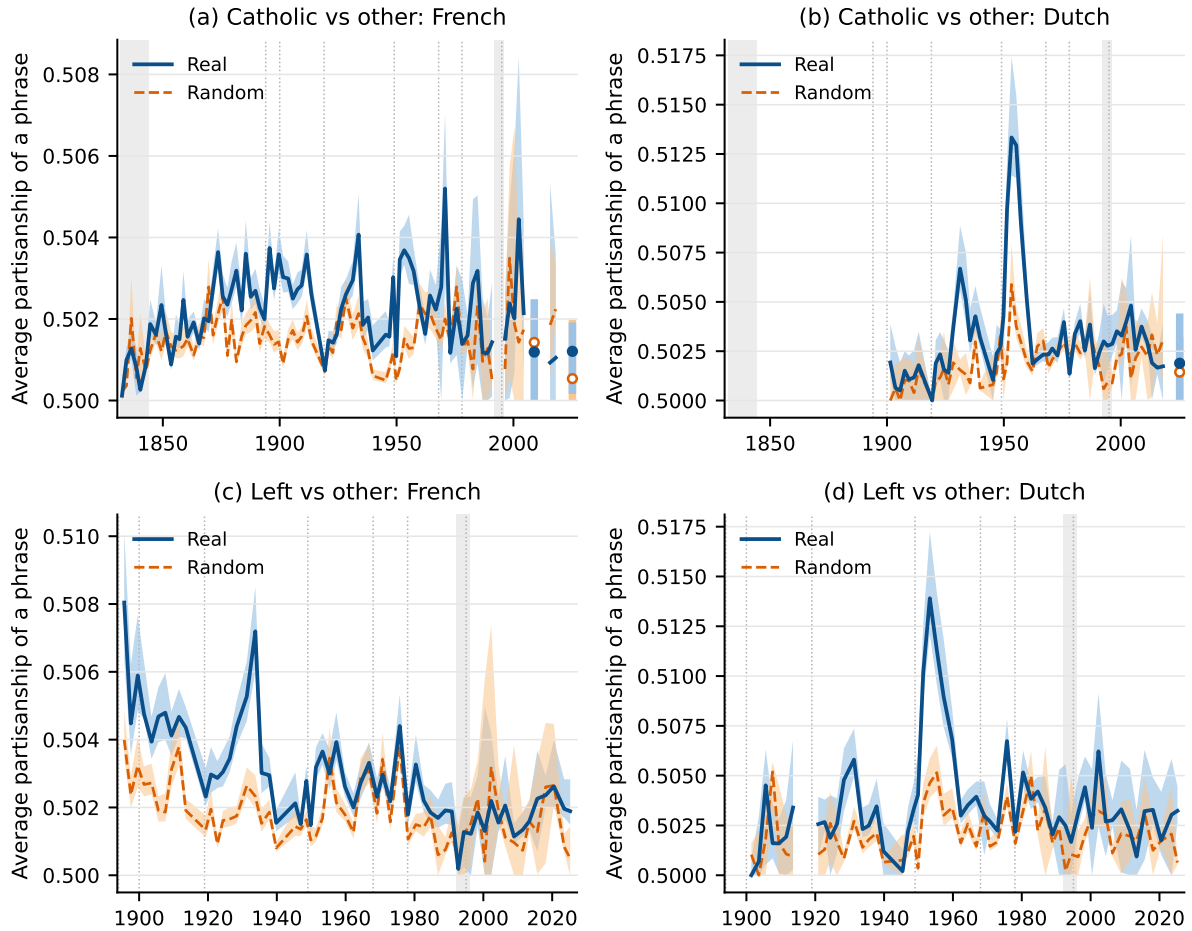


Figure A8: Partisanship by language

Notes: The French and Dutch components of Figures 1 and 2. Levels are not comparable across languages: the Dutch vocabulary is about a sixth of the French one.

Figure A9 reports the unpenalized leave-out estimator of Gentzkow et al. (2019) for the three main groupings. Its random benchmark averages close to 0.5, but estimates are noisy. Some fall below 0.5, and intervals are about ten times wider than penalized intervals. The ranking of eras is similar. Religious estimates are positive in every period of 1843–1893 but rarely significant, significant in all ten periods of 1894–1914, highest in 1950–1954, and negative in 1971–1981. Left–right estimates are highest in 1894–1902 and high again in the 1950s. Government–opposition estimates peak in 1950–1954.

Recent decades stand closer to the 1950s than in the penalized series. In the 2020s, left–right and government–opposition estimates exceed nine tenths of their 1950s averages, compared

with 43 and 73 per cent in the penalized series (Section 5.10).

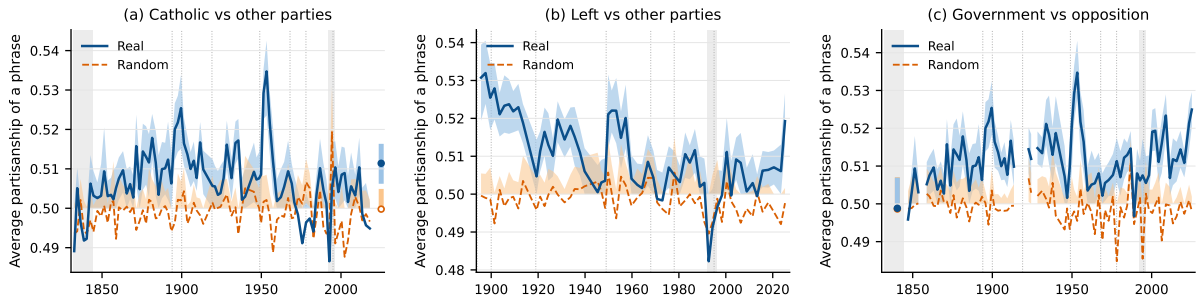


Figure A9: Leave-out estimator

Notes: Leave-out estimator of Gentzkow et al. (2019), as used by Graziani and Vanschoonbeek (2026); no covariates.

Figure A10 compares the main real series with estimates excluding speeches delivered by members as ministers, which account for about a sixth of phrases. It omits random benchmarks and confidence intervals. Before 1968, religious estimates are higher without ministerial speeches in four fifths of periods. The 1950s peak also rises slightly: net partisanship is 0.0048 rather than 0.0039 in 1954–1956. After the Christian-democratic split, the religious series significantly exceeds its random benchmark in only one period, compared with six in the main series. Most significant recent values therefore disappear without ministerial speeches. The left–right series retains its timing and is slightly higher in three quarters of periods. The main peaks do not depend on ministers’ speeches.

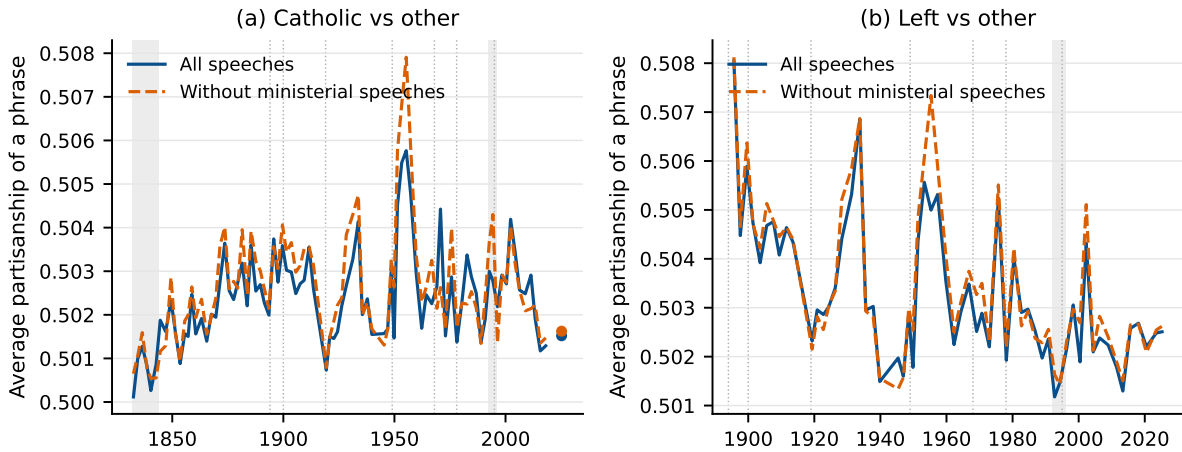


Figure A10: Speeches delivered in a ministerial capacity left out

Figure A11 compares constant gender and province effects with effects varying by institutional period. Real estimates are almost identical, with a correlation of 0.99 for both groupings. The largest difference occurs at the start of the left–right series, in 1894–1896. Average net religious partisanship is 0.00081 with constant effects and 0.00078 with varying effects; random benchmarks are not shown. Both specifications place the religious peak in 1954–1956 and the left–right peak in 1932–1934.

Individual net estimates vary more because each specification draws a different random benchmark. Religious partisanship in 1894–1896 falls from 0.0021 to 0.0004, mainly because the

random estimate rises. The institutional-period ranking in Table 3 is unchanged for religion. For left-right partisanship, plural voting and equal male suffrage exchange positions.

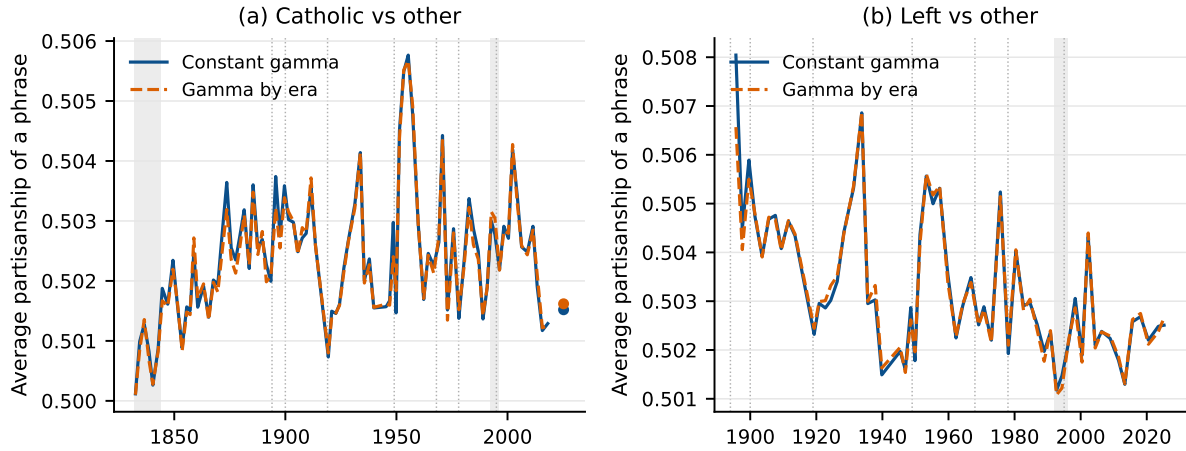


Figure A11: Covariate effects that vary by institutional period

Figure A12 compares Flemish and Walloon members within national parties before each party's split, using French speech without covariates. Each region needs 15 speakers. This creates Catholic-series gaps before 1884, when few Walloon Catholics speak. The Liberal series covers only the years to 1864 and 1904–1914, and the Socialist series begins in 1919. Catholics speak similarly across regions: net partisanship averages 0.0003 and is significant in 4 of 42 periods. Socialists differ more, averaging 0.0028, with significance in 6 of 22 periods. Four are interwar periods; the others are 1950–1952 and 1958–1961. Their intervals are wide, however, with only 15 to 25 Flemish Socialists speaking French. Liberal differences are significant only in 1850–1852 and 1857–1859. Regional differences within national parties therefore appear mainly among Socialists (Section 5.5).

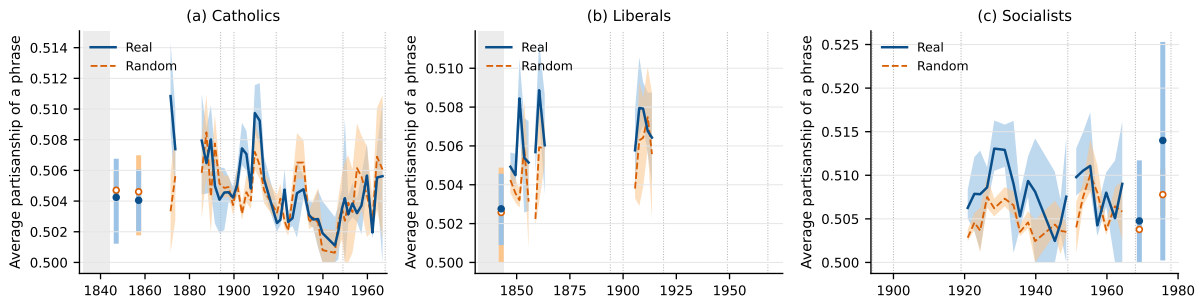


Figure A12: Flemish vs Walloon members within each party family, before its split

Notes: French speech; no covariates.

Figure A13 tracks French phrase partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ (Gentzkow et al., 2019), multiplied by 1,000. Eligible phrases were among a decade's three most partisan. Each panel selects phrases first identified in its half-century and displays the five with the largest absolute value in any period. Institutional-role phrases change sign with government status. *section centrale* identifies the Liberal majority in 1857–1859 and the Catholic majority in 1876–1878. *projet de loi* and *honneur de déposer* peak for Catholics in 1952–1954. *premier ministre*, the figure's largest value at 1.33 in

1999–2001, identifies Christian democrats in opposition. Cleavage-related phrases instead mark particular episodes: *écoles communales* for Liberals in 1884–1886, *consultation populaire* for other parties in 1949–1950, and *pays en voie de développement* for Catholics in 1969–1971 (Section 5.1.1).

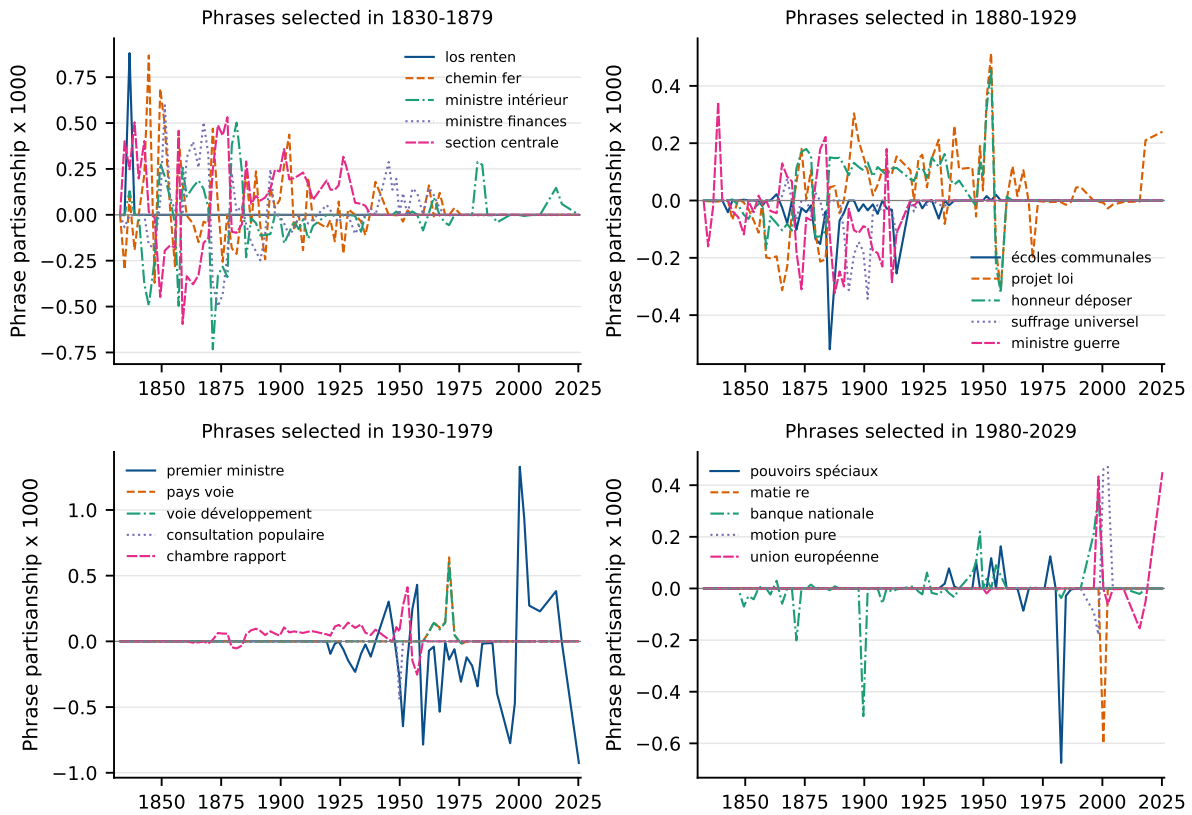


Figure A13: Religious partisanship ζ_{jt} of selected phrases

Notes: Phrase partisanship multiplied by 1000. The phrases are selected among the three most partisan of each decade (French speech); each panel shows, among those first selected in the decades of its half-century, the five with the largest absolute value in any period. Positive values: Catholic phrases.

Figure A14 repeats this exercise for left–right partisanship. The first panel is empty because the series begins in 1894. Before 1914, *suffrage universel* and *classe ouvrière* identify the left, reaching about 0.6 in 1900–1902 and 1912–1914. Institutional-role vocabulary later dominates. *projet de loi* identifies other parties under the Christian-democratic government of 1952–1954. *premier ministre* changes sides as Socialists move from opposition in 1985–1987 to government in 1989–1991.

Two of the three largest values are name sequences: *MM. Cousin* and *Cousin Coiseau*. They refer to Zeebrugge port contractors whose concession was debated in August 1895. A left speaker is predicted to use each sequence more than 600 times per 100,000 phrases, compared with about 25 for other parties. Their partisanship values of 1.6 and 1.5 are more than four times that of *classe ouvrière* in the same period. Together they account for much of left–right partisanship in 1894–1896 (Section 5.2).

Figure A15 plots monarchy-related phrases as a share of all phrases alongside religious partisanship (top). The bottom panels show Catholic members’ count and share of these phrases. Most matches are royal-decree formulas: *arrêté royal* alone accounts for about 60 per cent. Almost all are French. Their share peaks in 1949–1950, before the referendum on Leopold III’s return.

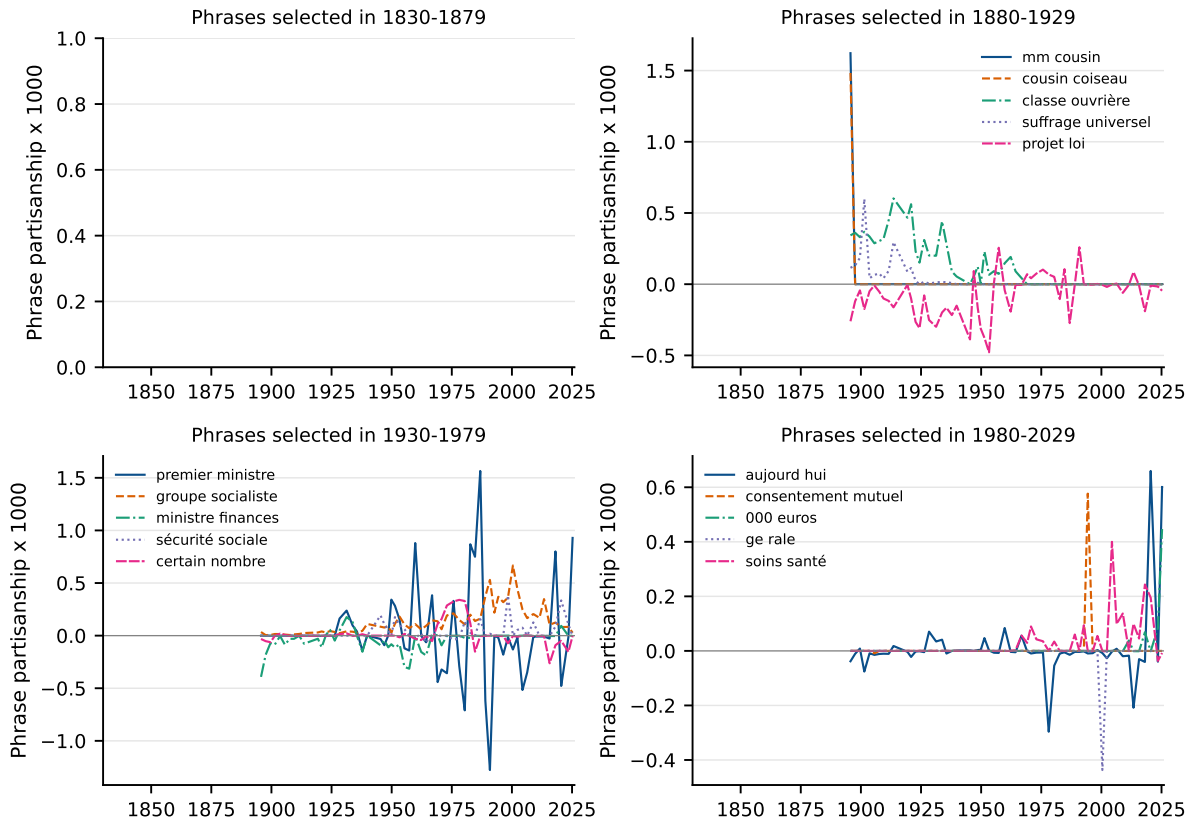


Figure A14: Left-right partisanship ζ_{jt} of selected phrases

Notes: As Figure A13; positive values: phrases of the left.

Catholics use 20 per cent of these phrases, below their shares of speakers (46 per cent) and speeches (28 per cent). Religious partisanship is then moderate at 0.0009 and peaks later, in 1954–1956 during the second school war (Section 6).

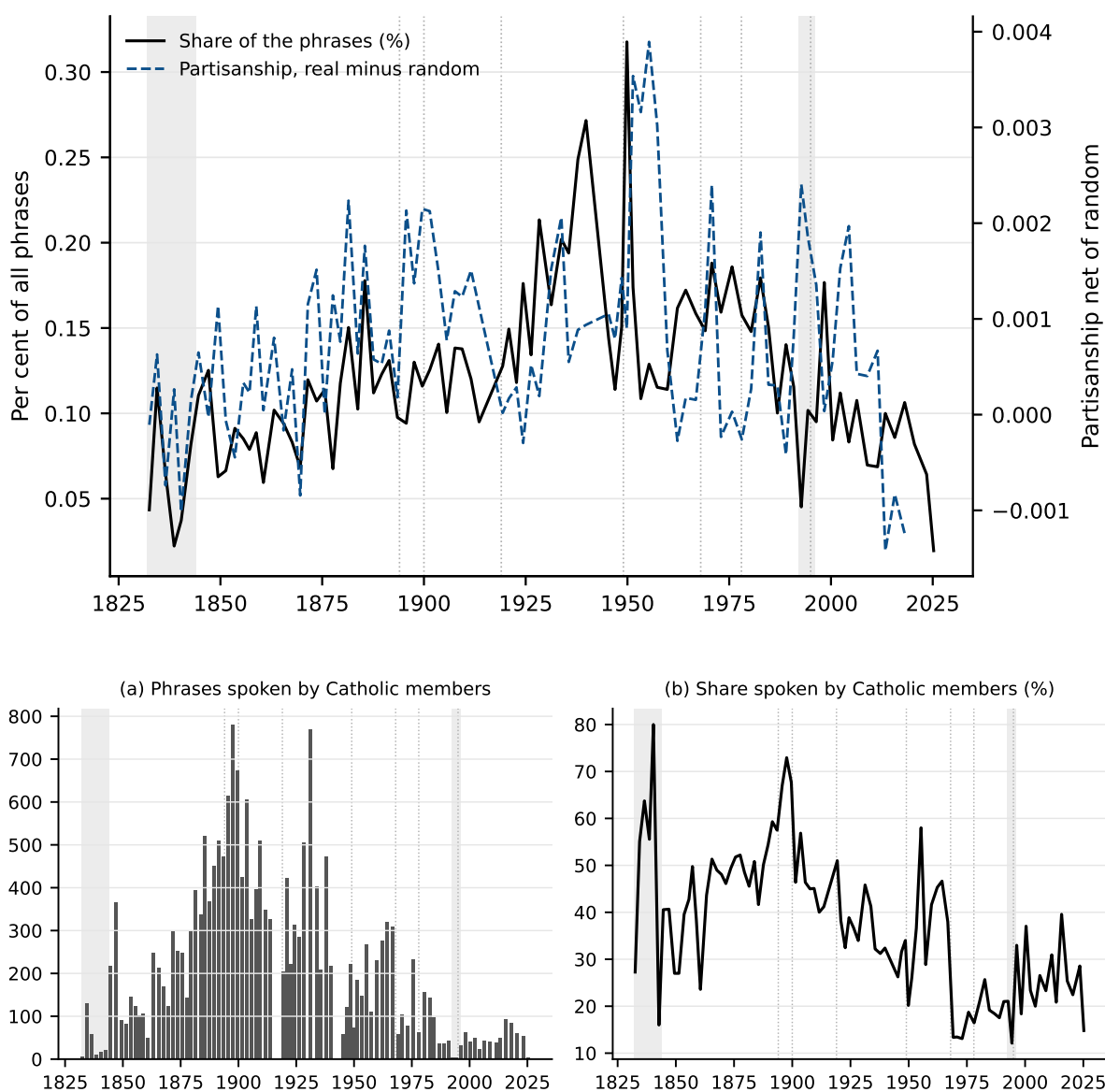


Figure A15: Phrases related to the Royal Question

Figure A16 plots language-policy phrases (top) and labour phrases (bottom) alongside the corresponding partisanship series. These compare Flemish and Walloon French speech before 1968, and the left with other parties. Language-policy phrases are most frequent in 1906–1908, 1921–1923 and 1929–1932, and around the 1970 state reform. Regional partisanship does not track them: the correlation is 0.05. Labour phrases reach 1.2–2.4 per cent in 1894–1914 after the Socialists enter and become less frequent after 1934. Left–right partisanship tracks them across the full period, with a correlation of 0.57.

The labour dictionary matches few Dutch phrases, so Dutch speech’s growing share partly explains the later decline. In French alone, labour phrases still account for 0.6–0.8 per cent in 2016–2025. Left–right differences therefore move with labour attention, while regional differences do

not move with language-policy attention (Section 6).

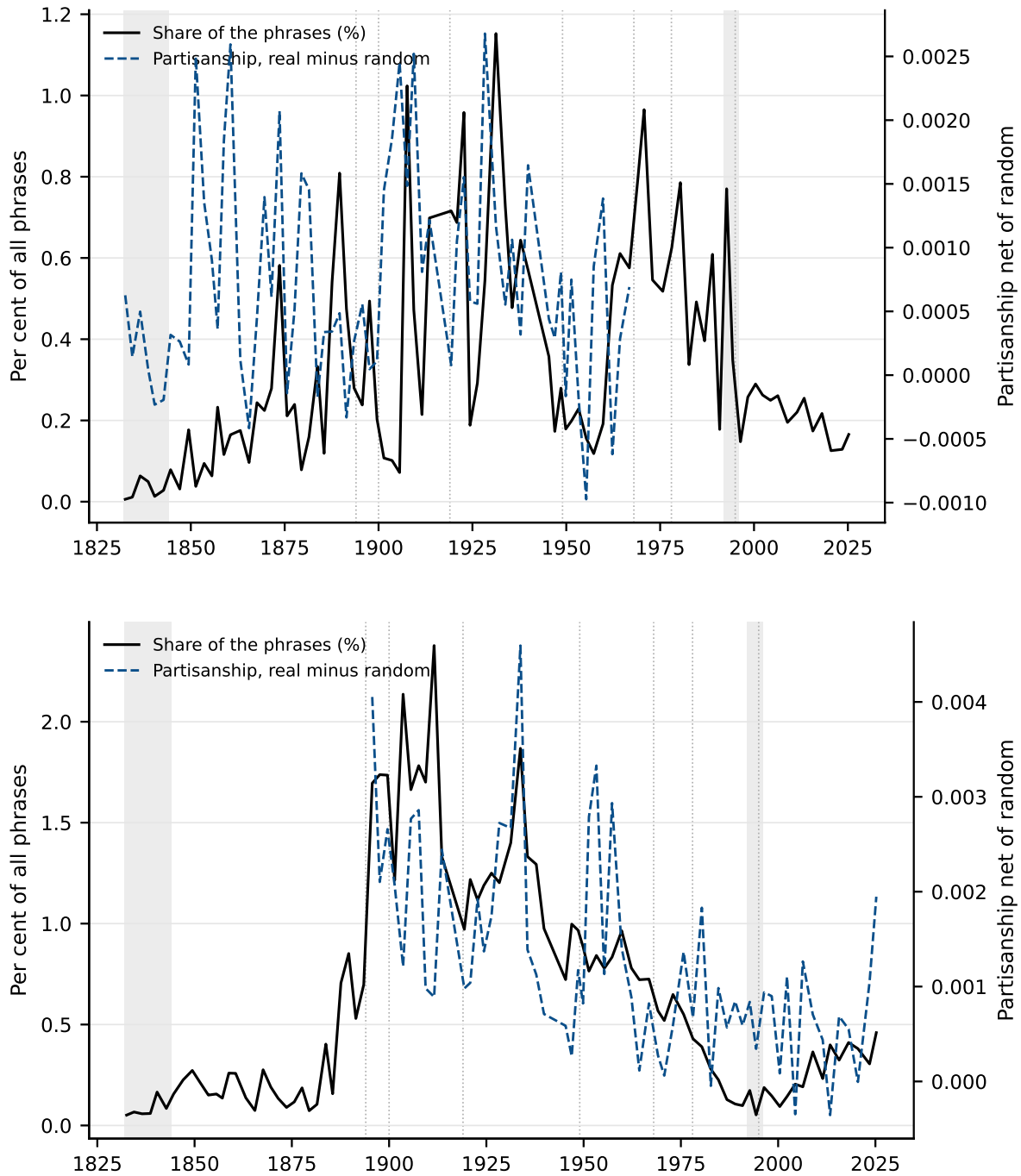


Figure A16: Phrases related to the language question (top) and to labour (bottom)

Figure A17 compares both main speech series with voting differences between the same groups. It uses the party-unlikeness index of Rice (1925), averaged across each period's roll calls. This parallels Gentzkow et al. (2019)'s comparison of speech and roll-call scores in the US Congress. Religious-group voting differences (panel a) are greatest under plural voting (0.46–0.81) and in 1954–1956. Speech and voting do not move together before 1945: correlations are close to zero under census suffrage and negative under plural voting and equal male suffrage. They move together afterwards, with a correlation of 0.60 from 1946–1947 to 1989–1991.

Left–right voting differences (panel b) follow Socialist government status. They range from 0.45 to 0.70 in 1894–1914 and fall to about 0.1 in 1934–1939 and 1961–1965, when Socialists govern. They peak under the centre-right governments of 1981–1987, when speech partisanship is low. Votes therefore follow government–opposition divisions more closely than speech does (Section 5.3). Before 1870, panel (a) uses fewer than 20 roll calls per period.

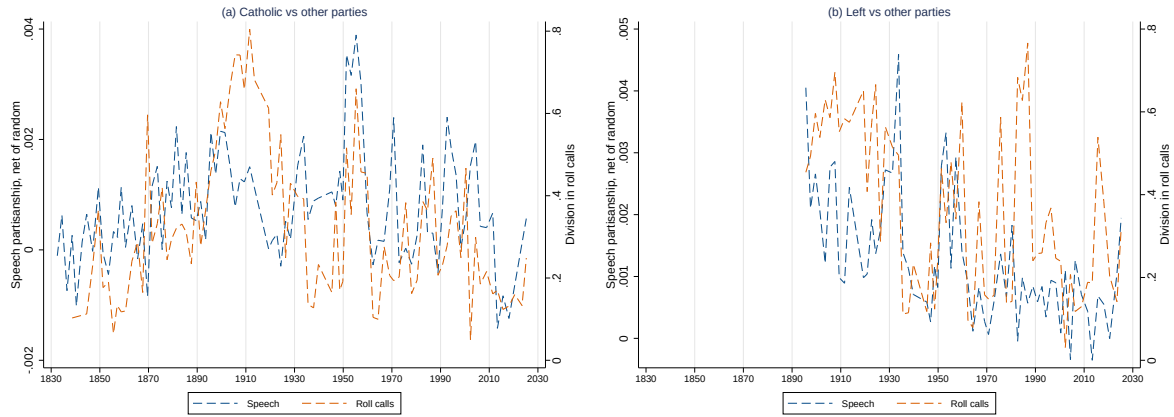


Figure A17: Partisanship in speech and division in roll-call votes

Figure A18 reports the experiment from Section 4. In panel (a), simulated character errors in born-digital reports from 2019–2025 steadily reduce left–right partisanship without covariates. At 5 per cent error, its distance above 0.5 falls to 73 per cent of the clean-text distance. With covariates, attenuation is smaller and irregular, retaining 85 per cent at 5 per cent error. The religious series is undefined.

Panel (b) shows the share of tokens outside a lexicon of words occurring at least twice in each of at least ten periods. For French, this share is 6–12 per cent before 1843 and 1.2–3.0 per cent in 1845–1999, below the 3.8 per cent in clean recent reports. Applied to the experiment, these rates suggest no attenuation after the early 1840s. However, the lexicon also excludes new and rare words. These shares therefore do not yet measure historical OCR error rates (Section 5.8).

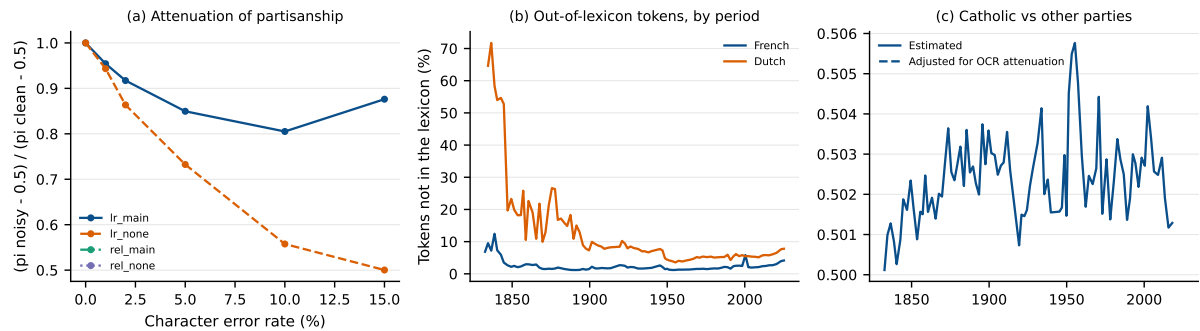


Figure A18: OCR noise and measured partisanship

Notes: (a) Attenuation of partisanship in the born-digital reports of 2019–2025 with simulated OCR errors; the religious series is not defined in these years. (b) Share of the tokens that are not in the reference lexicon (the words used at least twice in each of at least ten periods), by language. (c) Religious partisanship, real series; the series adjusted for the attenuation implied by panel (b) is not defined, because the religious series is not defined in the experiment.

Figure A19 applies Figure 19' decomposition to left–right partisanship. From 1894–1896

to 1912–1914, cumulative leave-out partisanship falls by -0.013 , entirely through renewal; sitting-member changes sum to zero. The First World War adds a further decline, mainly among sitting members. Afterwards, the within component varies sharply across periods, with more than twice renewal’s standard deviation. Its cumulative sum is negative from 1888–1889 to 2022–2024 and turns positive only in the final change to 2024–2025. Across the full sample, renewal subtracts 0.020 and sitting members add 0.012, as in the religious series. However, the components have opposite signs in only three of five institutional periods (Table 7). The pattern in Section 5.6 is therefore weaker for left–right differences.

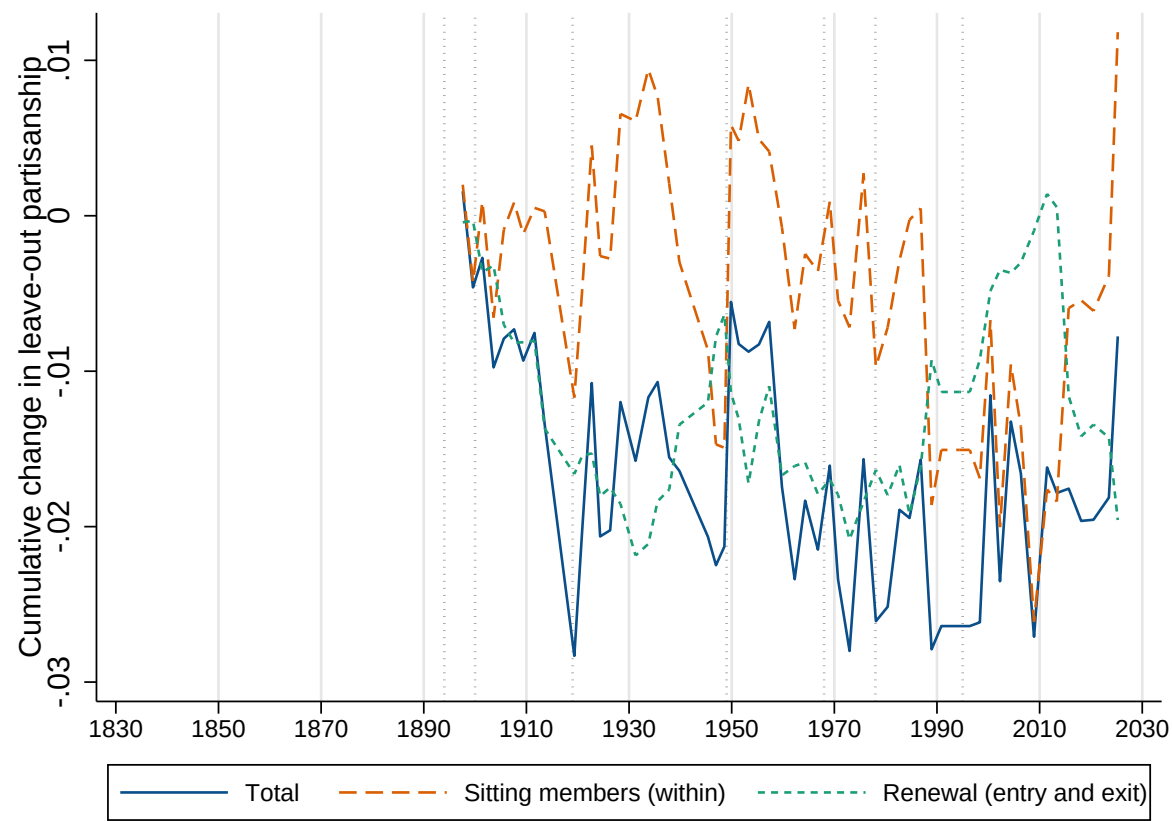


Figure A19: Left–right partisanship: renewal of the Chamber and adaptation of sitting members
Notes: As Figure 19.

Online Appendix B: Data and preprocessing

Sample selection. We start from the dataset’s 3,057,358 blocks and select speech blocks from plenary sittings. Plenary reports are identified by document code from 1999 and by the 1985–1999 classification in `committee_scan.csv` for earlier reports. We exclude the chair’s turns, retain French or Dutch speeches linked to a member or minister through exact, fuzzy or manual matching, and require Chamber membership on the sitting date. Table B1 gives block counts at each step. We retain speeches by members serving as ministers; Online Appendix Figure A10 excludes those delivered in a ministerial capacity.

Table B1: Sample selection

Step	Blocks
All blocks	3,057,358
Speech blocks	2,126,618
In plenary sittings	2,015,293
Not turns of the chair	1,650,454
In French or Dutch, linked to a member or minister	1,625,933
Delivered by members of the Chamber	1,567,306

Preprocessing. We remove parenthetical text containing interruptions, applause and laughter, and rejoin words hyphenated at line breaks. We spell out euro, dollar, per cent and paragraph signs, replace other non-alphanumeric characters with spaces, lowercase the text and split it into words. We remove each language’s Snowball stopwords and single-character tokens, then apply the French and Dutch Snowball stemmers (Porter, 2001). For Dutch, we use the original algorithm, which retains the prefix *ge-*.

We form bigrams from consecutive stems. We remove those containing a member’s or minister’s surname, a party acronym, an address to the chair or colleagues, or a month. We retain surnames printed in lowercase at least half the time, treating them as common words. We also exclude listed procedural phrases and party names. Party adjectives such as *catholique* and *socialiste* remain because they can describe policy objects, as in *enseignement catholique*. The lists are in `code/python/textproc.py`.

Parties. Rules in `code/python/parties.py` map party labels to families, language communities and party units. We manually check these mappings in `party_crosswalk.csv` and use the dataset’s family label when available. A party unit is the national party before its family’s split—Catholics in 1968, Liberals in 1972 and Socialists in 1978—and the language-community party afterwards. A unit is in government on a day if one of its members holds ministerial office. Unionist governments include both Catholics and Liberals.

Districts. We map electoral districts to provinces and the three regions in `code/python/districts.py`, treating Brussels, Flemish Brabant and Walloon Brabant separately.

Groups of phrases. School, Royal Question, language-policy and labour phrases are vocabulary phrases whose stems match the patterns in `code/python/08_dictionary.py`. Matches are listed in `output/phrases/`.

Language of the speeches. Each block uses the dataset's language label. We assess text in the other language by counting phrases containing its function words (`code/python/19_language_check.py`). Examples are *het, een, ik* and *mijnheer* in French counts, and *le, que, dans* and *monsieur* in Dutch counts. We exclude words shared across languages or appearing in proper names, including *de, en, van, je* and *pas*. This check misses other-language phrases without a function word.

In French counts, flagged phrases account for at most 0.2 per cent before 1934, 0.3–1.3 per cent in 1934–1999, 4.5–7 per cent in 1999–2005 and 2–4 per cent afterwards. In Dutch counts, they account for 7–15 per cent in 1919–1953, 4–8 per cent in 1954–1990, 1–3 per cent in 1991–1999 and 5–10 per cent afterwards. There are 326 flagged phrases in the French vocabulary and 868 in the Dutch vocabulary.

Three sources account for most flagged text. First, the record includes translated formulas. From the interwar years to the 1950s, these concern submission of reports and bills (*De heer X legt ter tafel het verslag over het wetsontwerp; sur le bureau de la Chambre le rapport*). From the 1990s, they also close interpellations (*het incident is gesloten, l'incident est clos*). Second, some speeches use both languages. Third, some speeches have the wrong language label.

The effect is largest when flagged text concentrates in one group. In 1950–1954, Dutch-function-word phrases account for 1.6–1.7 per cent of Catholics' French phrases, compared with 0.2–0.4 per cent for Liberals and Socialists. In 1954–1958, the shares reverse to 0.2–0.3 and 0.7–2.6 per cent. After 2010, many Flemish nationalist and Vlaams Belang speeches labeled French are Dutch; flagged phrases account for about two thirds of their French counts in 2019–2024. In 1965–1969, Dutch passages account for 3.6–4.8 per cent of Flemish members' French phrases, versus less than 0.5 per cent for other members. French passages account for 41–50 per cent of Communist members' Dutch phrases in 1969–1981 and also affect Socialist Dutch speech in 1969–1971.

Leave-out estimates without text in the other language. The same script recomputes leave-out series excluding phrases with a function word from the other language. In 1949–1958, these phrases account for 26 per cent of religious, 20 per cent of left–right and 22 per cent of government–opposition partisanship. The corresponding contributions are 30, 21 and 22 per cent in French, and 18, 13 and 17 per cent in Dutch. In other pre-1995 periods, excluding them changes French estimates by 0.0003 on average and at most 0.004. The religious series still peaks in 1956–1958, at 0.026 rather than 0.033.

Flagged text raises several post-1995 estimates. Excluding it lowers government–opposition partisanship from 0.0460 to 0.0234 in 2022–2024 and from 0.0355 to 0.0276 in 2019–2021. The pre-1995 maximum after the same exclusion is 0.0274, compared with 0.0279 before exclusion. Only 2005–2007, during the roll-call-formula years, remains clearly higher at 0.0377. The 2024–2025 left–right estimate changes little, from 0.0356 to 0.0327. Penalized series have not yet been re-estimated with these phrases removed.

The language rule. After the Catholic, Liberal and Socialist families split, their members enter only their community's language estimation. In the reported estimates, this rule does not cover parties associated with one community from their foundation: Flemish nationalists, Vlaams Blok and Vlaams Belang, Francophone regionalists, and the two Green parties. Their members enter both languages. They belong to group *B* in the main series, where their few other-language phrases create only limited noise.

The problem is larger in pairwise comparisons. A party represented in one language by a few mislabeled interventions can produce a component where the groups share almost no phrases. We therefore recombine the multiparty index's previously estimated language components. From 1968, pairs involving Flemish nationalists or the radical right use Dutch only, while pairs involving Francophone regionalists use French only (`code/python/18_multiparty_ownlang.py`). Before 1968, all members enter both languages, as do national-party members. Flemish National League members, for example, did speak French in the 1930s. A full correction requires applying the language rule to every party with a language community and re-estimating the pairs. This will also provide the index's subsampling intervals.

Procedural text. In 1997–2007, many speech blocks end with roll-call formulas: *Début du vote*, *Fin du vote*, *Résultat du vote*, and the Dutch equivalents *Begin van de stemming*, *Einde van de stemming*, *Uitslag van de stemming*. They occur 180–700 times per 100,000 French phrases in 1997–2007 and 320 times in 1993–1995, but never in 1995–1997. Other periods have at most 60 occurrences (`code/python/19_language_check.py`). These formulas concentrate among members speaking just before votes. In 1999–2005, they account for 1,100–1,400 per 100,000 French phrases by Christian-democratic members.

Tables and companion modules. `code/python/20_main_tables.py` produces Tables 1 and 2 from the estimated series. The emotions module's test run supplies the data for Figures 8, 9 and 10, and Section 7 (`code/emotions`; Online Appendix E). `code/python/21_emotions_link.py` reads these outputs and draws the figures. It writes decade correlations to `output/series/emotions_corr.csv` and text macros to `tables/emotions_macros.tex`.

`code/python/22_economy.py` supplies Figure 6 and the growth results in Section 5.7. It reads the Maddison Project Database (`external/mpd2023_web.xlsx`), writes correlations and slopes to `output/series/economy_corr.csv`, and writes text macros to `tables/economy_macros.tex`.

Token files. Token files for all 91 periods supply the very-long-speech counts in Figure 14, panel b (`code/python/14_stata_inputs.py`), and the out-of-lexicon rates in Figure A18, panel b (`code/python/10_ocr_noise.py`).

Files not yet produced. Figure 20 requires the topic of every speech.

Online Appendix C: Most partisan phrases

The tables list each group's five most partisan phrases by $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker in each group. Religious, left-right and government-opposition comparisons cover every period in French and Dutch, with one table per decade. The Flemish-Walloon comparison uses French speech and selects one period every ten years. Phrases are stemmed bigrams displayed in their most frequent unstemmed form. Some leading phrases are text in the other language (Online Appendix B).

Tables C1–C20 (French) and C21–C33 (Dutch) show the religious comparison. Lists reflect government and opposition roles as much as religion. Submission phrases (*projet de loi*, *section centrale*, *honneur de déposer*) belong to the governing side: Catholics in every period from 1884 to 1940 and in 1947–1954, and other parties in 1954–1958. Opposition phrases address ministers by office or name, such as *van houtte* in 1950–1954.

Within this pattern, education appears from 1841–1843 to the second school war. *classe ouvrière* identifies other parties in 18 of 21 periods of 1894–1940. The Royal Question also appears, followed by the Congo and development aid for Catholics in 1958–1971. Dutch lists show the same shifts in submission formulas and assign *eerste minister* to other parties in every period from 1958 to 1999. Where a group lacks strongly partisan phrases, its list contains frequent phrases with nearly equal predicted counts, as for other parties in 1831–1833 and 1988–1989. Dutch roll-call text (*zijn stem*) and words split at accented letters (*matie re*) in 1999–2001 are record artefacts.

The left-right lists appear in Tables C34–C47 and C48–C60. *classe ouvrière* identifies the French-speaking left in every period from 1894 to 1940. Before 1914 it appears alongside universal suffrage, the eight-hour day and labour courts (*conseils de prud'hommes*); in 1932–1934, alongside *pleins pouvoirs*. Social security and trade unions follow, then tax fraud and pension age (67 *ans*) in the federal era. Submission phrases (*projet de loi*, *section centrale*) identify other parties in 25 of 27 periods from 1894 to 1954, then the governing left in 1954–1958. *groupe socialiste* appears in 21 of 23 periods from 1965–1968 to 2012–2014.

In Dutch, the left uses *wij socialisten* and *werkende klas* before 1932. *werkende klas* returns in 1939–1940, 1946–1947 and 2024–2025; *gewone mensen* appears in 2022–2025. The two leading left phrases in 1894–1896 name Zeebrugge port contractors (Figure A14). Record artefacts include bilingual running heads in 1991–1995, words split at accented letters in 1999–2001, and French roll-call text in Dutch lists (*ont répondu*).

Institutional roles dominate the government-opposition lists (Tables C61–C80 and C81–C93). Submission phrases (*projet de loi*, *honneur de déposer*, *section centrale*) identify the governing side in 46 of 49 French periods before 1958. The Dutch equivalent (*ter tafel neerleggen*) appears in every Dutch period from 1927 to 1958. Opposition phrases address ministers in 72 of 79 French periods. *premier ministre* appears in 33 of 37 French periods since 1945, and *eerste minister* in 35 of 38 Dutch periods. In 2012–2024, the opposition also invokes the Council of State.

Current issues mostly identify the opposition: education and universal suffrage before 1914, *pleins pouvoirs* in 1932–1934, the Royal Question, *loi unique* in 1958–1963, and taxation after 2010. In most periods since 2010, governing members thank ministers for answers in French. From 2005, they use *we moeten* ('we must') in Dutch. Dutch roll-call text (*zijn stem*, 1999–2003) and

the split word *matie re*, which heads the governing side's French list in 1999–2001, are record artefacts.

Table C94 shows that regional economic interests mainly distinguish Flemish and Walloon members within the same families. Flemish lists include sugar, Ostend's port and mechanical spinning in 1839–1841; linen in 1848–1850; Ghent and West Flanders in 1888–1890; devastated regions in 1918–1919; the Congo in 1958–1961; and national product and public debt in 1965–1968. Walloon lists include the Société Générale in 1839–1841; the Charleroi canal and Meuse in 1859–1861; working hours and labour courts in 1908–1910; the national coal council in 1949–1950; the European Coal and Steel Community in 1958–1961; and the Walloon motorway in 1965–1968.

Language policy is absent from displayed periods apart from *pays flamand* in 1888–1890 and cultural councils in 1939–1940. In other periods, it appears through Ghent's Flemish university in 1921–1923 and 1925–1927. From 1919, Walloon lists often contain spoken-French expressions such as *tout à l'heure* and *à l'heure actuelle*, appearing in 15 of 22 full-list periods to 1968.

Table C1: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1830s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1831–1833</i>					
ministre justice	252	159	section centrale	430	431
000 fr	193	109	cour cassation	358	359
flandre orientale	92	74	aujourd'hui	355	355
			cour appel	232	233
			projet loi	218	218
<i>1833–1835</i>					
section centrale	1058	899	chemin fer	120	239
conseil communal	231	123	000 fr	186	297
commissaire police	108	29	ministre justice	127	198
loi communale	170	111	ministre guerre	70	134
commissaire arrondissement	62	20	cour comptes	69	103
<i>1835–1837</i>					
los renten	407	57	eh bien	138	176
section centrale	540	441	non activité	20	52
ministres cultes	85	24	caisse épargne	14	46
ministre intérieur	276	224	minerai fer	13	34
société générale	78	37	mines houille	6	23
<i>1837–1839</i>					
section centrale	752	552	chemin fer	330	406
ministre guerre	257	120	vote secret	12	76
sous officiers	65	14	eh bien	130	157
000 hommes	62	18	ministre justice	48	75
état major	56	13	fils laine	5	19
<i>1839–1841</i>					
société générale	232	122	sucre exotique	90	167
section centrale	515	437	tribunal commerce	46	91
affaires étrangères	153	133	chemins vicinaux	42	68
ministre affaires	100	85	redevance mines	12	37
adjudication publique	40	35	caisses prévoyance	8	18

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C2: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1840s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1841–1843</i>					
section centrale	697	537	ministre intérieur	195	346
chemin fer	538	450	écoles normales	166	272
sucre indigène	120	44	cours normaux	24	70
sucre exotique	99	38	loi communale	64	93
pétition datée	26	5	instruction primaire	63	90
<i>1843–1845</i>					
chemin fer	911	565	ministre intérieur	231	429
domicile secours	65	20	aujourd'hui	408	492
bulletin officiel	50	6	ministre finances	162	228
st trond	51	21	droits différentiels	123	167
cahier charges	72	42	pavillon national	31	70
<i>1845–1848</i>					
sucre indigène	104	36	chemin fer	348	496
sucre exotique	81	29	travaux publics	265	371
cour comptes	145	97	ministre intérieur	164	262
dette flottante	52	19	ministre finances	239	311
tribunal commerce	32	7	ministre travaux	149	208
<i>1848–1850</i>					
chemin fer	547	273	section centrale	479	658
ministre intérieur	280	167	ministre guerre	35	82
eh bien	327	247	000 fr	230	269
enseignement religieux	116	44	garde civique	43	75
enseignement moyen	140	78	société générale	21	51

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C3: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1850s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1850–1852</i>					
ministre finances	470	231	section centrale	350	428
chemin fer	732	538	sous rapport	88	134
ministre intérieur	224	140	flandre occidentale	20	63
tout heure	145	86	code civil	36	72
trésor public	100	49	honneur déposer	11	37
<i>1852–1854</i>					
eh bien	315	261	section centrale	477	543
commissaire arrondissement	71	20	000 fr	328	388
ministre finances	188	149	flandre occidentale	36	86
ministre intérieur	296	260	000 hommes	29	64
prohibition sortie	46	16	projet loi	322	350
<i>1854–1856</i>					
pétition datée	138	52	chemin fer	760	872
prohibition sortie	71	30	travaux publics	300	404
lutte denderleeuw	90	50	ministre justice	102	206
fer fort	42	7	section centrale	533	604
libre sortie	61	26	projet loi	407	452
<i>1856–1857</i>					
section centrale	644	461	ministre intérieur	239	438
chemin fer	378	210	ministre justice	68	227
pétition datée	97	32	examen écrit	35	123
000 fr	201	154	personnification civile	31	81
travaux publics	194	150	administrateurs spéciaux	135	158
<i>1857–1859</i>					
ministre intérieur	288	185	section centrale	382	620
pétition datée	152	50	prud hommes	121	268
ministres cultes	206	120	conseils prud	70	201
critique censure	104	26	projet loi	375	455
chemin fer	352	283	contrainte corps	19	96
<i>1859–1861</i>					
ministre finances	294	169	section centrale	310	444
vol domestique	117	22	projet loi	339	419
passe port	87	20	garde civique	7	69
pétition datée	88	30	bruxelles louvain	39	78
eh bien	350	298	000 fr	230	265

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C4: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1860s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1861–1864</i>					
ministre finances	307	148	section centrale	167	319
ministre justice	181	94	projet loi	316	394
ministre intérieur	225	165	garde civique	20	96
eh bien	378	321	servitudes militaires	23	91
pétition datée	92	37	citadelle nord	18	61
<i>1864–1866</i>					
ministre justice	278	152	section centrale	270	401
ministre finances	211	108	projet loi	314	439
ministre intérieur	229	154	chemin fer	385	445
ministre guerre	167	115	honneur déposer	18	60
station intérieure	49	8	déposer bureau	26	54
<i>1866–1868</i>					
ministre finances	349	147	projet loi	283	376
ministre justice	288	149	écoles adultes	65	140
000 hommes	174	84	section centrale	212	273
conseil communal	146	87	loi 1842	92	152
ministre intérieur	208	152	enseignement primaire	38	88
<i>1868–1870</i>					
ministre finances	223	91	sociétés coopératives	3	70
ministre justice	290	190	000 fr	67	120
aujourd'hui	554	497	section centrale	317	368
listes électorales	92	37	assemblée générale	39	87
pétition datée	95	49	sociétés anonymes	78	125

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C5: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1870s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1870–1872</i>					
chemin fer	714	526	ministre intérieur	159	452
section centrale	279	180	ministre finances	117	268
bassins houillers	232	135	écoles moyennes	89	175
compagnie bassins	98	24	banque nationale	54	135
honneur déposer	59	14	ministre guerre	64	135
<i>1872–1874</i>					
section centrale	356	160	ministre finances	137	338
pétition datée	94	21	écoles moyennes	35	183
projet loi	382	309	ministre intérieur	168	300
honneur déposer	84	15	ministre guerre	72	197
déposer bureau	73	18	servitudes militaires	47	143
<i>1874–1876</i>					
section centrale	464	291	garde civique	68	259
honneur déposer	86	14	ministre finances	149	323
tout heure	172	102	chambre commerce	161	275
juge paix	105	53	ministre intérieur	96	210
déposer bureau	71	22	chemin fer	413	516
<i>1876–1878</i>					
section centrale	494	281	ministre intérieur	113	249
tout heure	180	114	ministre justice	91	188
honneur déposer	77	14	écoles moyennes	30	120
déposer bureau	68	15	ministre finances	158	245
bureau chambre	56	12	eh bien	196	266
<i>1878–1880</i>					
ministre intérieur	285	133	chemin fer	313	386
instruction publique	243	105	écoles communales	72	126
ministre justice	193	84	honneur déposer	20	71
ministre instruction	136	42	projet loi	288	332
ministre finances	169	77	section centrale	306	343

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C6: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1880s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1880–1882</i>					
ministre intérieur	306	105	projet loi	261	346
ministre justice	254	79	chemin fer	271	356
instruction publique	187	80	écoles communales	47	108
ministre instruction	119	35	honneur déposer	17	67
ministre guerre	131	59	droit pêche	19	68
<i>1882–1884</i>					
instruction publique	250	89	projet loi	228	310
ministre justice	203	106	honneur déposer	23	66
ministre intérieur	215	121	suffrage universel	33	67
ministre guerre	131	41	déposer bureau	25	56
ministre instruction	124	38	droit électoral	31	60
<i>1884–1886</i>					
section centrale	309	192	écoles communales	149	357
chemin fer	279	190	ministre intérieur	121	214
droit auteur	116	33	pères famille	87	172
tout heure	148	86	instruction publique	76	150
honneur déposer	73	13	écoles adoptées	96	163
<i>1886–1888</i>					
honneur déposer	78	19	ministre guerre	73	202
déposer bureau	71	18	écoles communales	70	179
bureau chambre	69	16	000 hommes	46	118
concordat préventif	61	8	ministre finances	147	207
tout heure	158	112	conseil communal	104	149
<i>1888–1890</i>					
chemin fer	360	265	ministre guerre	79	179
prud hommes	220	142	ministre justice	137	221
conseils prud	155	93	ministre finances	111	191
honneur déposer	75	15	sûreté publique	19	96
déposer bureau	61	12	agents provocateurs	3	46

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C7: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1890s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1890–1892</i>					
fonds commun	104	38	ministre guerre	83	204
honneur déposer	68	19	ministre finances	126	226
ministre justice	198	153	traitement attente	64	131
bureau chambre	62	17	lieutenant général	26	91
déposer bureau	61	18	conseil communal	53	110
<i>1892–1894</i>					
représentation proportionnelle	179	105	suffrage universel	157	283
tout heure	173	125	chemin fer	242	339
projet loi	244	198	droit électoral	60	115
autre part	123	84	députation permanente	49	97
section centrale	163	125	ministre intérieur	98	142
<i>1894–1896</i>					
projet loi	440	318	conseil communal	58	163
ministre finances	285	185	suffrage universel	38	114
droit licence	78	14	classe ouvrière	61	132
chemin fer	365	305	députation permanente	46	93
section centrale	192	136	ministre intérieur	55	97
<i>1896–1898</i>					
section centrale	224	125	classe ouvrière	39	134
projet loi	379	295	suffrage universel	25	83
garde civique	224	155	membres droite	23	73
honneur déposer	57	9	ministre guerre	50	96
unions professionnelles	249	204	ministre justice	111	150
<i>1898–1900</i>					
section centrale	243	148	banque nationale	122	321
projet loi	380	318	classe ouvrière	33	119
juge paix	90	43	tramways bruxellois	29	106
honneur déposer	57	15	suffrage universel	46	117
bureau chambre	47	13	eh bien	146	211

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C8: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1900s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1900–1902</i>					
section centrale	293	149	suffrage universel	199	337
chemin fer	361	253	classe ouvrière	35	108
jeux hasard	99	22	ministre intérieur	58	121
honneur déposer	70	17	ministre justice	92	153
bureau chambre	68	17	représentation proportionnelle	59	115
<i>1902–1904</i>					
chemin fer	469	293	classe ouvrière	44	114
section centrale	226	149	ministre guerre	61	131
chef entreprise	58	17	ministre justice	68	130
autre part	167	130	lieutenant général	29	85
faute lourde	69	32	général cousebant	25	75
<i>1904–1906</i>					
section centrale	195	115	alkemade ministre	66	141
honneur déposer	57	10	ministre guerre	161	234
bureau chambre	58	12	général cousebant	74	147
déposer bureau	55	11	cousebant alkemade	66	138
repos dominical	84	49	lieutenant général	81	150
<i>1906–1908</i>					
section centrale	206	120	ministre guerre	50	142
langue flamande	97	46	classe ouvrière	25	99
projet loi	231	188	lieutenant général	17	84
honneur déposer	59	18	eh bien	139	188
bureau chambre	57	18	conseil communal	52	88
<i>1908–1910</i>					
section centrale	196	104	chemin fer	299	376
comité spécial	103	25	classe ouvrière	31	95
ministre guerre	202	130	fer postes	31	84
loi 1902	74	21	ministre chemins	58	109
000 hommes	75	27	écoles normales	35	85

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C9: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1910s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1910–1912</i>					
caisses prévoyance	133	36	ministre guerre	71	185
chemin fer	418	338	classe ouvrière	43	139
section centrale	139	72	lieutenant général	17	96
déposer bureau	58	13	général hellebaut	13	76
honneur déposer	60	15	hellebaut ministre	7	68
<i>1912–1914</i>					
projet loi	289	227	écoles communales	78	180
honneur déposer	65	19	classe ouvrière	41	143
déposer bureau	55	11	écoles adoptées	89	141
bureau chambre	58	15	suffrage universel	67	114
section centrale	141	108	ministre guerre	91	137
<i>1918–1919</i>					
section centrale	384	309	classe ouvrière	55	107
dommages guerre	178	134	comité national	43	85
projet loi	474	432	avant guerre	127	162
honneur déposer	90	60	chemin fer	134	162
oeuvre nationale	36	8	pendant guerre	143	167
<i>1919–1921</i>					
section centrale	218	163	classe ouvrière	83	170
ministre justice	136	94	temps service	16	63
honneur déposer	86	58	avant guerre	136	182
administration centrale	42	15	huit heures	33	74
doit être	178	155	premier ministre	76	114

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C10: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1920s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1921–1923</i>					
gardes champêtres	142	50	chemin fer	229	287
projet loi	254	196	écoles normales	30	77
section centrale	142	87	écoles moyennes	15	43
chambre rapport	59	14	classe ouvrière	70	95
honneur déposer	83	39	avant guerre	121	141
<i>1923–1925</i>					
section centrale	214	149	dommages guerre	44	86
projet loi	342	278	service sauvetage	6	46
déposer bureau	89	32	classe ouvrière	31	64
bureau chambre	85	33	droits spécifiques	12	44
chambre rapport	66	16	avant guerre	102	133
<i>1925–1927</i>					
section centrale	277	150	chemin fer	244	329
code civil	57	15	classe ouvrière	41	121
neuf ans	75	33	avant guerre	75	133
chambre rapport	55	15	huit heures	31	82
honneur déposer	79	47	premier ministre	94	118
<i>1927–1929</i>					
section centrale	246	155	défense nationale	87	164
bureau chambre	99	35	premier ministre	79	137
déposer bureau	96	33	classe ouvrière	43	94
honneur déposer	103	43	avant guerre	74	115
projet loi	353	294	personnel enseignant	21	59
<i>1929–1932</i>					
projet loi	360	275	premier ministre	91	184
honneur déposer	86	39	société nationale	101	149
déposer bureau	76	30	classe ouvrière	68	113
bureau chambre	75	31	ministre finances	104	145
chambre rapport	55	14	ministre industrie	50	91

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C11: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1930s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1932–1934</i>					
allocations familiales	128	58	pleins pouvoirs	35	137
honneur déposer	99	34	démocrates chrétiens	26	116
déposer bureau	92	28	classe ouvrière	116	197
bureau chambre	94	32	défense nationale	53	134
chambre rapport	65	13	ministre défense	27	73
<i>1934–1936</i>					
gouverneur général	46	2	défense nationale	75	156
prix revient	73	35	arrêtés lois	47	118
prix vente	40	8	classe ouvrière	48	112
honneur déposer	84	53	société nationale	127	187
pouvoirs spéciaux	103	72	chemin fer	161	206
<i>1936–1939</i>					
projet loi	361	256	premier ministre	197	243
taxe crise	77	23	ministre affaires	60	106
arrêté royal	206	160	affaires étrangères	47	93
000 kilogrammes	46	10	ministre justice	56	85
commission finances	69	33	non intervention	18	41
<i>1939–1940</i>					
chemin fer	143	71	ministre justice	48	88
pommes terre	73	18	personnel enseignant	25	62
projet loi	277	233	nationalistes flamands	10	42
société nationale	121	82	instruction publique	96	124
commission bancaire	59	20	politique indépendance	8	34

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C12: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1940s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1944–1946</i>					
premier ministre	338	217	conseil etat	54	208
ministre finances	240	125	prisonniers politiques	102	186
000 000	123	33	secours civil	11	58
impôt capital	83	29	000 tonnes	32	62
impôt spécial	69	21	assistance publique	9	39
<i>1946–1947</i>					
allocations familiales	157	47	assistance publique	15	88
ministre finances	181	126	prisonniers politiques	77	120
sous officiers	63	10	heure actuelle	84	127
premier ministre	196	145	commissions assistance	17	51
pouvoirs spéciaux	50	7	personnel enseignant	13	44
<i>1947–1949</i>					
banque nationale	138	49	premier ministre	167	204
ministre finances	150	71	organisations syndicales	8	43
projet loi	331	255	prisonniers politiques	32	67
neuf ans	82	8	classe ouvrière	23	56
juge paix	102	36	affaires étrangères	60	93
<i>1949–1950</i>					
assurés libres	70	15	consultation populaire	177	353
pouvoirs représentants	47	8	premier ministre	187	297
honneur déposer	80	45	question royale	92	132
central provincial	42	7	société nationale	34	67
collège électoral	52	20	budget 1950	6	29

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C13: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1950s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1950–1952</i>					
projet loi	375	232	premier ministre	133	392
honneur déposer	155	25	sécurité sociale	49	115
bureau chambre	158	30	personnel enseignant	28	86
déposer bureau	155	29	van houtte	18	71
chambre rapport	124	13	classe ouvrière	29	76
<i>1952–1954</i>					
projet loi	491	285	premier ministre	147	199
honneur déposer	218	32	van houtte	17	69
déposer bureau	211	31	assurés libres	24	72
bureau chambre	215	35	plan schuman	16	63
chambre rapport	174	8	victimes civiles	36	76
<i>1954–1956</i>					
instruction publique	205	90	déposer bureau	30	122
ministre instruction	151	45	honneur déposer	28	119
premier ministre	199	100	bureau chambre	37	123
enseignement moyen	200	101	projet loi	233	301
enseignement libre	259	183	travailleurs indépendants	47	110
<i>1956–1958</i>					
premier ministre	264	91	honneur déposer	19	148
conseil etat	144	26	projet loi	247	373
pouvoirs spéciaux	76	11	bureau chambre	23	148
ministre finances	181	132	déposer bureau	23	147
allocations familiales	115	73	chambre rapport	16	117
<i>1958–1961</i>					
autre part	236	165	premier ministre	208	522
politique scientifique	48	4	tout heure	177	245
allocations familiales	120	85	loi unique	63	121
ruanda urundi	100	67	aujourd'hui	392	438
force publique	57	24	classe ouvrière	25	67

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C14: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1960s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1961–1963</i>					
assistance technique	123	22	education nationale	52	98
chemin fer	173	109	classe ouvrière	11	53
ministre finances	125	67	ministre affaires	96	137
projet loi	332	284	affaires économiques	65	95
arrêté royal	169	122	premier ministre	172	201
<i>1963–1965</i>					
assistance technique	143	26	aujourd'hui	322	397
pays voie	67	8	corps médical	80	132
voie développement	64	7	victimes guerre	16	64
arrêté royal	171	127	etats unis	59	101
outre mer	49	6	maladie invalidité	118	155
<i>1965–1968</i>					
cour comptes	95	23	premier ministre	329	543
assistance technique	83	11	assurance maladie	57	93
doit être	220	162	pouvoirs spéciaux	59	94
chemin fer	97	49	maladie invalidité	55	86
arrêté royal	171	125	pacte scolaire	45	74
<i>1968–1969</i>					
affaires étrangères	190	80	personnes âgées	10	61
registre national	98	2	organisations syndicales	26	67
education nationale	134	68	assistance publique	15	48
coopération développement	78	16	ministre intérieur	48	66
nations unies	72	12	000 tonnes	12	27
<i>1969–1971</i>					
pays voie	283	26	projet loi	192	274
voie développement	265	25	police judiciaire	16	95
affaires étrangères	207	75	santé publique	36	103
coopération développement	130	15	affaires économiques	91	154
parlement européen	134	39	premier ministre	183	239

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C15: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1970s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1971–1974</i>					
classes moyennes	158	56	certain nombre	95	163
santé publique	115	66	ministre affaires	111	155
société nationale	78	31	education nationale	30	73
aménagement territoire	89	47	affaires économiques	138	171
exposé général	65	23	expansion économique	68	101
<i>1974–1977</i>					
arrondissement mons	105	5	premier ministre	344	467
langue allemande	87	18	aide sociale	18	98
économique sociale	126	65	certain nombre	132	202
catégories sociales	54	7	travailleurs indépendants	26	77
partenaires sociaux	57	21	secrétaire etat	112	151
<i>1977–1978</i>					
finances publiques	226	50	certain nombre	163	226
langue allemande	128	25	premier ministre	405	453
régional wallon	117	53	plan secteur	13	56
conseil régional	105	53	affaires bruxelloises	7	35
pouvoirs spéciaux	128	78	travailleurs indépendants	43	58
<i>1979–1981</i>					
communauté germanophone	114	23	premier ministre	527	600
conseil ministres	167	75	conseil etat	72	108
parlement européen	77	13	article 107quater	18	46
affaires étrangères	114	62	organisations syndicales	26	54
coopération développement	84	33	communautés régions	29	57

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C16: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1980s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1981–1983</i>					
crédits provisoires	217	65	pouvoirs spéciaux	223	494
ministre intérieur	186	71	premier ministre	353	490
politique scientifique	126	17	conseil etat	125	244
circuit travail	105	11	cockerillambre	3	75
communautés régions	94	30	avis conseil	50	83
<i>1983–1985</i>					
ministre intérieur	191	81	education nationale	42	111
temps travail	137	31	conseil etat	154	197
langue allemande	108	7	ministre justice	48	88
maintien ordre	104	23	chef établissement	16	40
police communale	94	14	plan secteur	6	28
<i>1985–1987</i>					
région bruxelloise	281	141	education nationale	58	123
van der	152	46	premier ministre	809	814
secteurs nationaux	95	20	aujourd'hui	535	539
entreprises secteur	58	6	projet loi	309	311
cockerillambre	50	3	ministre justice	81	83
<i>1988–1989</i>					
société canal	115	11	aujourd'hui	711	717
communauté germanophone	87	8	premier ministre	639	644
mouscron comines	87	11	ministre chers	282	285
mise place	145	72	séance plénière	247	249
accord coopération	109	45	van volksvertegenwoordigers	228	230
<i>1989–1991</i>					
précompte mobilier	152	47	premier ministre	550	707
précompte professionnel	82	30	affaires étrangères	101	158
union nationale	68	20	ministre affaires	95	144
détention préventive	76	28	secrétaires communaux	21	55
spéciale impôts	51	4	ministre intérieur	77	94

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C17: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1990s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1995–1997</i>					
nations unies	112	11	premier ministre	349	658
banque nationale	99	14	ministre justice	89	141
bancaire financière	82	7	motion pure	43	80
commission bancaire	89	16	mons borinage	10	15
force armée	98	42	aujourd'hui	615	617
<i>1997–1999</i>					
union européenne	240	66	premier ministre	286	474
banque nationale	159	13	conseil état	86	159
banque centrale	125	28	motion pure	32	104
remercie ministre	121	42	libération conditionnelle	138	186
langue allemande	76	4	certain nombre	189	236
<i>1999–2001</i>					
premier ministre	893	363	matie re	216	457
motion pure	261	76	certain nombre	192	349
zijn stem	147	72	services police	69	137
stem gecontroleerd	146	72	supplé mentaires	23	81
amendement nr	147	80	police fédérale	53	101

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C18: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 2000s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2001–2003</i>					
premier ministre	735	359	criminalité organisée	27	122
motion pure	224	34	certain nombre	193	289
soins palliatifs	192	12	travail intérêt	15	85
conseil etat	197	96	peine travail	22	79
amendement nr	130	32	police fédérale	38	88
<i>2003–2005</i>					
jean jacques	200	20	ministre justice	120	139
premier ministre	477	368	aujourd'hui	714	724
réductions cotisations	117	22	projet loi	440	446
communautés régions	97	22	proposition loi	303	307
hal vilvorde	120	46	certain nombre	230	233
<i>2007–2010</i>					
partenaires sociaux	271	96	commission enquête	72	146
premier ministre	525	433	demandeurs asile	15	64
demandeurs emploi	99	32	certain nombre	115	152
manière dont	110	47	pays européens	25	52
cour appel	84	26	médecins généralistes	29	55

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C19: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 2010s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2014–2016</i>					
premier ministre	1098	947	union européenne	179	240
ministre intérieur	124	66	saut index	68	112
contre terrorisme	124	72	sécurité sociale	99	139
aujourd'hui	1116	1071	doel doel	28	64
voitures société	57	15	arabie saoudite	24	52
<i>2016–2019</i>					
projet loi	525	441	sécurité sociale	171	217
secret professionnel	74	26	saut index	10	52
arabie saoudite	103	55	pension points	8	38
spf finances	53	13	67 ans	8	36
manière dont	103	70	droits femmes	21	48

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\xi}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C20: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 2020s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2024–2025</i>					
union européenne	324	144	premier ministre	285	654
remercie réponse	158	45	500 euros	23	113
projet loi	244	148	000 euros	117	193
coopération développement	55	17	flexi jobs	28	85
moyen orient	32	10	67 ans	17	60

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C21: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1900s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1900–1902</i>					
frank toe	1030	195	000 frank	824	837
vlaamsche volk	659	254	werkende klas	303	312
			algemeen stemrecht	526	533
			minister landbouw	586	593
			voorzien artikel	265	271
<i>1902–1904</i>					
mager vee	1598	858	wij socialisten	24	73
			minister landbouw	839	847
			vlaamsche taal	608	613
			vlaamsche land	447	451
			ten minste	485	488
<i>1904–1906</i>					
000 frank	1128	1121	frank toe	251	680
ont répondu	341	337			
répondu non	184	181			
toe kennen	251	249			
kleine bedienden	412	409			
<i>1906–1908</i>					
000 frank	618	613	nationale bank	118	546
gij hebt	490	485	bedienden werkliden	125	385
mager vee	363	359	mijne hoeren	40	180
jaar dienst	413	409	wij socialisten	15	101
vlaamsche volk	364	360	private nijverheid	29	97
<i>1908–1910</i>					
indien gij	401	180	wij socialisten	17	154
kleine bedienden	236	78	burgerlijke stand	67	197
zult gij	414	278	ambtenaar burgerlijke	52	157
wetenschappen kunsten	47	47	land waas	27	56
arrondissement antwerpen	68	68	gij hebt	565	566

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C22: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1910s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1910–1912</i>					
000 frank	780	774	frank toe	133	508
werkende klas	336	331	private nijverheid	18	293
toe kennen	299	296			
ten minste	454	451			
000 000	204	202			
<i>1912–1914</i>					
algemeen stemrecht	658	245	tweede taal	42	275
gij hebt	465	462	lager onderwijs	91	292
000 frank	514	511	lagere scholen	105	295
zeer wel	473	470	14 jaar	162	297
gij zult	438	436	wij socialisten	7	118
<i>1918–1919</i>					
			00 uur	4	4
			sociale wetten	3	3
			sociale wetgeving	3	3
			sociale woningen	3	3
			sociale woningbouw	3	3
<i>1919–1921</i>					
landelijke politie	329	14	werkende klas	144	381
syndicale vrijheid	137	14	koninklijk besluit	240	349
afschaffing artikel	168	62	politieke gevangenen	49	137
lager onderwijs	91	29	oud strijders	419	499
land waes	82	25	hebt gij	61	119

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C23: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1920s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1921–1923</i>					
middelbaar onderwijs	475	126	000 frank	914	1300
lager onderwijs	358	178	oud strijders	111	238
vierde graad	152	40	vlaamsche waalsche	71	169
landelijke politie	201	98	werkende klas	48	142
eerste minister	169	69	vlaamsche soldaten	48	129
<i>1923–1925</i>					
artikel 10	282	94	vlaamsche nationalisten	1	109
artikel 57	209	55	000 frank	1109	1120
vierde graad	156	36	binnenlandsche zaken	508	512
kroostrijke gezinnen	129	12	minister binnenlandsche	394	398
wet 20	217	106	ten minste	370	374
<i>1925–1927</i>					
onze soldaten	153	38	vlaamsche nationalisten	42	181
minister landsverdediging	302	225	oud strijders	142	229
militaire overheid	120	46	nationale bank	81	161
eer bureel	79	13	vlaamsch nationale	16	74
tussen beide	110	44	onze groep	62	113
<i>1927–1929</i>					
000 frank	1013	761	oud strijders	188	361
kroostrijke gezinnen	277	87	fransch belgisch	31	139
koninklijk besluit	429	288	zes maanden	281	383
neer leggen	200	70	vlaamsche nationalisten	39	133
eer bureel	134	5	militair akkoord	17	93
<i>1929–1932</i>					
neer leggen	304	70	vlaamsche nationalisten	47	226
kamer neer	237	25	vlaamsche volk	109	247
eer bureel	196	13	gij hebt	287	410
kroostrijke gezinnen	206	58	eerste minister	173	294
bureel kamer	194	53	vlaamsch nationale	11	121

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C24: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1930s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1932–1934</i>					
maatschappij buurtspoorwegen	270	15	eerste minister	7	163
nationale maatschappij	380	135	vlaamsche nationalisten	41	164
eer bureel	229	12	hebt gij	176	292
leggen verslag	215	11	vlaamsche volk	105	201
neer leggen	272	77	gij hebt	332	403
<i>1934–1936</i>					
kroostrijke gezinnen	219	57	vlaamsche volk	69	291
eerste minister	529	372	oud strijders	56	199
kadastraal inkomen	198	56	gij hebt	164	303
koninklijk besluit	520	394	000 000	239	347
brusselsche agglomeratie	163	43	hebt gij	63	162
<i>1936–1939</i>					
ter tafel	481	270	gij hebt	158	293
neer leggen	308	110	gij zijt	100	205
nationale bank	289	95	vlaamsche nationalisten	76	167
eer ter	205	49	hebt gij	61	150
koninklijk besluit	466	325	wij weten	156	230
<i>1939–1940</i>					
technisch onderwijs	436	117	vlaamsch nationale	19	176
nationale maatschappij	475	224	vlaamsche nationalisten	52	177
000 000	309	123	onze groep	23	99
koninklijk besluit	451	305	vlaamsche volk	50	115
eer ter	190	58	vlaamsche soldaten	23	82

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C25: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1940s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1944–1946</i>					
dienst pensioenen	325	90	eer ter	140	278
kroostrijke gezinnen	198	31	eerste minister	674	793
000 000	555	429	tafel neer	147	263
ambachten neringen	112	49	ter tafel	373	487
zwarte markt	213	213	hebt gij	57	101
<i>1946–1947</i>					
eerste minister	721	205	dienst pensioenen	50	267
technisch onderwijs	221	113	politieke gevangenen	83	273
ambachten neringen	115	12	economische unie	92	193
000 ton	219	145	economische problemen	20	87
minister financiën	216	146	tafel neer	125	188
<i>1947–1949</i>					
ter tafel	541	334	millioen frank	82	173
eer ter	331	201	centraal bestuur	33	116
tafel neer	311	197	grote steden	35	115
kroostrijke gezinnen	129	31	socialistische groep	23	93
verslag wetsontwerp	287	190	fonds gemeenten	34	94
<i>1949–1950</i>					
tafel neer	414	51	eerste minister	273	895
ter tafel	496	137	ten slotte	349	354
eer ter	412	54	wanneer wij	304	308
leggen verslag	352	60	legt ter	81	85
verslag wetsontwerp	340	80	000 frank	222	226

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C26: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1950s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1950–1952</i>					
ter tafel	671	51	eerste minister	144	554
verslag wetsontwerp	511	35	gij hebt	113	271
eer ter	412	22	minister financiën	118	257
tafel neer	408	20	vier twintig	48	148
neer leggen	411	80	000 000	82	180
<i>1952–1954</i>					
ter tafel	937	75	eerste minister	145	659
eer ter	605	32	twintig maanden	80	308
tafel neer	588	30	achttien maanden	38	242
verslag wetsontwerp	604	49	gij hebt	126	290
neer leggen	559	107	hebt gij	28	190
<i>1954–1956</i>					
eerste minister	707	270	ter tafel	47	726
technisch onderwijs	259	30	tafel neer	23	478
wet 29	232	85	eer ter	27	481
minister financiën	368	229	verslag wetsontwerp	22	475
vrij verzekeren	242	107	neer leggen	53	408
<i>1956–1958</i>					
eerste minister	680	134	ter tafel	68	619
belgisch congo	224	114	tafel neer	39	478
ten laste	173	67	eer ter	37	475
000 frank	651	546	neer leggen	68	432
technisch onderwijs	147	48	verslag wetsontwerp	45	400
<i>1958–1961</i>					
koninklijk besluit	236	162	eerste minister	390	1468
economische politiek	162	92	gij hebt	226	419
regionale economie	73	17	minister financiën	177	360
regionale economische	90	33	000 000	78	181
000 ton	80	27	nationale bank	13	106

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C27: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1960s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1961–1963</i>					
dienst pensioenen	196	53	000 frank	340	497
buitenlandse zaken	203	124	eerste minister	190	340
verenigde staten	138	66	minister nationale	35	97
haven antwerpen	123	55	vitale belangen	11	67
kadastraal inkomen	185	117	economische politiek	62	111
<i>1963–1965</i>					
nationale maatschappij	142	70	nationale opvoeding	148	282
koninklijk besluit	298	229	eerste minister	110	220
speciaal onderstandsfonds	71	24	tweede taal	65	172
miljoen frank	121	83	nationale kas	13	111
ten laste	212	178	twee gemeenschappen	12	86
<i>1965–1968</i>					
openbare werken	233	168	eerste minister	475	940
wetenschappelijk onderzoek	100	48	nationale opvoeding	189	322
ervan overtuigd	136	86	vrije universiteiten	17	106
sociaal statuut	107	73	ten opzichte	82	143
speciaal onderstandsfonds	42	8	vice gouverneur	9	58
<i>1968–1969</i>					
openbare onderstand	168	52	eerste minister	212	364
gewaarborgd inkomen	125	30	vaste commissie	19	122
collectieve arbeidsovereenkomsten	92	7	technische ingenieurs	70	172
miljoen frank	129	53	commissie taaltoezicht	26	102
sociale voorzorg	192	125	hoger onderwijs	78	142
<i>1969–1971</i>					
hoger onderwijs	246	66	eerste minister	141	432
nationale maatschappij	195	88	ter zake	320	442
koninklijk besluit	522	419	nationale opvoeding	117	188
gewaarborgd inkomen	76	16	lager onderwijs	34	98
rusten overlevingspensioenen	60	9	minister geachte	121	181

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C28: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1970s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1971–1974</i>					
geachte lid	189	68	eerste minister	277	624
buitengewoon onderwijs	140	33	sociale voorzorg	76	201
departement openbare	100	48	vorige regering	102	169
economische groei	80	28	bestendige deputatie	38	94
jonge mensen	75	27	belgische staat	32	75
<i>1974–1977</i>					
wij moeten	341	225	eerste minister	333	1096
hoger onderwijs	186	93	binnenlandse zaken	184	307
minder validen	140	63	minister binnenlandse	101	210
sociale voorzorg	137	78	ationale opvoeding	124	217
ervan overtuigd	123	75	minister financiën	78	151
<i>1977–1978</i>					
vlaamse gemeenschap	124	76	eerste minister	516	986
kleine ondernemingen	47	11	openbaar vervoer	42	170
vlaamse gewest	82	46	nationale investeringsmaatschappij	6	95
buitenlandse handel	163	137	europese verkiezingen	112	190
binnen grenzen	39	15	toegevoegd minister	33	104
<i>1979–1981</i>					
koninklijk besluit	407	280	eerste minister	638	1263
hoofdstedelijk gebied	135	28	minister geachte	226	319
miljard frank	127	44	buitenlandse zaken	115	169
miljoen frank	148	77	studiemeester opvoeder	4	54
persoonsgebonden materies	131	63	vlaamse socialisten	18	69

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C29: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1980s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1981–1983</i>					
europese commissie	222	47	eerste minister	528	1046
wij moeten	416	254	openbare ziekenhuizen	26	98
cockerill sambre	311	151	minister financiën	108	179
miljoen frank	207	51	minister geachte	214	265
europese gemeenschap	241	123	besluit nr	67	114
<i>1983–1985</i>					
wij moeten	377	203	eerste minister	426	939
ten aanzien	317	163	koninklijk besluit	375	507
nationale sectoren	160	82	ter zake	590	681
zuid afrika	116	50	minister geachte	297	377
vraag gesteld	251	187	besluit nr	111	189
<i>1985–1987</i>					
bijzondere machten	274	114	eerste minister	849	2038
europese gemeenschap	259	159	geantwoord mm	14	106
ervan overtuigd	167	92	wetenschappelijk onderzoek	109	195
sociale gesprekspartners	83	11	ont répondu	22	103
buitenlandse zaken	125	77	vice premier	59	126
<i>1988–1989</i>					
nationale bank	253	132	eerste minister	713	1209
roerende voorheffing	178	76	mm michel	52	150
miljard frank	186	110	minister geachte	207	293
ten aanzien	212	149	se sont	14	95
miljoen frank	77	31	sont abstenus	14	93
<i>1989–1991</i>					
europese gemeenschap	391	206	eerste minister	618	1690
onze fractie	266	106	juillet 1991	106	242
miljard frank	183	102	vergadering vrijdag	51	117
nationale bank	135	64	du vendredi	55	118
ten aanzien	163	103	openbaar vervoer	97	140

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C30: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1990s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1991–1993</i>					
procent bnp	538	105	eerste minister	388	1494
hoofdstedelijk gewest	285	23			
vice gouverneur	91	28			
annales handelingen	1119	1114			
volksvertegenwoordigers belgië	1137	1133			
<i>1993–1995</i>					
parket generaal	158	29	eerste minister	446	1987
kamer volksvertegenwoordigers	1280	1260	miljard frank	283	433
volksvertegenwoordigers belgië	1236	1216			
belgië législature	1232	1212			
48e zittingsperiode	1234	1214			
<i>1995–1997</i>					
commissie dutroux	225	63	eerste minister	914	2181
procureur generaal	384	264	miljard frank	346	577
welke mate	132	34	politieke benoemingen	38	99
korte termijn	158	79	chronische zieken	60	106
gemeen recht	98	23			
<i>1997–1999</i>					
koninklijk besluit	491	276	eerste minister	501	1302
voorwaardelijke invrijheidstelling	281	66	miljard frank	196	358
procureur generaal	334	186	miljoen frank	88	205
commissie justitie	214	88	politieke benoemingen	19	65
procureur konings	183	97	kamer volksvertegenwoordigers	1057	1067
<i>1999–2001</i>					
eerste minister	1805	1457	mondelinge vraag	279	486
federale politie	308	101	halle vilvoorde	84	280
behoorlijk bestuur	186	7	gesloten incident	274	426
minister justitie	641	524	question orale	156	278
binnenlandse zaken	675	580	est clos	335	443

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C31: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2000s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2001–2003</i>					
eerste minister	1897	1461	les membres	32	152
minister justitie	686	319	europese unie	120	235
veiligheid staat	341	119	lambermont akkoord	94	197
ten aanzien	295	126	georganiseerde misdaad	25	101
amendement nr	178	57	gestemd les	37	111
<i>2003–2005</i>					
eerste minister	1369	833	europese unie	91	298
amendement nr	403	27	belg wet	110	252
openbaar ministerie	177	44	snel belg	113	253
bijgevolg amendement	123	4	sociale partners	79	144
amendement verworpen	135	18	nieuwe belgen	10	68
<i>2005–2007</i>					
eerste minister	1335	641	europese unie	86	292
miljoen euro	570	350	sociale partners	56	210
diverse bepalingen	156	41	schriftelijk verslag	75	144
miljard euro	218	110	goede zaak	71	132
houdende diverse	124	40	wettelijke samenwoning	26	83
<i>2007–2010</i>					
wij moeten	494	321	eerste minister	483	1558
nmbs groep	145	15	notionele intrestaftek	13	95
ter zake	468	358	miljard euro	300	356
openbaar ministerie	128	29	halle vilvoorde	84	135
sociale partners	301	206	minister financiën	111	161

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C32: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2010s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2010–2012</i>					
wij moeten	690	531	eerste minister	433	972
sociale partners	215	85	miljard euro	174	329
nationale bank	304	182	minnelijke schikking	45	192
nmbs groep	146	27	algemene vergadering	51	94
bilaterale akkoorden	121	21	diverse bepalingen	76	113
<i>2012–2014</i>					
sociale partners	417	240	miljard euro	216	446
voorliggend ontwerp	209	74	eerste minister	555	663
wij moeten	527	439	europese unie	361	447
burgerlijke stand	108	42	koninklijke familie	11	74
ambtenaar burgerlijke	91	27	prins laurent	8	66
<i>2014–2016</i>					
sociale partners	450	218	eerste minister	836	1171
dank antwoord	301	190	saudi arabie	5	72
minister dank	324	237	saoedi arabie	26	73
wij moeten	746	668	burn out	2	21
economische groei	151	73	ten tweede	465	470
<i>2016–2019</i>					
wij moeten	751	576	eerste minister	738	1177
minister dank	302	200	72 uur	27	105
europese commissie	215	119	saudi arabie	146	216
voorlopige hechtenis	116	34	jobs jobs	42	96
goede zaak	222	139	miljard euro	146	186

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C33: Most partisan phrases, Catholic and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2020s

Catholic			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2024–2025</i>					
we moeten	1277	824	miljard euro	291	677
nationale loterij	193	55	eerste minister	476	662
absoluut nodig	125	11	miljoen euro	598	602
zodat we	200	90	incident est	500	504
we ervoor	190	81	est clos	500	504

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Catholic: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 1; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C34: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1890s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1894–1896</i>					
mm cousin	676	22	ministre finances	116	275
cousin coiseau	626	27	projet loi	309	415
classe ouvrière	192	53	section centrale	108	183
cahier charges	91	28	droit licence	6	76
eh bien	219	159	honneur déposer	12	62
<i>1896–1898</i>					
classe ouvrière	181	36	garde civique	134	233
eh bien	198	133	section centrale	114	208
membres droite	86	26	ministre finances	85	159
suffrage universel	83	30	projet loi	307	355
rappel ordre	52	10	honneur déposer	6	52
<i>1898–1900</i>					
banque nationale	355	125	section centrale	138	227
classe ouvrière	162	28	juge paix	24	102
eh bien	238	147	ministre justice	85	131
caisse épargne	140	63	députation permanente	35	80
suffrage universel	126	51	conseil guerre	39	83

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{ji}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C35: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1900s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1900–1902</i>					
suffrage universel	457	216	section centrale	119	251
classe ouvrière	180	32	chemin fer	225	329
ministre guerre	230	157	projet loi	196	266
eh bien	255	186	jeux hasard	9	73
major cousebant	114	61	cercles privés	10	61
<i>1902–1904</i>					
classe ouvrière	176	41	section centrale	125	213
eh bien	217	166	chemin fer	319	404
membres droite	68	20	conseil communal	50	100
heures travail	57	12	faute lourde	25	63
prix viande	73	32	déposer bureau	9	41
<i>1904–1906</i>					
classe ouvrière	155	39	section centrale	104	170
ministre guerre	269	178	code civil	28	80
lieutenant général	184	98	repos dominical	32	80
heures travail	101	27	grande coupure	39	86
général cousebant	162	90	ministre justice	91	132
<i>1906–1908</i>					
classe ouvrière	155	32	section centrale	91	186
industrie travail	196	93	langue flamande	20	88
ministre industrie	148	52	déposer bureau	9	41
huit heures	153	61	honneur déposer	14	47
heures travail	116	43	bureau chambre	15	45
<i>1908–1910</i>					
classe ouvrière	159	31	ministre guerre	106	186
prud hommes	271	152	section centrale	87	167
chemin fer	418	312	comité spécial	5	77
conseils prud	186	109	projet loi	148	188
huit heures	108	42	union minière	4	40

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C36: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1910s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1910–1912</i>					
classe ouvrière	227	46	section centrale	43	123
industrie travail	147	92	caisses prévoyance	47	100
lieutenant général	99	47	projet loi	149	197
ministre guerre	169	123	juge paix	29	70
ministre industrie	101	57	cour comptes	6	44
<i>1912–1914</i>					
classe ouvrière	278	35	projet loi	205	270
suffrage universel	183	63	section centrale	78	136
membres droite	93	28	écoles communales	99	143
4e degré	82	36	société nationale	33	67
quelque chose	94	48	pères famille	93	126
<i>1918–1919</i>					
classe ouvrière	231	43	dommages guerre	49	191
comité national	121	49	tribunaux dommages	11	90
suffrage universel	81	46	affaires économiques	63	109
huit heures	44	10	écoles normales	24	67
suffrage femmes	64	33	juge unique	38	71
<i>1919–1921</i>					
classe ouvrière	289	64	dommages guerre	54	149
passage eau	52	1	ministre finances	92	137
suffrage universel	70	24	projet loi	297	337
avant guerre	194	151	affaires économiques	31	69
huit heures	86	47	tribunaux dommages	21	55

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C37: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1920s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1921–1923</i>					
classe ouvrière	146	53	projet loi	153	260
industrie travail	103	50	honneur déposer	21	79
sciences arts	135	86	bureau chambre	15	69
administration communale	109	68	déposer bureau	14	67
eh bien	118	78	gardes champêtres	64	103
<i>1923–1925</i>					
service sauvetage	89	7	projet loi	231	355
société nationale	103	41	chemin fer	172	257
classe ouvrière	91	30	déposer bureau	14	81
industrie travail	137	88	honneur déposer	25	89
ministre industrie	110	73	section centrale	138	201
<i>1925–1927</i>					
classe ouvrière	162	37	banque nationale	46	113
chemin fer	341	264	section centrale	172	228
huit heures	101	35	dette flottante	17	69
avant guerre	143	85	général kestens	17	63
société nationale	89	50	neuf ans	28	70
<i>1927–1929</i>					
défense nationale	178	89	projet loi	268	369
classe ouvrière	120	39	déposer bureau	28	88
premier ministre	147	82	bureau chambre	33	89
démocrates chrétiens	71	15	honneur déposer	40	95
ministre défense	101	46	section centrale	163	214
<i>1929–1932</i>					
premier ministre	201	104	projet loi	242	363
industrie travail	159	70	honneur déposer	30	81
classe ouvrière	144	63	déposer bureau	21	71
ministre industrie	121	43	bureau chambre	23	71
ministre finances	170	99	doit être	132	178

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C38: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1930s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1932–1934</i>					
classe ouvrière	272	93	honneur déposer	17	97
pleins pouvoirs	181	36	projet loi	299	379
démocrates chrétiens	163	23	déposer bureau	11	90
liste arrondissement	71	12	bureau chambre	16	92
allocations chômage	85	32	tenir compte	87	147
<i>1934–1936</i>					
société nationale	235	115	projet loi	193	259
classe ouvrière	155	41	honneur déposer	38	91
arrêtés lois	141	50	déposer bureau	36	90
chemin fer	227	165	bureau chambre	39	85
conseil administration	82	32	prix revient	31	66
<i>1936–1939</i>					
travaux publics	134	61	projet loi	233	320
non intervention	58	14	conseil etat	36	117
classe ouvrière	111	76	classes moyennes	52	127
administration communale	60	25	arrêté royal	133	200
affaires étrangères	94	63	ministre finances	102	164
<i>1939–1940</i>					
personnel enseignant	90	21	projet loi	209	270
instruction publique	142	91	arrêté royal	181	226
groupe socialiste	48	3	honneur déposer	32	73
union soviétique	24	2	bureau chambre	41	78
classe ouvrière	67	45	chambre rapport	17	52

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C39: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1940s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1944–1946</i>					
prisonniers politiques	227	105	conseil etat	69	234
secours civil	91	8	projet loi	166	321
sécurité sociale	100	22	000 000	19	92
pensions vieillesse	65	12	ministre finances	134	171
ouvriers mineurs	53	6	impôt exceptionnel	5	42
<i>1946–1947</i>					
heure actuelle	141	83	allocations familiales	53	109
travaux publics	130	73	juge paix	35	83
prisonniers politiques	131	82	premier ministre	140	177
société nationale	81	34	sous officiers	11	42
sécurité sociale	95	51	classes moyennes	45	73
<i>1947–1949</i>					
plan marshall	169	93	projet loi	244	310
classe ouvrière	73	23	neuf ans	7	53
mobilisation civile	53	5	ministre finances	73	117
société nationale	119	76	juge paix	32	76
heure actuelle	132	91	commission justice	17	60
<i>1949–1950</i>					
premier ministre	338	201	projet loi	221	346
membres conseil	133	62	déposer bureau	25	97
conseil ministres	159	89	bureau chambre	29	94
conseil etat	174	125	honneur déposer	24	87
vrai oui	42	8	eaux usées	11	59

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C40: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1950s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1950–1952</i>					
premier ministre	382	268	projet loi	193	344
classe ouvrière	113	20	honneur déposer	21	99
sécurité sociale	134	64	bureau chambre	27	102
personnel enseignant	103	38	déposer bureau	25	99
groupe socialiste	77	31	groupe libéral	8	79
<i>1952–1954</i>					
groupe socialiste	88	15	projet loi	248	440
premier ministre	215	154	honneur déposer	18	155
victimes civiles	94	34	déposer bureau	18	148
assurés libres	84	27	bureau chambre	23	151
plan schuman	82	25	chambre rapport	7	106
<i>1954–1956</i>					
travailleurs indépendants	134	54	ministre finances	76	196
déposer bureau	120	61	ministre instruction	53	118
honneur déposer	118	60	conseil etat	46	99
bureau chambre	121	67	premier ministre	108	156
enseignement officiel	117	64	instruction publique	108	153
<i>1956–1958</i>					
déposer bureau	188	47	ministre finances	65	192
chambre rapport	165	29	banque nationale	23	134
bureau chambre	184	52	classes moyennes	72	175
honneur déposer	183	51	conseil etat	22	96
rapport projet	158	33	dette publique	10	72
<i>1958–1961</i>					
premier ministre	569	217	congo belge	54	146
loi unique	129	62	autre part	148	229
classe ouvrière	82	23	ruanda urundi	61	98
services publics	94	44	marché commun	65	99
groupe socialiste	93	49	budget ordinaire	14	47

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C41: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1960s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1961–1963</i>					
classe ouvrière	83	6	projet loi	259	336
organisations syndicales	79	22	ministre finances	53	115
services publics	98	56	assistance technique	25	73
loi unique	102	63	marché commun	96	135
pension retraite	55	26	secteur privé	46	76
<i>1963–1965</i>					
corps médical	146	86	ministre finances	43	119
services publics	134	81	assistance technique	31	94
etats unis	114	61	pays voie	9	40
organisations syndicales	79	36	outre mer	6	36
victimes guerre	68	27	voie développement	10	39
<i>1965–1968</i>					
premier ministre	571	417	cour comptes	6	73
pouvoirs spéciaux	127	55	assistance technique	5	48
assurance maladie	124	53	doit être	159	197
maladie invalidité	115	49	lois linguistiques	19	47
groupe socialiste	76	18	pays wallon	3	31
<i>1968–1969</i>					
organisations syndicales	120	11	premier ministre	219	396
maladies professionnelles	100	39	travaux publics	68	134
groupe socialiste	67	12	conseil économique	101	159
ouvriers mineurs	68	18	ministre culture	37	75
marché commun	125	79	code judiciaire	8	39
<i>1969–1971</i>					
affaires économiques	200	106	premier ministre	151	280
autre part	248	177	conseil culturel	38	102
certain nombre	165	101	police judiciaire	43	100
organisations syndicales	109	49	pères famille	21	63
santé publique	128	70	classes moyennes	24	64

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C42: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1970s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1971–1974</i>					
certain nombre	223	108	premier ministre	231	374
groupe socialiste	88	11	classes moyennes	32	92
travailleurs frontaliers	75	16	aménagement territoire	25	76
affaires économiques	201	144	santé publique	55	89
organisations syndicales	111	60	conseil culturel	51	75
<i>1974–1977</i>					
aide sociale	157	11	conseil etat	82	143
premier ministre	510	377	doit être	151	199
certain nombre	245	114	langue allemande	11	59
groupe socialiste	110	25	classes moyennes	61	108
secrétaire etat	181	104	communes facilités	3	48
<i>1977–1978</i>					
certain nombre	309	173	aujourd'hui	467	585
plus particulièrement	116	55	premier ministre	373	489
groupe socialiste	74	14	finances publiques	34	104
heure actuelle	131	74	secrétaire etat	171	220
travaux publics	141	87	pacte egmont	14	56
<i>1979–1981</i>					
certain nombre	314	182	premier ministre	413	697
loi programme	168	65	conseil etat	45	133
bien être	98	25	communauté germanophone	7	60
organisations syndicales	92	27	déclaration gouvernementale	118	170
sécurité sociale	165	111	région bruxelles	13	57

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C43: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1980s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1981–1983</i>					
premier ministre	679	332	crédits provisoires	57	121
cockerill sambre	112	9	classes moyennes	25	88
groupe socialiste	97	17	projet loi	235	277
services publics	110	52	budget 1983	24	62
affaires économiques	103	48	budget 1982	49	82
<i>1983–1985</i>					
premier ministre	583	283	arrêté royal	148	225
groupe socialiste	67	12	certain nombre	132	193
armes nucléaires	60	14	temps travail	24	80
région wallonne	99	54	langue allemande	3	49
services publics	132	88	classes moyennes	30	69
<i>1985–1987</i>					
premier ministre	1144	522	droits succession	109	220
pouvoirs spéciaux	255	125	projet loi	271	380
vice premier	224	108	déclaration révision	15	57
groupe socialiste	77	13	réfugiés politiques	39	79
sécurité sociale	158	96	van der	45	74
<i>1988–1989</i>					
groupe socialiste	158	9	premier ministre	475	722
loi programme	193	59	etat central	85	180
commission justice	130	26	région bruxelloise	89	167
organisations syndicales	65	10	modernisation services	8	50
cour comptes	60	10	culturelles nationales	6	48
<i>1989–1991</i>					
groupe socialiste	220	8	premier ministre	303	813
projet loi	572	469	loi financement	38	76
loi programme	98	43	secrétaires communaux	34	63
commission justice	104	50	cessez feu	33	54
personnes âgées	61	14	politique agricole	20	30

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C44: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 1990s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1991–1993</i>					
groupe socialiste	101	14	aujourd'hui	549	550
soins santé	107	69	van volksvertegenwoordigers	546	547
			représentants belgique	543	544
			volksvertegenwoordigers van	543	544
			van belgië	543	544
<i>1993–1995</i>					
consentement mutuel	330	99	premier ministre	946	953
commission justice	263	50	aujourd'hui	493	497
voulais voter	200	37	représentants belgique	449	453
groupe socialiste	161	13	annales handelingen	443	446
			chambre représentants	437	440
<i>1995–1997</i>					
circonscriptions électorales	159	13	premier ministre	573	645
groupe socialiste	138	11	cour cassation	72	134
bruxelles hal	78	4	aujourd'hui	641	644
conseil état	105	50	chambre représentants	472	474
hal vilvorde	59	12	représentants belgique	455	458
<i>1997–1999</i>					
sécurité sociale	214	60	cour comptes	18	115
groupe socialiste	153	8	arrêté royal	142	215
travailleurs frontaliers	76	32	supérieur contrôle	11	83
organisations syndicales	50	12	juge instruction	74	142
personnes âgées	63	29	non conventionnelles	48	110
<i>1999–2001</i>					
groupe socialiste	270	3	ge rale	114	289
consé quence	229	103	premier ministre	510	562
valable celui	91	20	pre sident	1698	1705
pouvoirs membres	56	5	aujourd'hui	746	749
droits homme	147	98	projet loi	478	480

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C45: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 2000s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2001–2003</i>					
groupe socialiste	185	8	arc ciel	28	65
zones police	217	77	aujourd'hui	722	733
criminalité organisée	212	76	bruxelles hal	6	15
police locale	176	54	projet loi	499	507
services publics	183	72	premier ministre	467	474
<i>2003–2005</i>					
soins santé	274	114	premier ministre	277	483
groupe socialiste	102	3	vice premier	109	187
loi principe	83	30	jean jacques	20	92
établissements pénitentiaires	62	12	bruxelles hal	15	83
02 minister	52	5	hal vilvorde	24	76
<i>2005–2007</i>					
petits risques	109	17	premier ministre	291	432
groupe socialiste	67	0	année budgétaire	17	100
02 minister	65	2	particulières recherche	32	97
fraude fiscale	75	30	van het	22	86
titres porteur	59	17	méthodes particulières	29	92
<i>2007–2010</i>					
fraude fiscale	174	76	titres services	35	69
groupe socialiste	89	7	cour comptes	65	91
soins santé	154	99	projet loi	259	284
sécurité sociale	168	117	commission justice	37	52
secret bancaire	59	10	coopération développement	45	57

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C46: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 2010s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2010–2012</i>					
groupe sncb	182	33	gouvernement affaires	22	66
entreprises publiques	141	69	aide juridique	16	52
observatoire prix	74	5	assistance avocat	11	35
groupe socialiste	69	2	zone euro	42	67
rapport écrit	83	23	cour comptes	38	51
<i>2012–2014</i>					
groupe socialiste	146	6	conseil état	85	190
zone euro	91	35	aujourd'hui	931	1014
famille royale	78	25	arrondissement judiciaire	15	56
milliards euros	150	101	aide juridique	6	46
partenaires sociaux	172	126	intérêts notionnels	58	95
<i>2014–2016</i>					
services publics	173	45	certain nombre	96	202
saut index	166	68	ministre remercie	85	128
fraude fiscale	174	94	partenaires sociaux	157	200
milliards euros	169	100	cour assises	16	54
millions euros	238	172	arabie saoudite	26	60
<i>2016–2019</i>					
premier ministre	1140	822	projet loi	406	482
soins santé	175	78	ose espérer	8	44
saut index	107	11	certain nombre	117	153
tax shift	152	73	pacte énergétique	23	57
67 ans	73	4	extrêmement important	36	67
<i>2019–2021</i>					
aujourd'hui	1744	1483	premier ministre	498	689
sécurité sociale	189	55	droit passerelle	38	166
soins santé	205	127	remercie réponse	93	165
milliards euros	158	89	entités fédérées	41	97
paradis fiscaux	83	16	ose espérer	14	48

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C47: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, French speech: periods beginning in the 2020s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
2022–2024					
milliards euros	183	113	certain nombre	63	124
cessez feu	69	15	remercie réponse	41	78
services publics	68	23	ose espérer	8	42
sécurité sociale	110	68	droit passerelle	19	47
conditions travail	71	30	qualité soins	17	41
2024–2025					
premier ministre	825	455	remercie réponse	36	92
aujourd'hui	1596	1358	allocations chômage	39	76
000 euros	293	114	projet loi	158	176
500 euros	182	39	droit auteur	14	19
67 ans	118	6	lutte contre	247	251

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C48: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1900s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1900–1902</i>			wet 25	90	90
			kamer gezegd	35	35
			00 uur	3	3
			sociale wetten	2	2
			sociale wetgeving	2	2
<i>1902–1904</i>			mager vee	1114	1118
wij socialisten	201	19	minister landbouw	824	827
werkende klas	180	22	vlaamsche taal	626	628
			000 frank	610	612
			frank toe	540	542
<i>1904–1906</i>			000 frank	1242	1286
ont répondu	1596	356	frank toe	531	568
répondu oui	782	173	répondu non	264	285
werkende klas	597	60	ten minste	422	435
fr 20	277	78	bedienden werklieden	287	299
<i>1906–1908</i>			nationale bank	133	484
werkende klas	565	113	000 frank	729	731
wij socialisten	172	11	jaar dienst	452	453
mensen zoals	4	4	gij hebt	487	488
administrateur generaal	3	3	gij zijt	336	337
zaken justitie	2	2			
<i>1908–1910</i>			frank toe	188	487
wij socialisten	258	13	kleine bedienden	63	208
werkende klas	444	220	gij zult	539	541
groote mogendheden	146	19	minister spoorwegen	576	577
gij hebt	642	540	indien gij	294	296
officieele scholen	106	50			

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C49: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1910s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1910–1912</i>					
private nijverheid	552	19	000 frank	850	858
kleine bedienden	650	228	ten minste	471	476
twijfel getrokken	119	24	gij hebt	439	444
			gij zult	424	429
			wij moeten	419	423
<i>1912–1914</i>					
frank daags	606	226	algemeen stemrecht	527	540
14 jaar	517	160	000 frank	545	557
uren dagen	470	120	gij hebt	449	459
ten honderd	382	57	zeer wel	472	482
wij socialisten	221	6	gij zult	439	449
<i>1919–1921</i>					
werkende klas	481	72	oud strijders	169	601
000 frank	902	619	landelijke politie	59	164
koninklijk besluit	503	240	syndicale vrijheid	18	96
fr 50	159	75	gewestelijke indeeling	70	112
minister zijne	106	33	onze vlaamsche	75	109

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C50: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1920s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1921–1923</i>					
000 frank	1751	850	middelbaar onderwijs	206	460
werkende klas	178	20	gewestelijke indeeling	66	201
nationaal werk	162	47	vierde graad	32	141
arbeidende klas	124	47	vlaamsche land	95	157
zoo lang	128	53	militair akkoord	17	42
<i>1923–1925</i>					
artikel 94	466	71	artikel 57	30	148
werkende klas	214	38	rechtbank koophandel	32	132
kosteloos pensioen	292	157	vierde graad	38	119
werk kindervelzijn	165	55	oud strijders	201	279
arbeidende klas	90	32	vlaamsch nationale	5	26
<i>1925–1927</i>					
drie jaar	602	237	oud strijders	91	270
openbare werken	659	379	buitenlandsche zaken	57	215
negen jaar	367	98	vlaamsche nationalisten	41	182
landbouw openbare	255	122	vlaamsch nationale	13	72
drie zes	106	7	zeer zeker	42	57
<i>1927–1929</i>					
zes maanden	528	237	000 frank	770	1139
gewestelijke indeeling	340	54	oud strijders	158	450
christen democraten	299	119	fransch belgisch	31	175
minister landsverdediging	348	173	militair akkoord	7	104
werkende klas	131	4	koninklijk besluit	334	422
<i>1929–1932</i>					
minister nijverheid	303	103	000 frank	766	1000
nijverheid arbeid	419	221	oud strijders	113	301
lijst nr	115	4	eerste minister	155	305
openbare werken	407	303	vlaamsche nationalisten	56	205
wij socialisten	98	1	vlaamsche land	79	201

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C51: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1930s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1932–1934</i>					
openbaren onderstand	280	13	neer leggen	76	198
wet 31	128	32	buitenlandsche zaken	34	130
sint truiden	155	60	kamer neer	35	127
le peuple	101	21	eer bureel	36	114
artikel 32	89	14	bureel kamer	62	136
<i>1934–1936</i>					
west vlaanderen	302	113	eerste minister	224	547
provincie west	158	29	oud strijders	39	143
openbare werken	503	396	fransch belgisch	34	134
toestand landbouw	104	20	militair akkoord	15	79
dien toestand	187	103	belgisch militair	36	82
<i>1936–1939</i>					
000 frank	898	613	tafel verslag	472	880
officieel onderwijs	260	61	nationale bank	48	229
jaar dienst	194	61	eerste minister	321	457
officieele scholen	127	26	buitenlandsche zaken	32	151
vrije scholen	112	34	neer leggen	138	229
<i>1939–1940</i>					
openbaren onderstand	203	67	vlaamsch nationale	41	106
vierde graad	142	11	technisch onderwijs	277	303
culturele autonomie	111	22	legt ter	872	876
nationale conferentie	122	44	000 frank	719	723
werkende klas	75	3	tafel verslag	649	652

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C52: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1940s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1944–1946</i>					
400 frank	211	94	buitenlandsche zaken	96	201
tafel verslag	479	479	eerste minister	763	763
legt ter	490	490	000 frank	993	993
ter tafel	594	594	gedurende oorlog	183	183
onderzoek geloofsbrieven	176	176	zwarte markt	199	199
<i>1946–1947</i>					
politieke gevangenen	356	114	eerste minister	253	661
economische unie	217	77	minister financiën	118	225
wij moeten	404	299	technisch onderwijs	140	217
economische problemen	110	17	000 ton	126	201
werkende klas	85	11	maatschappelijke zekerheid	140	206
<i>1947–1949</i>					
miljoen frank	196	74	ter tafel	440	675
centraal bestuur	121	33	verslag wetsontwerp	243	360
fonds gemeenten	114	27	ten laste	136	245
sint niklaas	119	39	technisch onderwijs	103	210
socialistische groep	97	18	eer ter	224	331
<i>1949–1950</i>					
eerste minister	896	361	kiescollege arrondissement	37	464
wij vragen	321	183	ter tafel	192	487
minister financiën	270	141	eer ter	75	334
vlaamse socialisten	134	22	neer leggen	151	403
algemene paritaire	140	31	verslag wetsontwerp	95	344

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C53: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1950s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1950–1952</i>					
eerste minister	581	195	ter tafel	87	803
minister financiën	317	115	verslag wetsontwerp	46	608
gij hebt	263	138	eer ter	29	399
vier twintig	154	43	tafel neer	42	390
gehuwde vrouw	135	28	neer leggen	75	422
<i>1952–1954</i>					
eerste minister	713	165	ter tafel	99	1020
twintig maanden	340	81	verslag wetsontwerp	57	657
achttien maanden	253	38	eer ter	35	578
minister landsverdediging	264	79	tafel neer	47	557
gij hebt	304	131	neer leggen	87	561
<i>1954–1956</i>					
ter tafel	821	147	eerste minister	288	695
verslag wetsontwerp	587	69	technisch onderwijs	35	263
gij hebt	848	344	minister financiën	167	392
eer ter	489	68	wet 29	63	243
tafel neer	460	72	vrij onderwijs	91	213
<i>1956–1958</i>					
ter tafel	746	151	eerste minister	143	656
verslag wetsontwerp	531	76	000 frank	509	729
eer ter	503	68	ten laste	55	182
tafel neer	495	76	minister financiën	185	293
neer leggen	478	91	technisch onderwijs	63	150
<i>1958–1961</i>					
eerste minister	1704	557	vlaamse land	39	198
gij hebt	517	195	wet 21	28	128
minister financiën	415	213	kiescollege arrondissement	15	99
hebt gij	220	82	buitenlandse handel	80	148
nationale bank	142	14	mijns inziens	21	88

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C54: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1960s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1961–1963</i>					
kiescollege arrondissement	168	7	vlaamse land	49	142
economische zaken	334	179	verenigde staten	40	116
vitale belangen	132	9	artikel 123sexies	11	81
nationaal inkomen	150	49	culturele autonomie	4	74
burgerlijke oorlogsslachtoffers	102	9	minister financiën	252	313
<i>1963–1965</i>					
economische expansie	274	89	ten laste	119	242
oud strijders	123	12	koninklijk besluit	223	318
sociale partners	127	32	vlaamse land	94	183
economische zaken	304	209	vlaamse gemeenschap	13	99
burgerlijke oorlogsslachtoffers	97	14	tweede taal	65	151
<i>1965–1968</i>					
eerste minister	1410	613	nationale partijen	25	104
lid staten	106	25	vlaamse land	38	112
sociale politiek	161	81	openbare werken	152	218
vice eerste	166	96	universitair onderwijs	17	72
economische gemeenschap	87	25	universitaire expansie	21	75
<i>1968–1969</i>					
sluiting ondernemingen	122	18	eerste minister	200	350
onze landbouwers	120	28	000 ton	30	175
collectieve overeenkomsten	97	12	technische ingenieurs	34	161
openbare besturen	128	56	technisch onderwijs	29	119
economische expansie	143	72	culturele autonomie	84	153
<i>1969–1971</i>					
verenigde staten	155	57	hoger onderwijs	30	172
buitenlandse handel	148	50	secundair onderwijs	40	131
gerechtelijke politie	104	15	000 ton	69	135
regie posterijen	74	11	eerste minister	257	322
minder validen	95	42	sociale zekerheid	65	113

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C55: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1970s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1971–1974</i>					
minder validen	318	135	eerste minister	316	539
sociale voorzorg	251	131	openbare werken	332	415
arrondissement aalst	105	27	wij moeten	230	263
ten opzichte	192	125	lid staten	23	54
openbare schuld	116	51	vlaamse gemeenschap	7	37
<i>1974–1977</i>					
eerste minister	1683	565	koninklijk besluit	480	642
binnenlandse zaken	455	210	wij moeten	176	301
minister binnenlandse	313	129	hoger onderwijs	61	154
ten opzichte	285	119	buitengewoon onderwijs	11	97
economische zaken	328	234	kleine middelgrote	36	109
<i>1977–1978</i>					
buitengewoon onderwijs	126	4	buitenlandse handel	60	174
ten opzichte	175	95	vlaamse gemeenschap	13	124
amendement artikel	95	33	vlaamse gewest	16	73
kiescollege arrondissement	100	42	comité toezicht	8	56
secundair onderwijs	88	35	belgische dienst	20	67
<i>1979–1981</i>					
buitenlandse zaken	319	109	eerste minister	796	1155
vlaamse socialisten	190	14	vlaamse gemeenschap	32	246
openbare sector	180	36	gemeenschappen gewesten	69	188
minder validen	154	31	hoofdstedelijk gebied	9	73
minister buitenlandse	188	70	vlaanderen wallonië	41	99

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C56: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1980s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1981–1983</i>					
eerste minister	1143	757	wij moeten	195	362
koninklijk besluit	711	468	cockerill sambre	124	239
bijzondere machten	434	278	nationale sectoren	42	132
besluit nr	154	72	miljoen frank	41	130
industrieel beleid	102	31	buitenlandse zaken	69	152
<i>1983–1985</i>					
eerste minister	1091	643	wij moeten	160	299
koninklijk besluit	630	384	cockerill sambre	28	115
ter zake	774	591	vlaamse gemeenschap	16	79
deeltijdse arbeid	123	16	nationale sectoren	63	126
derde wereld	136	33	gemeenschappen gewesten	20	78
<i>1985–1987</i>					
eerste minister	2388	1382	ont répondu	22	96
openbaar ambt	273	68	vlaamse gemeenschap	34	108
oudere werklozen	112	20	geantwoord mm	17	89
vice premier	166	77	bijzondere machten	116	185
koninklijk besluit	381	309	amendement nr	18	76
<i>1988–1989</i>					
minder validen	157	9	eerste minister	760	1136
oudere werklozen	138	46	mm michel	5	133
grondige bespreking	57	11	minister financiën	81	170
24 miljard	47	7	ont répondu	34	96
tijdens eerste	72	32	neen geantwoord	24	80
<i>1989–1991</i>					
18 jaar	194	14	eerste minister	840	1519
mannen vrouwen	135	32	buitenlandse zaken	200	476
vlaamse socialisten	99	12	minister buitenlandse	152	384
bescherming consument	94	14	derde fase	54	198
volledig pensioen	70	11	gemeenschappen gewesten	34	97

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C57: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1990s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1991–1993</i>					
kiescollege arrondissement	524	72	eerste minister	1180	1283
lijst nr	425	53	kamer volksvertegenwoordigers	1141	1155
11 000	187	12	volksvertegenwoordigers België	1130	1143
België parlementaire	185	26	législature 48e	1096	1109
arrondissement antwerpen	115	37	représentants Belgique	1106	1120
<i>1993–1995</i>					
koninklijk besluit	599	324	eerste minister	661	1838
Vlaamse socialisten	58	14			
kamer volksvertegenwoordigers	1277	1266			
volksvertegenwoordigers België	1234	1223			
België législature	1229	1218			
<i>1995–1997</i>					
miljoen frank	633	411	eerste minister	662	2199
koninklijk besluit	314	161	sociale zekerheid	423	645
medisch dossier	164	35	openbaar ministerie	41	70
sociaal overleg	174	66	vierde graad	0	0
deeltijdse arbeid	126	35			
<i>1997–1999</i>					
miljoen frank	350	142	eerste minister	516	1291
medisch dossier	218	13	hoog comité	19	213
Europese unie	303	149	comité toezicht	12	174
buitenlandse zaken	202	73	gerechtelijke politie	80	154
amendement nr	155	54	nationale bank	41	101
<i>1999–2001</i>					
est clos	554	386	eerste minister	829	1678
openbaar ministerie	248	82	halle vilvoorde	80	238
incident est	547	386	amendement nr	51	134
federaal parket	220	86	lambermont akkoord	6	79
laten we	109	29	volksgezondheid leefmilieu	81	81

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C58: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2000s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2001–2003</i>					
les membres	568	60	eerste minister	869	1714
gestemd les	359	48	veiligheid staat	60	213
ont répondu	358	57	lambermont akkoord	34	172
répondu oui	184	32	vlaams parlement	163	268
sociale gesprekspartners	150	3	nationale loterij	88	147
<i>2003–2005</i>					
verenigde staten	202	42	eerste minister	274	1157
fiscale fraude	126	29	amendement nr	29	215
minister dank	137	73	halle vilvoorde	146	231
onze regering	61	9	openbaar ministerie	41	110
wetsontwerp inzake	55	15	miljard euro	106	156
<i>2005–2007</i>					
sociale partners	273	122	eerste minister	349	1009
eenparig aangenomen	190	46	miljard euro	63	169
goede zaak	203	88	miljoen euro	357	452
zwarte lijst	117	5	nationale bank	35	72
gerechtelijke achterstand	147	74	minister financiën	73	106
<i>2007–2010</i>					
sociale partners	493	159	wij moeten	241	390
sociale zekerheid	428	189	miljard euro	253	375
minister justitie	343	215	miljoen euro	418	508
sociaal overleg	183	55	parlementaire onderzoekscommissie	32	118
commissie sociale	134	47	halle vilvoorde	65	142

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C59: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2010s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2010–2012</i>					
est clos	506	322	miljard euro	50	334
incident est	502	323	fiscale fraude	45	116
eerste minister	974	860	heel belangrijk	124	162
minister buitenlandse	170	80	seksueel misbruik	34	61
nederland Duitsland	96	21	amendement nr	42	67
<i>2012–2014</i>					
eerste minister	827	627	miljoen euro	419	617
wij moeten	576	439	vlaams belangfractie	9	40
minister dank	299	219	va fractie	12	34
maatregelen genomen	152	85	ter zake	449	452
vlaamse rand	83	27	ten tweede	445	448
<i>2014–2016</i>					
eerste minister	1421	1019	wij moeten	404	771
miljoen euro	551	334	est clos	303	470
tax shift	233	92	incident est	305	469
minister financiën	278	138	minister dank	159	282
fiscale fraude	222	83	onze fractie	315	433
<i>2016–2019</i>					
eerste minister	1377	1023	wij moeten	455	652
minister financiën	193	81	saudi arabie	115	261
vindt normaal	128	18	europese unie	129	271
alle duidelijkheid	181	77	sociale zekerheid	213	309
45 jaar	172	78	heel belangrijk	131	220
<i>2019–2021</i>					
jaar geleden	252	154	va fractie	10	74
minister dank	147	77	vlaams belangfractie	4	47
laten wij	189	125	ter stemming	35	71
onderhavig voorstel	94	32	eerste minister	699	725
heel lang	109	58	veiligheid staat	31	52

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C60: Most partisan phrases, Left and Other parties, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2020s

Left			Other parties		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2022–2024</i>					
gewone mensen	139	9	eerste minister	517	668
heel belangrijk	307	195	nationale loterij	17	101
sociaal tarief	294	187	onze fractie	245	321
voorstel resolutie	236	132	nationale bank	44	100
sociale bescherming	133	30	va fractie	37	90
<i>2024–2025</i>					
werkende mensen	245	45	miljard euro	482	669
elke dag	380	200	eerste minister	511	651
werkende klas	166	4	30 procent	26	127
sociaal akkoord	163	19	flexi jobs	64	161
gewone mensen	186	46	nationale loterij	27	74

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Left: positive; Other parties: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 2; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C61: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1830s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1839–1841</i>					
observations discussion	53	15	société générale	104	345
ministre guerre	33	20	section centrale	417	600
chemin fer	457	453	ministre finances	228	297
aujourd'hui	425	422	liste civile	10	64
projet loi	269	267	avantages commerce	5	54

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C62: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1840s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1845–1848</i>					
000 fr	319	189	ministre justice	150	201
cour comptes	134	73	ministre travaux	170	210
dette flottante	42	11	ministre intérieur	207	237
sucre exotique	58	36	van weyer	27	53
chemin fer	422	402	école vétérinaire	8	34
<i>1848–1850</i>					
section centrale	660	477	chemin fer	275	544
ministre guerre	83	32	ministre intérieur	166	283
000 fr	271	226	eh bien	248	323
société générale	52	17	enseignement religieux	44	116
garde civique	75	41	enseignement moyen	78	140

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\xi}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C63: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1850s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1850–1852</i>					
section centrale	429	348	ministre finances	229	473
sous rapport	134	88	chemin fer	542	728
flandre occidentale	64	20	ministre intérieur	138	228
code civil	73	34	tout heure	87	142
honneur déposer	37	11	trésor public	49	100
<i>1852–1854</i>					
section centrale	545	474	commissaire arrondissement	20	71
000 fr	391	322	eh bien	263	311
flandre occidentale	86	36	ministre intérieur	257	300
000 hommes	62	30	ministre finances	147	190
projet loi	351	320	garde civique	237	266
<i>1857–1859</i>					
section centrale	622	379	ministre intérieur	183	293
prud hommes	266	125	pétition datée	52	146
conseils prud	197	76	critique censure	26	104
projet loi	457	372	art 295	17	84
contrainte corps	95	20	ministres cultes	125	190
<i>1859–1861</i>					
section centrale	446	308	ministre finances	168	297
projet loi	420	336	vol domestique	22	116
garde civique	70	5	passe port	19	91
000 fr	268	224	pétition datée	31	85
bruxelles louvain	79	37	fonds communal	74	126

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C64: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1860s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1861–1864</i>					
section centrale	321	166	ministre finances	147	309
projet loi	395	315	ministre justice	97	178
garde civique	97	19	ministre intérieur	162	229
servitudes militaires	91	23	eh bien	323	376
citadelle nord	60	18	pétition datée	38	89
<i>1864–1866</i>					
section centrale	404	268	ministre justice	155	274
projet loi	440	313	ministre finances	107	213
chemin fer	442	389	ministre intérieur	151	233
honneur déposer	59	18	ministre guerre	114	169
déposer bureau	54	26	affaires étrangères	31	73
<i>1866–1868</i>					
projet loi	376	282	ministre finances	146	351
écoles adultes	140	65	ministre justice	153	283
section centrale	275	210	000 hommes	84	173
loi 1842	152	92	aujourd'hui	496	569
enseignement primaire	85	40	ministre intérieur	149	211
<i>1868–1870</i>					
sociétés coopératives	69	4	ministre finances	90	225
000 fr	124	63	ministre justice	194	286
section centrale	371	315	aujourd'hui	485	572
assemblée générale	88	37	listes électorales	36	93
sociétés anonymes	126	77	pétition datée	51	92

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{ji}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C65: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1870s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1870–1872</i>					
chemin fer	710	528	ministre intérieur	160	443
bassins houillers	232	135	ministre finances	115	270
section centrale	278	181	banque nationale	55	138
compagnie bassins	98	24	ministre guerre	62	136
honneur déposer	60	14	écoles moyennes	91	164
<i>1872–1874</i>					
section centrale	354	161	ministre finances	136	341
projet loi	385	306	écoles moyennes	36	171
pétition datée	92	22	ministre guerre	70	199
honneur déposer	84	15	ministre intérieur	171	295
déposer bureau	74	17	servitudes militaires	47	146
<i>1874–1876</i>					
section centrale	461	293	garde civique	67	261
honneur déposer	87	14	ministre finances	147	326
juge paix	117	45	chambre commerce	158	281
tout heure	170	104	ministre intérieur	98	205
déposer bureau	72	21	chemin fer	417	511
<i>1876–1878</i>					
section centrale	491	283	ministre intérieur	116	245
honneur déposer	78	14	ministre finances	157	247
tout heure	178	116	ministre justice	98	181
cours eau	168	109	écoles moyennes	32	111
déposer bureau	69	14	eh bien	198	262
<i>1878–1880</i>					
chemin fer	382	316	ministre intérieur	132	290
écoles communales	126	72	instruction publique	107	244
honneur déposer	71	20	ministre justice	88	191
projet loi	333	287	ministre instruction	42	136
section centrale	345	304	ministre finances	76	170

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C66: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1880s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1880–1882</i>					
projet loi	347	260	ministre intérieur	103	312
chemin fer	354	274	ministre justice	82	252
écoles communales	108	47	instruction publique	81	188
honneur déposer	67	17	ministre instruction	34	120
droit pêche	67	19	ministre guerre	58	132
<i>1882–1884</i>					
projet loi	310	228	instruction publique	90	252
honneur déposer	66	24	ministre intérieur	120	219
suffrage universel	67	32	ministre justice	108	201
déposer bureau	56	25	ministre guerre	40	132
droit électoral	60	31	ministre instruction	37	125
<i>1884–1886</i>					
section centrale	307	192	écoles communales	149	358
chemin fer	278	192	pères famille	83	177
droit auteur	116	34	ministre intérieur	123	213
honneur déposer	73	13	écoles adoptées	95	163
tout heure	147	87	instruction publique	80	147
<i>1886–1888</i>					
honneur déposer	78	19	ministre guerre	72	205
déposer bureau	71	17	écoles communales	70	179
bureau chambre	69	16	000 hommes	47	115
concordat préventif	61	8	ministre finances	146	209
autre part	117	72	conseil communal	103	151
<i>1888–1890</i>					
chemin fer	358	266	ministre guerre	78	181
prud hommes	220	143	ministre finances	110	193
honneur déposer	75	15	sûreté publique	18	97
conseils prud	154	95	ministre justice	141	215
déposer bureau	62	11	ville gand	15	65

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C67: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1890s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1890–1892</i>					
fonds commun	104	38	ministre guerre	82	206
honneur déposer	69	19	ministre finances	125	227
autre part	128	81	traitement attente	64	131
bureau chambre	63	17	lieutenant général	27	91
déposer bureau	61	17	conseil communal	52	111
<i>1892–1894</i>					
représentation proportionnelle	178	105	suffrage universel	157	283
projet loi	246	195	chemin fer	244	335
tout heure	172	127	droit électoral	60	115
autre part	125	81	députation permanente	49	97
juge paix	58	20	ministre finances	141	185
<i>1894–1896</i>					
projet loi	443	315	conseil communal	58	163
ministre finances	286	184	suffrage universel	38	114
droit licence	78	14	classe ouvrière	60	132
chemin fer	364	308	députation permanente	46	93
section centrale	191	136	ministre guerre	70	114
<i>1896–1898</i>					
section centrale	223	126	classe ouvrière	39	135
projet loi	381	292	suffrage universel	25	83
garde civique	225	155	membres droite	23	73
honneur déposer	56	9	ministre guerre	49	98
unions professionnelles	249	204	démocrates chrétiens	15	46
<i>1898–1900</i>					
section centrale	242	149	banque nationale	122	324
projet loi	382	315	classe ouvrière	33	119
juge paix	95	39	tramways bruxellois	29	106
honneur déposer	57	15	suffrage universel	46	117
fer vicinaux	56	19	eh bien	147	209

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C68: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1900s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1900–1902</i>					
section centrale	291	149	suffrage universel	199	337
chemin fer	359	255	classe ouvrière	35	109
jeux hasard	99	22	ministre intérieur	59	119
honneur déposer	70	17	représentation proportionnelle	60	114
déposer bureau	67	16	ministre justice	97	149
<i>1902–1904</i>					
chemin fer	467	295	ministre guerre	60	132
section centrale	226	149	classe ouvrière	44	115
autre part	170	127	lieutenant général	29	85
chef entreprise	58	17	ministre justice	71	126
faute lourde	69	32	général cousebant	25	75
<i>1904–1906</i>					
section centrale	194	115	ministre guerre	159	236
honneur déposer	57	10	alkemade ministre	66	141
bureau chambre	58	12	général cousebant	74	147
déposer bureau	55	11	cousebant alkemade	66	138
repos dominical	84	49	lieutenant général	82	150
<i>1906–1908</i>					
section centrale	206	120	ministre guerre	49	144
langue flamande	97	46	classe ouvrière	25	100
projet loi	233	186	lieutenant général	17	84
honneur déposer	59	18	eh bien	141	186
déposer bureau	53	13	conseil communal	51	88
<i>1908–1910</i>					
section centrale	196	104	chemin fer	301	374
comité spécial	103	25	classe ouvrière	31	95
ministre guerre	203	129	fer postes	31	84
loi 1902	74	20	ministre chemins	58	109
000 hommes	75	28	écoles normales	36	83

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C69: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1910s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1910–1912</i>					
caisses prévoyance	131	37	ministre guerre	69	187
chemin fer	415	339	classe ouvrière	43	140
section centrale	139	72	lieutenant général	17	95
déposer bureau	59	12	général hellebaut	13	76
honneur déposer	60	15	hellebaut ministre	7	68
<i>1912–1914</i>					
projet loi	291	226	classe ouvrière	41	144
honneur déposer	65	19	écoles communales	78	180
déposer bureau	56	10	écoles adoptées	89	141
bureau chambre	58	15	ministre guerre	90	138
section centrale	141	108	suffrage universel	67	114

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\xi}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C70: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1920s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1921–1923</i>					
projet loi	261	150	classe ouvrière	55	128
chemin fer	298	224	sciences arts	83	138
bureau chambre	69	15	industrie travail	53	93
honneur déposer	77	23	quatrième degré	13	44
déposer bureau	66	14	écoles libres	31	60
<i>1923–1925</i>					
projet loi	351	230	service sauvetage	8	76
chemin fer	260	156	classe ouvrière	30	82
section centrale	200	135	société nationale	42	93
déposer bureau	79	15	sciences arts	30	71
honneur déposer	87	26	industrie travail	89	125
<i>1927–1929</i>					
projet loi	353	275	défense nationale	87	184
prud hommes	72	17	premier ministre	75	163
conseils prud	66	16	classe ouvrière	42	113
déposer bureau	80	30	aujourd'hui	280	339
bureau chambre	81	33	ministre défense	47	103
<i>1929–1932</i>					
projet loi	365	242	premier ministre	101	205
honneur déposer	80	29	industrie travail	70	147
déposer bureau	71	21	ministre industrie	43	112
bureau chambre	71	22	ministre finances	98	164
doit être	172	132	classe ouvrière	65	131

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C71: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1930s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1932–1934</i>					
honneur déposer	96	16	classe ouvrière	91	245
déposer bureau	89	11	pleins pouvoirs	35	179
bureau chambre	92	16	démocrates chrétiens	22	158
projet loi	376	302	liste arrondissement	14	73
caisse nationale	69	11	ministre finances	131	184
<i>1934–1936</i>					
honneur déposer	71	26	classe ouvrière	50	277
juge paix	43	6	arrêtés lois	59	272
déposer bureau	68	35	union nationale	19	164
nord midi	42	10	gouvernement union	7	124
chambre rapport	38	10	petite épargne	49	152
<i>1936–1939</i>					
projet loi	305	197	banque nationale	82	233
arrêté royal	181	135	premier ministre	210	321
honneur déposer	58	18	classes moyennes	78	142
conseil état	97	66	aujourd'hui	359	409
chambre rapport	36	7	quarante heures	22	71
<i>1939–1940</i>					
honneur déposer	64	20	charges sociales	13	68
projet loi	253	211	ministre travail	25	79
ministre finances	151	119	masses laborieuses	2	40
000 tonnes	35	11	heures travail	16	53
déposer bureau	61	37	groupe communiste	5	37

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C72: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1940s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1944–1946</i>					
conseil etat	204	52	ministre finances	118	277
prisonniers politiques	187	85	000 000	30	146
secours civil	57	9	projet loi	225	299
000 tonnes	61	34	impôt exceptionnel	5	75
théâtre national	45	23	dommages guerre	58	126
<i>1946–1947</i>					
heure actuelle	147	57	ministre finances	105	207
assistance publique	92	20	premier ministre	127	221
société nationale	76	22	allocations familiales	48	136
commissions assistance	57	12	banque nationale	23	94
prisonniers politiques	121	81	aujourd'hui	296	366
<i>1947–1949</i>					
société nationale	122	42	premier ministre	162	263
honneur déposer	90	22	prisonniers politiques	34	99
déposer bureau	89	29	allocations compensatoires	24	76
bureau chambre	92	36	syndicats libéraux	6	53
chambre rapport	63	10	coût vie	33	79
<i>1949–1950</i>					
projet loi	349	219	premier ministre	181	358
déposer bureau	93	27	membres conseil	59	137
bureau chambre	92	30	question royale	87	157
honneur déposer	84	25	conseil ministres	85	153
eaux usées	58	10	conseil etat	122	174

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C73: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1950s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1950–1952</i>					
projet loi	380	230	premier ministre	127	400
honneur déposer	154	25	sécurité sociale	47	116
bureau chambre	158	30	personnel enseignant	32	83
déposer bureau	156	28	prisonniers politiques	24	73
chambre rapport	123	13	classe ouvrière	29	76
<i>1952–1954</i>					
projet loi	495	282	premier ministre	141	206
honneur déposer	217	32	groupe socialiste	17	60
déposer bureau	212	30	van houtte	23	64
bureau chambre	214	34	classes moyennes	70	110
chambre rapport	173	8	groupe libéral	9	44
<i>1954–1956</i>					
déposer bureau	145	23	premier ministre	102	182
honneur déposer	140	22	ministre instruction	52	122
projet loi	329	214	conseil etat	53	106
bureau chambre	145	30	instruction publique	108	160
chambre rapport	95	16	ministre travail	28	80
<i>1956–1958</i>					
projet loi	407	228	premier ministre	65	266
honneur déposer	172	15	conseil etat	23	127
bureau chambre	171	19	allocations familiales	57	129
déposer bureau	170	18	pouvoirs spéciaux	5	72
chambre rapport	138	13	aujourd'hui	297	352
<i>1958–1961</i>					
congo belge	151	57	premier ministre	214	591
autre part	238	148	loi unique	65	135
table ronde	101	63	tout heure	187	251
marché commun	98	64	aujourd'hui	393	446
politique scientifique	36	4	classe ouvrière	24	77

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C74: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1960s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1961–1963</i>					
arrêté royal	164	89	premier ministre	162	255
assistance technique	66	15	loi unique	53	142
projet loi	314	270	aujourd'hui	334	421
nations unies	69	30	ministre affaires	98	169
certain nombre	141	105	classe ouvrière	23	71
<i>1963–1965</i>					
projet loi	360	259	aujourd'hui	331	455
certain nombre	164	69	premier ministre	93	161
assistance technique	79	18	commission prix	13	74
corps médical	130	80	ministre affaires	81	135
allocations familiales	85	37	prix détail	22	74
<i>1965–1968</i>					
cour comptes	77	9	premier ministre	370	606
certain nombre	190	123	pouvoirs spéciaux	50	119
assistance technique	49	10	assurance maladie	62	103
projet loi	196	163	maladie invalidité	56	96
voudrais dire	66	35	groupe socialiste	22	58
<i>1968–1969</i>					
certain nombre	156	74	premier ministre	209	411
affaires étrangères	134	67	vice premier	39	114
groupe socialiste	64	11	ministre chers	41	86
autre part	233	186	conseil administration	18	54
centres santé	46	4	maladies professionnelles	53	85
<i>1969–1971</i>					
pays voie	138	14	premier ministre	146	313
voie développement	135	12	police judiciaire	33	124
affaires étrangères	148	57	ministre chers	47	111
parlement européen	98	17	aujourd'hui	377	440
conseil ministres	132	76	classes moyennes	23	74

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C75: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1970s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1971–1974</i>					
certain nombre	201	108	premier ministre	212	419
heure actuelle	113	59	aujourd'hui	399	479
doit être	219	176	ministre chers	91	130
groupe socialiste	60	18	vice premier	34	69
marché commun	85	44	90 000	19	48
<i>1974–1977</i>					
conseil état	140	82	aide sociale	10	154
économique sociale	105	50	premier ministre	372	514
langue allemande	59	11	certain nombre	115	242
communes facilités	50	4	dès lors	164	245
classes moyennes	106	63	groupe socialiste	26	105
<i>1977–1978</i>					
langue allemande	70	8	premier ministre	295	668
doit être	195	147	pouvoirs spéciaux	57	128
économique sociale	108	68	aujourd'hui	514	573
communauté culturelle	58	22	secrétaire état	176	234
heure actuelle	105	70	classes moyennes	55	112
<i>1979–1981</i>					
certain nombre	325	165	premier ministre	377	719
affaires étrangères	114	45	aujourd'hui	468	552
états unis	85	33	conseil état	56	128
groupe socialiste	59	9	taux intérêt	26	68
ministre affaires	123	76	communautés régions	30	68

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C76: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1980s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1981–1983</i>					
projet loi	320	212	premier ministre	262	589
classes moyennes	122	29	cockerill sambre	8	95
crédits provisoires	120	70	conseil etat	179	253
enseignement secondaire	73	32	pouvoirs spéciaux	411	481
commission justice	58	16	groupe socialiste	19	63
<i>1983–1985</i>					
certain nombre	227	118	premier ministre	242	513
arrêté royal	241	143	vice premier	48	115
langue allemande	53	4	pouvoirs spéciaux	52	118
temps travail	78	33	sécurité sociale	87	125
commission justice	65	22	modération salariale	26	64
<i>1985–1987</i>					
enfants adultérins	67	9	premier ministre	475	951
van der	97	41	pouvoirs spéciaux	101	223
projet loi	336	299	vice premier	83	195
enfants nés	36	4	conseil etat	85	185
déclaration révision	57	27	groupe socialiste	19	53
<i>1988–1989</i>					
groupe socialiste	89	13	premier ministre	484	726
commission justice	89	23	modernisation services	5	67
loi programme	115	66	ministre intérieur	74	130
mouscron comines	53	8	culturelles nationales	7	60
projet loi	370	333	scientifiques culturelles	8	59
<i>1989–1991</i>					
projet loi	568	408	premier ministre	355	878
groupe socialiste	121	10	affaires étrangères	66	193
commission justice	89	39	ministre affaires	78	169
précompte mobilier	90	48	loi financement	29	90
membres commission	85	46	secrétaires communaux	20	67

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C77: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 1990s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1991–1993</i>					
groupe socialiste	66	10	loyauté fédérale	62	243
élection directe	74	20	premier ministre	333	460
électoral arrondissement	39	27	partis francophones	28	46
collège électoral	39	30	ministre dit	22	29
aujourd'hui	494	493			
<i>1993–1995</i>					
commission justice	123	43	premier ministre	319	1099
voulais voter	90	33	vice premier	101	162
groupe socialiste	42	21			
aujourd'hui	440	437			
représentants belgique	401	398			
<i>1995–1997</i>					
circonscriptions électorales	84	16	premier ministre	380	771
groupe socialiste	77	17	motion pure	33	109
union européenne	107	55	commission enquête	105	179
conseil état	85	44	pouvoirs spéciaux	19	54
bruxelles hal	43	8	sécurité sociale	280	308
<i>1997–1999</i>					
sécurité sociale	152	58	premier ministre	337	527
groupe socialiste	90	12	motion pure	41	137
union européenne	136	67	cour comptes	37	131
etats membres	83	19	comité supérieur	19	104
banque nationale	59	21	certain nombre	183	263
<i>1999–2001</i>					
matie re	476	211	premier ministre	336	881
certain nombre	352	205	motion pure	76	231
services police	145	58	amendement nr	57	174
groupe socialiste	84	6	zijn stem	53	167
supplé mentaires	82	24	stem gecontroleerd	53	167

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C78: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 2000s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2001–2003</i>					
criminalité organisée	126	28	premier ministre	325	772
certain nombre	290	203	soins palliatifs	12	171
travail intérêt	89	13	motion pure	38	171
rapport écrit	79	23	conseil etat	96	185
police locale	93	39	zijn stem	30	113
<i>2003–2005</i>					
ministre chers	224	166	premier ministre	284	600
rapport écrit	69	18	jean jacques	20	122
loi examen	56	11	conseil etat	135	233
groupe socialiste	53	9	circonscriptions électorales	9	69
commission justice	107	67	vice premier	132	188
<i>2005–2007</i>					
projet loi	570	356	premier ministre	234	582
ministre chers	244	123	aujourd'hui	750	823
année budgétaire	111	22	demandeurs asile	24	80
certain nombre	243	161	maître ouvrage	7	47
rapport écrit	82	25	prise compte	38	76

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C79: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 2010s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2010–2012</i>					
groupe sncb	91	8	commission enquête	72	185
remercie réponse	120	54	intérêts notionnels	17	89
union européenne	298	244	secret bancaire	50	102
ministre chers	213	161	commission finances	32	77
conseil administration	151	105	temps partiel	15	49
<i>2012–2014</i>					
secrétaire état	389	180	intérêts notionnels	35	208
ministre chers	339	138	conseil état	109	236
ministre remercie	189	65	région bruxelloise	23	111
remercie réponse	162	44	fraude fiscale	63	116
accord gouvernement	114	43	ministre finances	91	139
<i>2014–2016</i>					
certain nombre	233	134	premier ministre	626	1092
accord gouvernement	205	115	aujourd'hui	862	1154
ministre remercie	169	92	conseil état	120	232
affaires étrangères	142	69	ministre finances	54	142
entités fédérées	118	62	fraude fiscale	61	139
<i>2016–2019</i>					
certain nombre	215	111	premier ministre	671	1015
union européenne	231	140	aujourd'hui	919	1178
ministre remercie	168	88	conseil état	141	244
bien entendu	161	85	sécurité sociale	155	223
extrêmement important	112	36	transaction pénale	17	67
<i>2019–2021</i>					
droit passerelle	174	63	conseil état	122	279
union européenne	166	113	projet loi	200	335
vice premier	69	30	aujourd'hui	1489	1596
remercie réponse	156	117	comptes titres	24	92
première ligne	97	61	paradis fiscaux	13	69

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C80: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, French speech: periods beginning in the 2020s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
2022–2024					
lutte contre	394	236	projet loi	477	799
femmes hommes	63	13	conseil état	75	196
premier ministre	499	451	millions euros	79	162
mise place	175	131	tva cent	21	69
service citoyen	53	13	cour constitutionnelle	17	63
2024–2025					
union européenne	254	135	premier ministre	343	723
projet loi	213	139	000 euros	91	241
accord gouvernement	227	172	500 euros	29	150
remercie réponse	97	47	67 ans	7	81
travailleurs sociaux	47	23	celles ceux	98	158

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\xi}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C81: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1900s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1900–1902</i>					
frank toe	1030	195	000 frank	824	837
vlaamsche volk	672	248	werkende klas	294	303
			algemeen stemrecht	526	533
			minister landbouw	587	593
			voorzien artikel	265	271
<i>1902–1904</i>					
mager vee	1598	858	minister landbouw	839	847
			vlaamsche taal	615	620
			vlaamsche land	444	448
			ten minste	485	489
			000 frank	587	591
<i>1904–1906</i>					
000 frank	1128	1119	frank toe	252	680
ont répondu	338	333	fr 20	85	243
kleine bedienden	412	409			
toe kennen	252	249			
gelijke rechten	427	425			
<i>1906–1908</i>					
vlaamsche taal	421	228	bedienden werklieden	119	393
vraag af	129	113	mijne hoeren	32	192
000 frank	616	614	wij socialisten	34	73
gij hebt	490	489			
west vlaanderen	327	325			
<i>1908–1910</i>					
indien gij	385	200	ambtenaar burgerlijke	50	160
zult gij	430	259	wij socialisten	28	138
kleine bedienden	236	78	gij hebt	566	568
du lundi	2	2	gij zult	512	514
1990 kamer	2	2	000 frank	529	531

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C82: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1910s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1910–1912</i>					
000 frank	779	773	frank toe	133	508
werkende klas	328	324	private nijverheid	45	241
toe kennen	299	296			
000 000	203	201			
ten minste	454	451			
<i>1912–1914</i>					
algemeen stemrecht	656	252	lagere scholen	51	451
gij weet	388	264	tweede taal	32	303
gij hebt	466	462	lager onderwijs	89	297
zeer wel	473	470	14 jaar	158	308
000 frank	514	510	koninklijk besluit	80	219

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\xi}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C83: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1920s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1921–1923</i>					
middelbaar onderwijs	463	121	000 frank	859	1375
koninklijk besluit	345	179	oud strijders	104	267
lager onderwijs	342	186	vlaamsche soldaten	40	144
vierde graad	155	31	nationaal werk	49	127
eerste minister	158	74	vlaamsche nationalisten	0	76
<i>1923–1925</i>					
artikel 10	289	71	artikel 94	91	286
koninklijk besluit	326	201	vlaamsche nationalisten	16	103
artikel 57	182	58	000 frank	1112	1118
vierde graad	146	35	binnenlandsche zaken	509	512
kroostrijke gezinnen	115	9	minister binnenlandsche	395	398
<i>1927–1929</i>					
000 frank	1116	698	oud strijders	159	394
openbare werken	387	171	zes maanden	271	394
koninklijk besluit	442	273	gewestelijke indeeling	61	178
kroostrijke gezinnen	237	89	fransch belgisch	33	148
neer leggen	203	59	vlaamsche nationalisten	41	139
<i>1929–1932</i>					
neer leggen	315	53	vlaamsche nationalisten	56	228
kamer neer	220	11	vlaamsche volk	103	256
eer bureel	177	4	gij hebt	277	421
000 frank	949	795	fransch belgisch	11	120
leggen wetsontwerp	151	4	vlaamsch nationale	20	122

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C84: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1930s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1932–1934</i>					
neer leggen	273	56	eerste minister	21	163
maatschappij buurtspoorwegen	228	14	vlaamsche nationalisten	43	180
kamer neer	204	10	vlaamsche volk	99	217
leggen verslag	194	7	besluit wet	100	204
nationale maatschappij	334	148	vlaamsche katholieken	10	89
<i>1934–1936</i>					
koninklijk besluit	538	286	vlaamsche volk	74	376
ter tafel	206	78	000 000	214	455
openbare werken	431	315	oud strijders	54	293
kroostrijke gezinnen	175	68	vlaamsche ministers	11	137
leggen verslag	91	10	vlaamsche land	112	228
<i>1936–1939</i>					
ter tafel	451	51	gij hebt	177	364
legt ter	570	233	gij zijt	110	272
verslag wetsontwerp	239	24	vlaamsche land	157	314
koninklijk besluit	444	244	vlaamsche volk	155	283
neer leggen	249	63	vlaamsche nationalisten	90	215
<i>1939–1940</i>					
legt ter	762	215	vlaamsch nationale	30	224
ter tafel	531	76	vlaamsche nationalisten	81	188
technisch onderwijs	377	67	vlaamsche soldaten	22	111
koninklijk besluit	473	211	onze groep	35	119
verslag wetsontwerp	217	57	vlaamsche volk	55	136

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C85: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1940s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1944–1946</i>					
ambachten neringen	229	19	dienst pensioenen	101	352
eer ter	261	127	000 000	407	587
minister justitie	250	124	kroostrijke gezinnen	35	206
eerste minister	761	641	buitenlandsche zaken	114	199
ter tafel	471	353	arbeid sociale	113	162
<i>1946–1947</i>					
dienst pensioenen	295	51	eerste minister	187	748
ter tafel	372	208	000 ton	116	246
legt ter	179	60	technisch onderwijs	103	230
economische unie	199	80	ambachten neringen	10	120
politieke gevangenen	228	134	vraag af	70	145
<i>1947–1949</i>					
ter tafel	470	203	miljoen frank	97	329
verslag wetsontwerp	260	88	werkende klas	17	235
eer ter	289	120	verenigde staten	109	319
tafel neer	277	115	eerste trimester	8	172
leggen verslag	193	67	gij hebt	101	255
<i>1949–1950</i>					
ter tafel	448	118	eerste minister	313	938
tafel neer	353	46	wij vragen	172	337
eer ter	354	47	algemene paritaire	29	140
leggen verslag	305	55	gij hebt	234	258
kiescollege arrondissement	324	82	legt ter	83	87

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{ji}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C86: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1950s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1950–1952</i>					
ter tafel	650	48	eerste minister	146	536
verslag wetsontwerp	499	34	gij hebt	112	274
eer ter	405	21	minister financiën	127	243
tafel neer	403	20	vier twintig	46	150
neer leggen	410	72	minister justitie	139	238
<i>1952–1954</i>					
ter tafel	910	70	eerste minister	146	635
eer ter	594	31	twintig maanden	82	306
tafel neer	581	30	achttien maanden	38	242
verslag wetsontwerp	592	48	gij hebt	124	293
neer leggen	557	97	hebt gij	44	169
<i>1954–1956</i>					
ter tafel	731	45	eerste minister	263	685
tafel neer	486	23	technisch onderwijs	25	256
eer ter	489	26	openbaar onderwijs	110	291
verslag wetsontwerp	482	21	arbeid sociale	125	265
neer leggen	423	49	wet 29	91	228
<i>1956–1958</i>					
ter tafel	633	64	eerste minister	144	651
tafel neer	492	39	000 frank	526	657
eer ter	488	36	ten laste	59	175
neer leggen	453	63	technisch onderwijs	45	146
verslag wetsontwerp	411	44	arbeid sociale	118	205
<i>1958–1961</i>					
wet 21	112	16	eerste minister	431	1577
openbare werken	205	123	gij hebt	189	498
koninklijk besluit	225	158	minister financiën	209	357
000 ton	77	22	hebt gij	90	199
miljoen ton	83	34	000 000	90	187

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C87: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1960s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1961–1963</i>					
dienst pensioenen	140	43	000 frank	347	630
openbare werken	191	101	eerste minister	196	439
koninklijk besluit	317	248	vlaamse land	84	194
buitenlandse zaken	171	121	fiscale hervorming	168	266
vitale belangen	57	13	minder validen	6	101
<i>1963–1965</i>					
openbare werken	258	136	tweede taal	53	274
economische expansie	146	90	vlaamse gemeenschap	23	184
burgerlijke oorlogsslachtoffers	42	3	hoger onderwijs	75	211
nationale maatschappij	117	81	vice gouverneur	25	158
sociale partners	61	38	vlaamse land	124	245
<i>1965–1968</i>					
koninklijk besluit	447	350	eerste minister	505	1028
jaar 1966	96	31	vrije universiteiten	32	122
openbare werken	221	161	vlaamse gemeenschap	20	93
1965 1966	116	67	wij weten	175	247
gemengde loopbanen	73	25	vice gouverneur	6	77
<i>1968–1969</i>					
openbare onderstand	140	39	eerste minister	198	481
begroting 1969	131	54	technische ingenieurs	58	255
geachte lid	81	21	000 ton	87	246
collectieve arbeidsovereenkomsten	59	9	nationale opvoeding	185	333
paritaire comités	59	13	hoger onderwijs	66	202
<i>1969–1971</i>					
hoger onderwijs	180	89	eerste minister	166	515
openbare werken	318	233	ter zake	327	479
koninklijk besluit	493	419	minister geachte	105	227
geachte lid	85	11	lager onderwijs	29	130
minder validen	77	16	nationale opvoeding	127	204

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C88: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1970s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1971–1974</i>					
geachte lid	151	5	eerste minister	303	806
buitengewoon onderwijs	107	12	traditionele partijen	5	99
minder validen	186	100	minister geachte	98	170
gewaarborgd inkomen	145	74	artikel 59bis	6	74
verzekering geven	83	16	syndicale vrijheid	3	70
<i>1974–1977</i>					
hoger onderwijs	210	53	eerste minister	322	1265
koninklijk besluit	627	505	binnenlandse zaken	165	347
geachte lid	119	9	minister binnenlandse	95	237
buitengewoon onderwijs	130	28	openbare werken	222	291
wij moeten	307	227	zeer duidelijk	95	157
<i>1977–1978</i>					
openbare werken	286	89	eerste minister	552	1602
000 frank	312	184	toegevoegd minister	31	258
koninklijk besluit	411	324	nationale investeringsmaatschappij	20	210
vlaamse gemeenschap	114	38	staatssecretaris begroting	44	150
nationale opvoeding	170	97	europese verkiezingen	139	232
<i>1979–1981</i>					
koninklijk besluit	424	207	eerste minister	624	1536
ter beschikking	175	97	minister geachte	236	348
hoofdstedelijk gebied	101	30	vlaamse gemeenschap	136	248
begroting 1980	145	76	vraag af	59	153
minder validen	76	7	studiemeester opvoeder	9	84

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C89: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1980s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1981–1983</i>					
wij moeten	426	221	eerste minister	483	1151
cockerill sambre	285	151	vraag af	41	129
europese commissie	174	52	minister geachte	198	284
miljoen frank	166	53	ten eerste	241	317
europese gemeenschap	226	113	openbare ziekenhuizen	34	101
<i>1983–1985</i>					
wij moeten	325	203	eerste minister	374	1066
ten aanzien	249	177	minister geachte	286	399
openbare financiën	104	40	koninklijk besluit	419	504
ervan overtuigd	154	97	sociale zekerheid	233	303
sovjet unie	69	12	ter zake	615	683
<i>1985–1987</i>					
europese gemeenschap	303	117	eerste minister	798	2237
stand brengen	163	44	geantwoord mm	10	124
netto financieren	134	43	ont répondu	12	122
onze fractie	194	115	eenvoudige motie	30	124
tijdens komende	76	13	vraag af	51	135
<i>1988–1989</i>					
mm michel	176	39	eerste minister	791	1412
gemeenschappen gewesten	248	143	openbare financiën	60	187
se sont	107	22	indirecte belastingen	40	105
sont abstenus	102	22	vraag af	41	104
politieke partijen	167	98	fiscale parafiscale	21	79
<i>1989–1991</i>					
europese gemeenschap	341	178	eerste minister	771	1995
onze fractie	209	86	buitenlandse zaken	291	558
ten eerste	384	280	minister buitenlandse	221	459
ten derde	221	139	juillet 1991	132	290
wij moeten	261	180	openbaar vervoer	61	194

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C90: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 1990s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1991–1993</i>					
procent bnp	376	109	eerste minister	622	1585
kiescollege arrondissement	219	78	sociale zekerheid	605	763
lijst nr	188	58	vraag af	65	110
vice gouverneur	70	30	parti socialiste	27	38
kamer volksvertegenwoordigers	1149	1142	vlaamse partijen	41	49
<i>1993–1995</i>					
koninklijk besluit	580	225	eerste minister	457	2318
kamer volksvertegenwoordigers	1278	1256	parti socialiste	34	243
volksvertegenwoordigers België	1235	1213			
België législature	1230	1209			
48e zittingsperiode	1232	1211			
<i>1995–1997</i>					
koninklijk besluit	269	137	eerste minister	775	2551
procureur generaal	358	250	sociale zekerheid	371	740
ter beschikking	223	119	minister justitie	340	502
korte termijn	148	66	parti socialiste	20	125
gerechtelijk onderzoek	136	58	politieke benoemingen	25	121
<i>1997–1999</i>					
koninklijk besluit	481	217	eerste minister	498	1553
voorwaardelijke invrijheidstelling	196	60	hoog comité	94	225
europese unie	253	123	minister hebt	36	133
procureur generaal	276	178	politieke verantwoordelijkheid	43	128
ten eerste	489	397	vice eerste	132	217
<i>1999–2001</i>					
mondelinge vraag	526	364	eerste minister	818	1921
openbaar ministerie	181	63	minister justitie	422	626
gesloten incident	454	337	federale politie	37	233
incident est	485	371	halle vilvoorde	107	282
est clos	486	371	miljard frank	249	404

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C91: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2000s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2001–2003</i>					
les membres	316	16	eerste minister	681	2023
gestemd les	251	13	minister justitie	277	534
ont répondu	213	15	lambermont akkoord	33	257
europese unie	295	149	vlaams parlement	119	317
nationale loterij	241	111	veiligheid staat	64	254
<i>2003–2005</i>					
ten eerste	608	365	eerste minister	357	1402
schriftelijk verslag	163	48	amendement nr	11	282
federale politie	125	36	snel belg	90	270
sociale partners	160	92	belg wet	98	262
verwijs schriftelijk	88	24	halle vilvoorde	118	280
<i>2005–2007</i>					
europese unie	314	131	eerste minister	278	1373
wij moeten	303	200	miljoen euro	324	520
sociale partners	208	106	snel belg	1	119
schriftelijk verslag	169	72	vice eerste	177	294
denk we	143	58	vraag af	79	183
<i>2007–2010</i>					
wij moeten	540	260	eerste minister	613	1717
heel belangrijk	241	137	vraag af	69	177
moeten wij	255	175	halle vilvoorde	49	156
minister dank	208	132	minister financiën	100	175
nmbs groep	87	14	minister hebt	55	123

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C92: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2010s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>2010–2012</i>					
wij moeten	701	493	eerste minister	524	1031
sociale partners	183	73	miljard euro	184	350
heel belangrijk	224	122	onze fractie	227	344
ervoor zorgen	337	250	000 euro	122	220
nmbs groep	78	35	amendement ingediend	100	166
<i>2012–2014</i>					
wij moeten	640	342	miljoen euro	459	681
minister dank	318	172	miljard euro	313	462
heel belangrijk	268	133	onze fractie	316	440
dank antwoord	278	156	gemiste kans	31	143
moeten wij	350	249	vraag af	49	158
<i>2014–2016</i>					
wij moeten	811	451	eerste minister	729	1789
minister dank	314	144	miljoen euro	291	536
dank antwoord	263	116	minister financiën	118	261
europese unie	302	162	tax shift	83	224
est clos	476	344	miljard euro	227	367
<i>2016–2019</i>					
wij moeten	675	462	eerste minister	901	1539
minister dank	258	129	buitenlandse zaken	82	181
sociale zekerheid	325	197	zware beroepen	101	191
europese unie	276	162	saudi arabie	176	255
dank antwoord	234	120	langer werken	52	118
<i>2019–2021</i>					
wij moeten	684	379	eerste minister	529	854
we moeten	521	293	miljard euro	173	469
ervoor zorgen	522	386	miljoen euro	414	664
moeten we	318	208	sociale zekerheid	105	226
moeten wij	384	282	europese unie	212	292

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C93: Most partisan phrases, Government and Opposition, Dutch speech: periods beginning in the 2020s

Government			Opposition		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
2022–2024					
we moeten	867	353	miljoen euro	172	525
ervoor zorgen	596	306	eerste minister	564	735
sociaal tarief	337	146	miljard euro	254	375
wij moeten	435	266	onze fractie	275	364
moeten we	430	264	europese commissie	139	218
2024–2025					
we moeten	996	617	eerste minister	528	876
moeten we	524	397	flexi jobs	92	206
heel belangrijk	233	116	miljard euro	612	721
ervoor zorgen	489	403	sterkste schouders	88	176
we ervoor	120	41	miljoen euro	581	661

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\xi}_{jt}$ for each group (Government: positive; Opposition: negative) in Dutch speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 3; covariates: female, province. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Table C94: Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: one period every ten years

Flemish districts			Walloon districts		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1839–1841</i>					
sucre indigène	139	36	section centrale	493	569
sucre exotique	134	81	société générale	139	214
57 millions	53	23	tribunal commerce	16	91
port ostende	20	4	publicité concurrence	69	124
fil mécanique	31	18	juge paix	16	36
<i>1848–1850</i>					
chemin fer	474	268	section centrale	548	673
aujourd'hui	515	425	conseil mines	26	59
projet loi	410	342	doit être	150	179
enseignement moyen	128	68	ministre finances	268	291
industrie linière	63	20	juge paix	10	33
<i>1859–1861</i>					
écoles normales	116	4	canal charleroi	37	235
conseil communal	106	45	canalisation meuse	8	81
pétition datée	66	17	travaux publics	250	314
élève universitaire	102	53	code pénal	88	143
examen écrit	56	8	communes octroi	59	111
<i>1868–1870</i>					
aujourd'hui	593	449	sociétés anonymes	59	171
ministre finances	218	102	assemblée générale	29	120
députation permanente	202	100	chemin fer	255	319
ministre guerre	199	106	code pénal	49	110
ministre intérieur	257	167	sociétés commandite	32	93
<i>1878–1880</i>					
ministre intérieur	308	107	chemin fer	235	649
députation permanente	214	84	travaux publics	243	337
ministre finances	165	81	projet loi	283	352
conseil communal	160	76	honneur déposer	24	76
ministre affaires	113	35	voies navigables	23	71
<i>1888–1890</i>					
prud hommes	241	160	ministre finances	102	180
pays flamand	89	22	ministre guerre	72	134
conseils prud	167	104	tribunal commerce	30	85
ville gand	59	8	ministre justice	150	203
flandre occidentale	40	7	commis greffiers	5	50
<i>1898–1900</i>					
représentation proportionnelle	310	235	banque nationale	150	207
projet loi	387	335	chemin fer	237	286
banque état	67	26	ministre finances	105	134
société nationale	39	8	députation permanente	60	85
fer vicinaux	54	24	suffrage universel	55	78
<i>1908–1910</i>					
ministre guerre	238	99	prud hommes	114	226
travaux publics	103	48	conseils prud	74	167
administration communale	104	53	neuf heures	8	79
effectif paix	74	23	écoles normales	28	99
collège échevinal	58	15	huit heures	33	85
<i>1918–1919</i>					
projet loi	505	419	traité paix	24	85
section centrale	398	335	juge paix	19	62
régions dévastées	79	17	chemin fer	123	161
flandre occidentale	61	8	prix revient	11	40
administration communale	110	67	tribunaux dommages	58	85
<i>1929–1932</i>					
enseignement moyen	80	23	aujourd'hui	280	387
projet loi	342	285	ministre finances	63	145
sciences arts	95	52	chemin fer	133	213
allocations familiales	80	41	tout heure	81	154
application loi	94	56	société nationale	114	158
<i>1939–1940</i>					
crédit anverso	137	16	prix revient	38	58
conseil culturel	102	8	sous officiers	18	37
ministre communications	89	24	pommes terre	20	39
pleins pouvoirs	67	5	charges sociales	16	32
anciens combattants	85	25	allocations familiales	67	81

Table C94: Most partisan phrases, Flemish districts and Walloon districts, French speech: one period every ten years (continued)

Flemish districts			Walloon districts		
Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$	Phrase	$\hat{q}^A$	$\hat{q}^B$
<i>1949–1950</i>					
société nationale	128	36	conseil national	19	69
bureaux dépouillement	70	14	conseil etat	98	146
budget extraordinaire	70	20	heure actuelle	49	89
ministre finances	235	192	national charbonnages	9	45
code électoral	67	24	premier ministre	235	268
<i>1958–1961</i>					
table ronde	145	38	allocations familiales	46	126
congo belge	125	49	conseil national	28	107
ruanda urundi	115	44	tout heure	171	250
gouverneur général	79	12	haute autorité	28	85
force publique	82	17	heure actuelle	63	118
<i>1965–1968</i>					
etats unis	197	93	tout heure	101	185
dette publique	108	19	autoroute wallonie	2	49
national brut	117	28	vice premier	69	97
produit national	115	38	germain anglo	0	26
cour comptes	94	19	ministre chers	15	38

Notes: The five phrases with the largest partisanship $\hat{\zeta}_{jt}$ for each group (Flemish districts: positive; Walloon districts: negative) in French speech, and their predicted counts per 100,000 phrases for a speaker of each group. Specification: Figure 15; covariates: family, female. Phrases are shown in their most frequent unstemmed form.

Online Appendix D: Descriptive figures and tables

This appendix describes Chamber composition and the speech volume behind the estimates. A period's members are all those listed for its legislature, whether or not they speak. This includes replacements and, before 1919, members entering or leaving through partial elections during the legislature. Speeches follow the sample in Section 3. Here, government status means the member's party held office on at least half the period's sitting days. Unlike the main estimates, it is not based on the timing of that member's speeches.

Table D1 selects one period every twenty years plus the final period. It reports each family's shares of members and speeches, and speeches per member. Catholics and Liberals share the Chamber until 1894. Socialists account for 19 per cent of members in 1898–1900. Flemish nationalists and Communists enter between the wars; by 2019–2021, no family has more than a quarter of members.

Opposition families usually deliver more speeches per member than governing families. Socialists deliver 406 versus Catholics' 169 in 1898–1900; Communists deliver 566 in 1958–1961; and Christian democrats deliver 61 versus Socialists' 17 in 1999–2001. In the last two rows, 7–8 per cent of members lack a family label because the register lacks their party. Nearly all who speak nevertheless have a party in the speaker data used for estimation.

Table D1: Share of members and speeches by party family

Period	Party family	Share of members	Share of speeches	Speeches per member
1839–1841	Catholic / Christian democrat	0.50	0.49	4.7
	Liberal	0.49	0.51	5.0
	Unknown	0.02	0.00	0.0
1859–1861	Liberal	0.64	0.63	59.1
	Catholic / Christian democrat	0.35	0.37	62.3
	Unknown	0.01	0.00	1.5
1878–1880	Liberal	0.56	0.52	73.3
	Catholic / Christian democrat	0.43	0.48	87.0
	Unknown	0.01	0.00	12.0
1898–1900	Catholic / Christian democrat	0.72	0.56	169.0
	Socialist	0.19	0.36	406.4
	Liberal	0.08	0.08	201.5
	Unknown	0.01	0.00	85.0
1918–1919	Catholic / Christian democrat	0.52	0.40	44.9
	Liberal	0.25	0.31	73.2
	Socialist	0.21	0.30	84.6
	Unknown	0.03	0.00	0.0
1939–1940	Catholic / Christian democrat	0.34	0.30	42.9
	Socialist	0.33	0.30	45.0
	Liberal	0.16	0.16	49.2
	Flemish nationalist	0.08	0.10	67.1
	Communist / radical left	0.04	0.09	107.4
	Unknown	0.03	0.01	9.1
	Other	0.03	0.03	61.0
1958–1961	Catholic / Christian democrat	0.48	0.33	78.6
	Socialist	0.39	0.54	158.5
	Liberal	0.11	0.08	85.8
	Communist / radical left	0.01	0.04	566.0
	Unknown	0.01	0.00	0.0
	Flemish nationalist	0.00	0.01	168.0

Table D1: Share of members and speeches by party family (continued)

Period	Party family	Share of members	Share of speeches	Speeches per member
1979–1981	Catholic / Christian democrat	0.38	0.26	46.2
	Socialist	0.27	0.19	47.6
	Liberal	0.17	0.20	83.5
	Francophone regionalist	0.08	0.11	104.1
	Flemish nationalist	0.07	0.17	159.8
	Communist / radical left	0.02	0.07	280.5
	Unknown	0.01	0.00	4.5
	Other	0.00	0.00	31.0
1999–2001	Liberal	0.27	0.21	26.3
	Socialist	0.24	0.12	17.0
	Catholic / Christian democrat	0.19	0.33	60.6
	Green	0.13	0.08	21.5
	Flemish nationalist	0.13	0.23	61.6
	Unknown	0.03	0.01	15.6
	Francophone regionalist	0.01	0.00	10.0
	Other	0.01	0.00	27.0
2019–2021	Flemish nationalist	0.25	0.26	69.0
	Socialist	0.19	0.14	48.4
	Liberal	0.18	0.17	62.7
	Green	0.14	0.08	39.5
	Catholic / Christian democrat	0.10	0.14	89.6
	Communist / radical left	0.07	0.11	108.9
	Unknown	0.07	0.05	46.2
	Francophone regionalist	0.01	0.03	186.5
2024–2025	Other	0.01	0.02	182.0
	Flemish nationalist	0.26	0.25	37.5
	Socialist	0.18	0.17	37.0
	Catholic / Christian democrat	0.16	0.11	27.2
	Liberal	0.16	0.17	42.1
	Communist / radical left	0.08	0.11	51.2
	Unknown	0.08	0.04	16.4
	Green	0.06	0.11	72.9
	Other	0.01	0.01	51.0
	Francophone regionalist	0.01	0.03	205.0

Notes: One period every twenty years and the last period.

Table D2 reports, every ten years, the member, speaker and speech shares for Catholics, the left, women and governing parties. Since most members speak, speaker shares differ from member shares by at most 0.05. Speech shares differ more. Excluding low-coverage years, governing parties deliver a smaller speech share than member share in 53 of 55 periods since 1894 with at least ten opposition members, compared with 10 of 21 earlier periods. In 1949–1950, governing Catholics hold 0.50 of membership but deliver 0.27 of speeches, while the left accounts for 0.37 and 0.57. Women’s member share stays below a tenth until 1995 and exceeds two fifths from 2019 (Section 5.4). Their speech share is below their seat share in 39 of 42 adequately covered periods since 1929.

Table D3 reports member and speech shares for Flemish, Walloon and Brussels districts. Flemish districts elect 0.45–0.52 of members until 2010 and 0.55–0.57 from 2019. Walloon districts elect 0.38–0.43 until 1940 and about a third from 1969. Brussels accounts for 0.10–0.17 from 1848.

Speech shares differ from seat shares. In every displayed period from 1908 to 1981, Flemish members’ speech share is smaller and Brussels members’ larger; Brussels delivers 0.28 of

Table D2: Summary statistics: Catholics, left parties, women and government parties

Period	Catholics			Left parties			Women			Government		
	MPs	Speakers	Speeches	MPs	Speakers	Speeches	MPs	Speakers	Speeches	MPs	Speakers	Speeches
1839–1841	0.50	0.47	0.49	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.49	0.53	0.51
1848–1850	0.28	0.24	0.28	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.70	0.75	0.72
1859–1861	0.35	0.38	0.37	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.64	0.61	0.63
1868–1870	0.41	0.40	0.40	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.59	0.60	0.60
1878–1880	0.43	0.45	0.48	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.56	0.55	0.52
1888–1890	0.70	0.69	0.53	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.70	0.69	0.53
1898–1900	0.72	0.71	0.56	0.19	0.20	0.36	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.72	0.71	0.56
1908–1910	0.53	0.52	0.42	0.20	0.21	0.33	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.53	0.52	0.42
1918–1919	0.52	0.54	0.40	0.21	0.23	0.30	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.97	1.00	1.00
1929–1932	0.41	0.39	0.36	0.37	0.39	0.43	0.01	0.01	0.00	0.56	0.55	0.49
1939–1940	0.34	0.36	0.30	0.37	0.35	0.40	0.01	0.01	0.02	0.85	0.87	0.80
1949–1950	0.50	0.46	0.27	0.37	0.39	0.57	0.03	0.02	0.01	0.63	0.61	0.43
1958–1961	0.48	0.50	0.33	0.40	0.39	0.58	0.05	0.04	0.01	0.59	0.60	0.41
1969–1971	0.32	0.34	0.27	0.31	0.30	0.27	0.04	0.04	0.01	0.55	0.56	0.45
1979–1981	0.38	0.38	0.26	0.29	0.29	0.26	0.07	0.08	0.03	0.65	0.64	0.44
1989–1991	0.28	0.28	0.26	0.35	0.32	0.14	0.08	0.10	0.09	0.71	0.70	0.48
1999–2001	0.19	0.20	0.33	0.24	0.23	0.12	0.21	0.23	0.17	0.64	0.63	0.42
2007–2010	0.22	0.23	0.20	0.20	0.22	0.23	0.36	0.37	0.28	0.58	0.61	0.46
2019–2021	0.10	0.11	0.14	0.26	0.24	0.25	0.43	0.43	0.39	0.58	0.57	0.47
2024–2025	0.16	0.18	0.11	0.27	0.27	0.28	0.41	0.41	0.36	0.63	0.65	0.52

Notes: Share of the members, of the speakers (members with at least one speech) and of the speeches that belong to each category; one period every ten years and the last period.

speeches against 0.14 of seats in 1929–1932. From 1989, Flemish members’ speech share exceeds their seat share. Brussels members deliver 0.17–0.28 of speeches in the 1908–1991 rows and are excluded from Section 5.5’s regional comparison. The low-coverage 1839–1841 row uses 598 speeches, and 4 per cent of members lack a region.

Table D3: Summary statistics: regions

Period	Flanders		Wallonia		Brussels	
	MPs	Speeches	MPs	Speeches	MPs	Speeches
1839–1841	0.50	0.30	0.40	0.55	0.06	0.14
1848–1850	0.50	0.49	0.40	0.44	0.10	0.07
1859–1861	0.45	0.49	0.42	0.37	0.13	0.14
1868–1870	0.47	0.37	0.43	0.53	0.10	0.10
1878–1880	0.45	0.53	0.43	0.36	0.12	0.11
1888–1890	0.47	0.48	0.39	0.43	0.14	0.08
1898–1900	0.46	0.42	0.42	0.51	0.12	0.06
1908–1910	0.48	0.37	0.38	0.41	0.14	0.21
1918–1919	0.45	0.32	0.42	0.45	0.14	0.23
1929–1932	0.47	0.37	0.39	0.36	0.14	0.28
1939–1940	0.45	0.36	0.40	0.43	0.15	0.21
1949–1950	0.49	0.38	0.36	0.35	0.15	0.26
1958–1961	0.50	0.49	0.36	0.33	0.15	0.17
1969–1971	0.50	0.43	0.34	0.28	0.15	0.28
1979–1981	0.50	0.48	0.33	0.26	0.17	0.26
1989–1991	0.51	0.53	0.32	0.24	0.17	0.23
1999–2001	0.52	0.60	0.34	0.28	0.14	0.12
2007–2010	0.51	0.53	0.34	0.25	0.15	0.22
2019–2021	0.55	0.58	0.34	0.28	0.11	0.14
2024–2025	0.57	0.58	0.32	0.30	0.11	0.12

Notes: Share of the members elected in, and of the speeches by members from, each region; one period every ten years and the last period.

Figure D1 shows the member shares of Catholic, Liberal and left (Socialist and Communist) families. Catholics and Liberals share the Chamber until 1894. Liberals reach 70 per cent in 1848–1852; Catholics hold 60–72 per cent in 1886–1900. Socialists enter with 17 per cent in 1894. In 1919–1968, Catholic and left shares are 31–51 and 34–45 per cent, while Liberals hold 9–22 per cent. After the party splits, the Catholic share falls most, reaching 10 per cent in 2019–2024. Liberals reach their highest post-1894 share, 27 per cent, in 1999–2007. Catholics, group A in the religious comparison, thus form a majority under Catholic governments in 1884–1914 and a small federal-era minority. In 2019–2024, they are too few for the religious series to be defined (Section 5.1).

Figure D2 counts members whose parties govern on at least half the period’s sitting days. The governing share is 100 per cent in 1831–1839, 1841–1848 and 1854–1857. These periods have unionist or mixed cabinets, or successive cabinets of both parties in 1845–1848. The share is 88–100 per cent under national-union governments in 1918–1921, 1925–1927, 1934–1936 and 1939–1940. Most such periods are absent from Figure 3.

Under single-party governments in 1847–1914, the governing family holds 53–72 per cent of members. The exception is 1882–1884 at 46 per cent, which includes members elected in 1884. After 1919, excluding national-union governments, the share ranges from 51–53 per cent in 1950–1958 and 1981–1987 to 83–85 per cent in 1961–1965 and 1977–1978. Federal-era shares are 57–69 per cent. Narrow majorities in 1950–1958 coincide with the religious peak and high

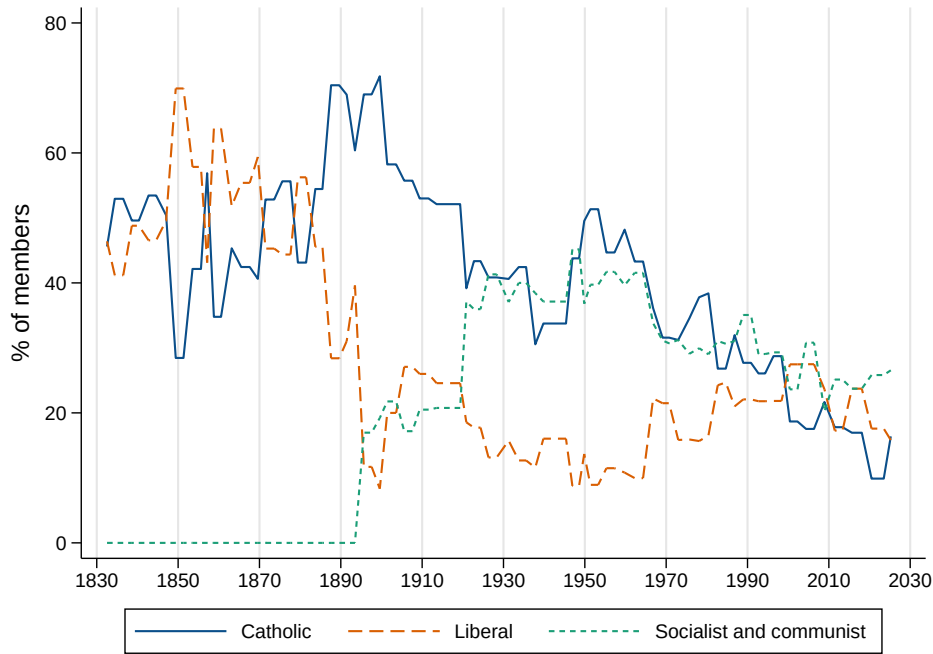


Figure D1: Members of the Catholic, Liberal and left families

government–opposition values. The latter series peaks in 1932–1936.

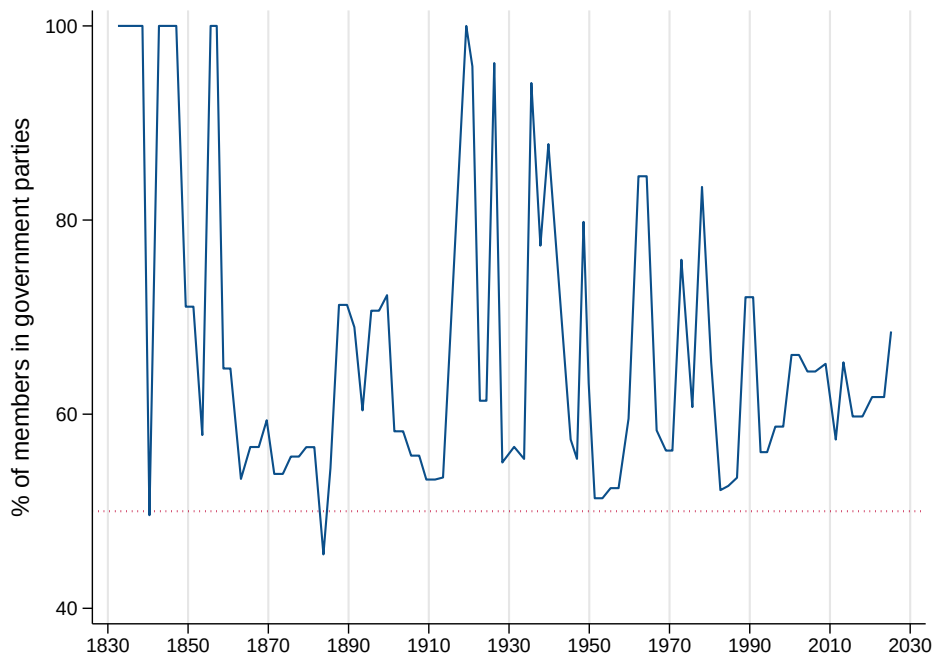


Figure D2: Members of the parties in government

Figure D3 reports the decade share of plenary speech blocks linked to a member or minister, excluding the chair's turns. Linkage is 74 per cent in the 1830s, when sources are digitized years of the *Moniteur belge*, 93 per cent in the 1840s and 96 per cent in the 1850s. It is at least 98 per cent in every later decade except the 2000s (97.8 per cent). Overall, 98.5 per cent of 1,650,454 blocks

are linked (Table B1). Incomplete linkage is therefore mainly concentrated in low-coverage years excluded from averages. Post-1850 estimates use almost all plenary speeches.

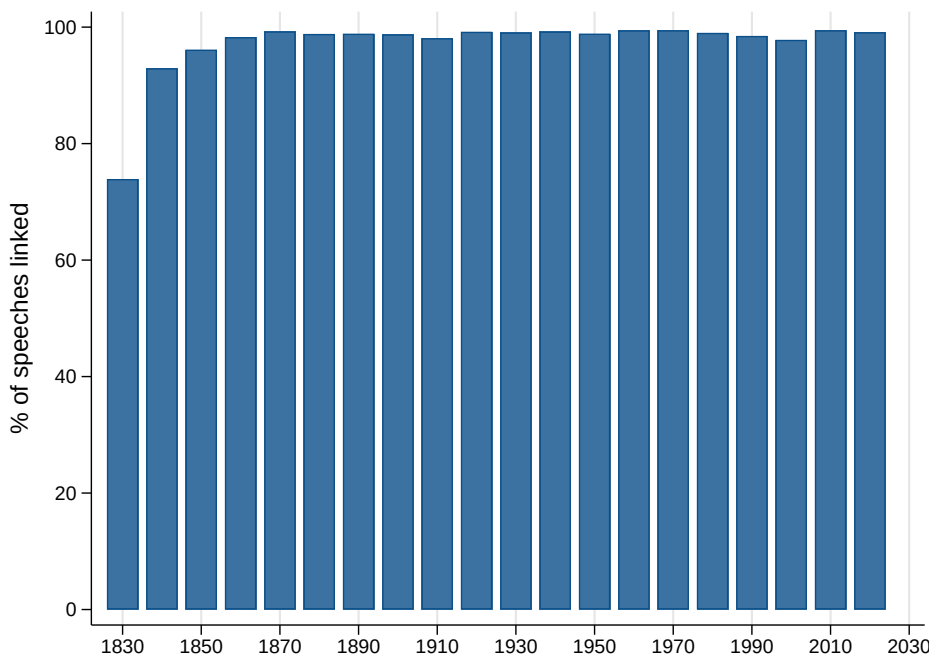


Figure D3: Speeches linked to a member or minister, by decade

Notes: See [Graziani \(2026\)](#) for the evaluation of the segmentation.

Figure D4 shows sample speech counts (a) and vocabulary phrases per speaker (b). Speech counts are at most 3,500 per period before 1843, 33,000–57,000 in 1894–1914, and 68,576 in 1929–1932, a period lasting almost three years. They range from 1,100 to 12,400 after 1985. Phrases per speaker peak at 6,400 in 1894–1896. They average about 4,600 in 1894–1918 and 1,300 in 1995–2025, while mean plenary sitting counts fall from 214 to 87. The lowest values occur in poorly covered years, 1831–1843 and 1991–1995. Since penalization retains coefficients only when the data support them, declining speech volume complicates comparisons across eras (Section 5.10).

Figure D5 shows the share of governing and opposition members who speak at least once per period. Both shares usually range from 80 to 100 per cent. Excluding low-coverage periods and periods with fewer than ten opposition members, opposition participation is higher in 40 of 55 periods since 1894 and 11 of 21 earlier periods, usually by a few points.

The lowest opposition shares, 59 per cent in 1884–1886 and 57 per cent in 1944–1946, include members who never speak. These are Liberals who lose their seats in June 1884 and Flemish nationalists elected in 1939, none of whom speak in 1944–1946. The opposition’s higher speech share in Table D2 mainly reflects speaking more often. Since 1894, opposition speakers deliver a median of 1.7 times as many speeches as governing speakers, and more in 53 of 55 periods.

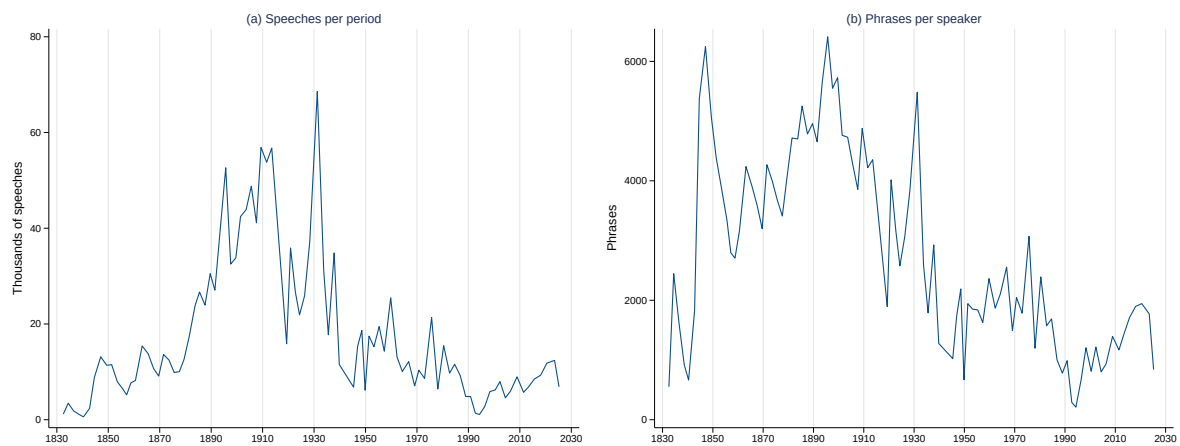


Figure D4: Amount of speech

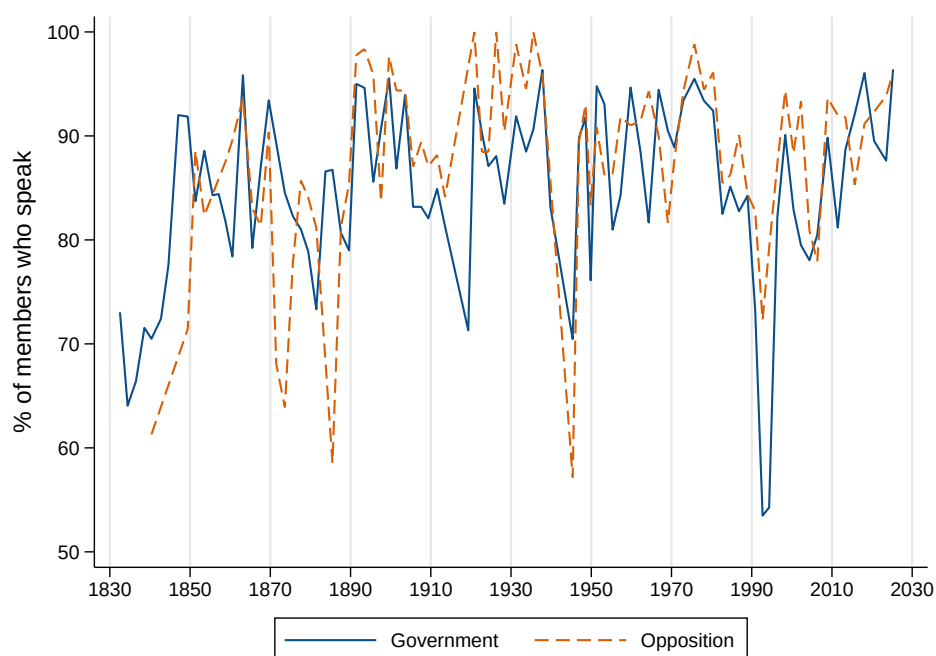


Figure D5: Share of government and opposition members who speak

Online Appendix E: Reactions, references and emotions

Section 7's measures come from a companion module (`code/emotions`). Its first steps cover the full period without a language model. They detect stenographers' stage directions, the chair's interventions and references between members. Later steps classify emotions and tone using a language model and a classifier, as described below. The reported results use a test run with placeholder labels for those later steps, so Section 7 reports no emotion estimates. Reactions and references are independent of these placeholders. Table E1 gives the detected counts.

Table E1: Reactions, calls to order and references found by the module

	Number	Attributed to a member or minister (%)
<i>Stage directions (pieces of parentheses) in the speeches and procedural blocks</i>		
Disorder	128,521	
Approval	124,811	
Laughter	77,060	
Stir	1,191	
Other (no measure)	709,373	
<i>Turns of the chair</i>		
Calls to order	1,201	
Censures	81	
<i>References in the speeches</i>		
By name	1,035,287	77.5
By office (ministers)	512,962	68.3
To the rapporteur	26,487	45.9
To the previous speaker	8,312	85.2
By constituency	3,968	43.3
Generic courtesy (no one designated)	98,303	

Notes: Plenary sittings, September 1831–2025: 2,013,705 speeches, 25,358 collective interjections and 537,360 procedural blocks in 14,943 sittings. Stage directions: pieces of a parenthesis cut at its dashes and semicolons; a piece counts once in every category it records; the counts include the reactions attributed to the public galleries, which the measures leave out. References: in the 1,649,591 speeches other than the turns of the chair. Test run of `code/emotions`: steps 0 (6 October 2026), 1 (7 October) and 2 (8 October).

Sample. The module uses the same dataset as the partisanship analysis (Graziani, 2026). It selects speeches, collective interjections and procedural blocks from plenary sittings between September 1831 and the end of 2025. As in the partisanship analysis, it excludes committee and Central Commission reports identified in `committee_scan.csv` for 1985–1999, and later documents with committee codes. Chair turns are identified from printed roles (*président*, *voorzitter* and variants), dataset flags or links.

The resulting sample differs slightly from the partisanship sample: it contains 1,649,591 non-chair speeches rather than 1,650,454. These are member and minister speeches, a small share unlinked to a person. After removing parenthetical text, they contain 256 million words. We measure reactions and references in these speeches. Each legislature is split at the midpoint between its first and last sitting, producing 112 half-legislatures for Figures 8 and 10.

From 1999, some numbered interventions remain inside the preceding block, often a chair turn, along with a summary in the other language. These account for about 8 per cent of words in 2000–2025. The reported results precede the module's current repair of these blocks (`criv.py`),

so they omit some speech from these years. This contributes to the lack of comparability after 1999.

Reactions of the Chamber. Stenographers record reactions within speech parentheses, for example (*Interruptions.*), (*Applaudissements à gauche. — Protestations à droite.*) and (*Gelach.*). The module reads parentheses of at most 25 words in speeches and procedural blocks, splitting them at dashes and semicolons. It normalizes each piece to lowercase without accents or punctuation and matches patterns for one or more categories: disorder (interruptions, noise, murmurs, protests, exclamations, uproar, the chair's gavel and Dutch equivalents), approval (applause, *très bien*, *bravo*, assent), laughter, and stir (*mouvement*, *sensation*). Patterns match word beginnings to detect plurals and OCR-split forms such as *applau dissements*.

A single (*Non.*) or (*Neen.*) usually answers the chair's request for objections. Yes or no counts as approval or disorder only when repeated, as in *Non ! non !*, or attributed to a side of the House. Other pieces—petition or naturalization place names, document references, article numbers and footnotes—enter an unused residual category.

A reaction is assigned to the speech containing it. If printed in procedural text or a chair turn, it is assigned to the preceding non-chair speech in that sitting. We exclude reactions from public galleries. Disorder per 100,000 words is the count of disorder pieces assigned to a group's speeches divided by those speeches' word count. The hostile share is disorder divided by disorder plus approval. Decades follow sitting dates.

The chair. We detect calls to order in chair turns using patterns such as *je vous rappelle à l'ordre*, *à l'ordre !* and *ik roep u tot de orde*. Censures use *censure*, *inscription au procès-verbal* and *met vermelding in de notulen*. A turn containing both counts once in each category. We exclude agenda and business-order reminders: *je rappelle que ... à l'ordre du jour*, *passer à l'ordre du jour*, *à l'ordre des travaux* and *tot de orde van de dag*. These exclusions remove 26 of the 1,227 initially detected calls. We report calls and censures per 100 sittings. The module also records chair warnings, sitting suspensions and collective interjections, where shouts are attributed to several members. Section 7 does not use these.

Government, party family and language community. A speaker is on the governing side on the sitting date if they are a minister or belong to a party with a minister in office. Unlinked speeches have unknown status. We match parties by label, otherwise by family and party language, or by family alone when no language is specified, as before national-party splits.

Some ministerial terms lack end dates, including 81 of 95 prime-minister terms. We end these the day before the next term in the same portfolio or the next prime minister's appointment. Where neither follows, the minister is treated as currently in office. Independent and extra-parliamentary ministers count only in cabinets consisting entirely of such ministers. Most members therefore belong to the governing side under the Catholic–Liberal unionist cabinets of 1831–1847: 95 per cent of 1830s speeches with known status.

Party family comes from the member register or, if absent, from the party label. Language community follows party language for parties associated with one community: Flemish nationalists, Francophone regionalists, Greens and other community-specific parties throughout, and

Catholics, Liberals and Socialists after their 1968, 1972 and 1978 splits. Otherwise it follows constituency region, assigning Flanders to Dutch and Wallonia to French. For Brussels members from 1919, we instead use the language of at least 70 per cent of their legislature’s speeches, provided they deliver at least 20. Community is known for 94 per cent of member-legislatures. Almost every member speaks French before the 1890s, so early community labels describe constituency region rather than spoken language.

References between members. We detect references in non-chair speeches after removing parenthetical text. Six pattern types identify: names following titles (*M. Woeste, l’honorable M. de Theux, MM. Beernaert et Woeste, de heer Van Rompuy, Mijnheer Tindemans, collega De Wever, minister Vandenbroucke*); constituency-based references (*l’honorable membre de Gand*); ministerial offices (*M. le ministre des Finances, de eerste minister*); rapporteurs; previous speakers (*l’honorable préopinant, de vorige spreker*); and generic courtesy without a specific target (*l’honorable membre*). When matches overlap, we keep the most specific.

We match names against members of the legislature and ministers in office on the sitting date. First, we try exact surnames, including leading words of the printed name. Next, we try surnames without particles (*Theux* for *de Theux*), then leading words of longer surnames (*de Theux* for *de Theux de Meylandt*). Finally, names of at least six letters can match members’ surnames by similarity to allow for OCR errors. We require a unique best match scoring at least 88 out of 100. Homonyms are resolved by first initial or, failing that, by who speaks in the same sitting. Otherwise they remain unresolved.

An office-based reference targets the minister holding that portfolio. If several qualify, we select the one speaking in the same debate. A minister mentioned without a portfolio is resolved only when a single minister speaks in that debate. Portfolios are unrecognized for 20 per cent of ministerial terms, leaving those ministers identifiable only by name. A rapporteur reference targets the most recent preceding speaker with that printed role in the same debate. A previous-speaker reference targets the last other member to speak in the debate. We exclude self-references.

Among name references, 71 per cent match surnames exactly. Another 6 per cent are resolved through particles, leading words, similarity, initials or sitting participation. One per cent remain ambiguous between homonyms, and 22 per cent match neither a legislature member nor a current minister. These include OCR errors, outsiders and members or ministers from other years. Section 7 uses resolved name references, following [Peeters and Lefever \(2026\)](#)’s name-only counts. A reference crosses families when both family labels are known and differ; the residual small-party category counts as a family. It crosses the language border when both communities are known and differ.

Random pairing. Group sizes affect cross-group reference shares. When one family dominates membership, it receives many references even if speakers address opponents. Figure 10’s benchmark randomly pairs each reference’s speaker with a target from those referenced in the same half-legislature. The expected cross-group share is $1 - \sum_g s_g t_g$, where s_g is group g ’s share of references made and t_g its share received. We calculate observed and expected shares by

half-legislature. Decade averages include half-legislatures whose midpoint falls in that decade, weighted by reference counts.

Validation. [Peeters and Lefever \(2026, Appendix 1\)](#) report counts for 53 investiture, State of the Union and confidence debates in 1961–2023. They count member and minister speeches, excluding chair turns, and name references within and across language groups from Chamber reports. We manually identify each debate’s sitting dates using agenda headings, chair announcements and cabinet dates, and list them in the module. For those dates, we select speeches outside headings for other business: questions, interpellations, bills, budgets, motions, petitions, naturalizations and personal statements. We then count name references between members with known language communities.

The module finds speeches for 49 of 53 debates. Investiture sittings from 1992, 1995 and 2003 are missing, and the 1994 debate is unidentified. Only the government declaration is available for 1987, so share comparisons use 48 debates. Our dataset also contains fewer speeches than [Peeters and Lefever \(2026\)](#) count in several debates: 1973, 1980, 1981, 1985, 1988, 1996 and 2006. Missing sittings explain most gaps. Section 7 reports the comparison.

Emotions and tone (in preparation). We remove parenthetical text and divide members’ speeches into passages of at most 120 words, producing 3.6 million passages. A locally run language model, Gemma 3 with 12 billion parameters, handles both French and Dutch. In sampled passages, it rates eight emotions from [Widmann and Wich \(2023\)](#): anger, fear, disgust, sadness, joy, enthusiasm, pride and hope. Ratings range from 0 (absent) to 2 (strong).

In sampled references, the model labels the speaker’s stance towards the target as supportive, neutral or critical. It also detects uncivil attacks—insults, mockery, attacks on character or motives, and accusations of lying—and denial of the target’s legitimacy as a political actor ([Muddiman, 2017](#)). Tone is classified as no attack, civil attack (critical without incivility) or uncivil attack.

The emotion sample contains 8,000 training passages and 1,200 test passages. A quarter of training passages are drawn from text with emotion cues, including exclamations, indignation, pride, hope or recorded disorder, to represent rare emotions. Test passages are equally allocated across institutional periods and languages. The reference sample contains 5,000 training references, half crossing groups, and 1,000 test references. Once topic labels are available, test samples will also be stratified by topic and doubled.

Two human coders independently label 300 test passages and 250 test references. We measure their agreement using Cohen’s kappa and, for emotions, Krippendorff’s alpha. We compare each with the language model using Cohen’s kappa. For each task, a single multilingual XLM-R classifier ([Conneau et al., 2020](#)) is fine-tuned on language-model labels. Using one classifier for both languages avoids differences in calibration entering trends as Dutch speech grows from almost zero to about 60 per cent. Probabilities are recalibrated on validation labels and averaged by speech, weighting passages by word count. We correct group-period averages for classifier errors with the design-based supervised learning estimator of [Egami et al. \(2023\)](#). Its gold standard is the test sample drawn with known probabilities, using either language-model labels or the two coders’ labels.